Vocabulario en inglés y exámenes ALCPT

Listado acumulado con traducciones al español y banco de preguntas resueltas

Estudiante	Brayhan
Nivel de referencia	B2
Palabras confirmadas	347
Formularios documentados	50, 51, 59, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 75, 82, 87, Technical
Phrasal verbs explicados	39
Idioms y términos militares	52
Preguntas documentadas	446
Actualizado	2026-10-06

Parte I · Vocabulario completo

Listado acumulado de todas las palabras y expresiones registradas hasta la fecha, con su traducción y matices de uso en español. Las secciones respetan el origen de cada término: primero las palabras aportadas directamente y después las extraídas de cada formulario del ALCPT.

A. Mis palabras

Palabras enviadas una por una

1	**Leakage**	fuga, filtración, escape
2	**Trade-off**	compensación, intercambio; sacrificio de una cosa a cambio de otra
3	**Beyond**	más allá de, por encima de, fuera de (un límite o alcance)
4	**Mainstream**	corriente principal, convencional, dominante
5	**Breach**	violación, incumplimiento, brecha
6	**Tailor**	sastre (sust.); adaptar, personalizar, hacer a medida (verbo)
7	**Fairly**	bastante, considerablemente; también: justamente, con equidad
8	**Vendors**	proveedores, vendedores
9	**Assessing**	evaluando, valorando, analizando
10	**Outward**	hacia afuera, externo, exterior
11	**Upward**	hacia arriba, ascendente
12	**Inward**	hacia adentro, interno, interior
13	**Boundary**	límite, frontera, borde
14	**Aside**	a un lado, aparte; comentario al margen (aside from = aparte de)
15	**Drop**	gota (sust.); caer, dejar caer, disminuir, abandonar (verbo)
16	**Bark**	ladrido, ladrar; también: corteza (de árbol)
17	**Folks**	gente, personas (informal); también: padres, familia
18	**Kettle**	tetera, hervidor de agua, pava
19	**Pick up**	recoger, levantar; pasar a buscar; aprender rápidamente; contestar el teléfono
20	**Bear**	oso (sust.); soportar, aguantar, llevar, dar a luz (bear - bore - borne)
21	**Concerns**	preocupaciones, inquietudes; concernir, atañer
22	**Plunge**	zambullirse, sumergirse; desplomarse, caer en picada; zambullida
23	**Enterprise**	empresa, compañía; emprendimiento, iniciativa; empresarial
24	**Unwise**	imprudente, poco sensato, desaconsejable

25	**Cobber**	amigo, compañero, "colega" (jerga australiana/neozelandesa)
26	**Kangaroo**	canguro
27	**Hooroo**	adiós, hasta luego, chao (jerga australiana informal)
28	**Shrink**	encoger(se), reducir(se), disminuir; psiquiatra o psicólogo (informal)
29	**Back down**	echarse atrás, ceder, dar marcha atrás, retractarse
30	**Rewording**	reformulación, reescritura; expresar algo con otras palabras
31	**Spurious**	falso, espurio, engañoso, sin fundamento
32	**Hazardous**	peligroso, arriesgado, nocivo
33	**Harms**	daños, perjuicios (sust.); daña, perjudica (verbo)
34	**Trial**	juicio (legal); prueba, ensayo; dificultad, adversidad
35	**Eliciting**	obteniendo, provocando, suscitando (información o una reacción)
36	**Purported**	supuesto, presunto, alegado
37	**Mockup**	maqueta, prototipo, boceto, modelo a escala
38	**Seashore**	orilla del mar, costa, litoral
39	**Seabed**	lecho marino, fondo del mar, fondo oceánico
40	**Vessels**	embarcaciones, buques, naves; recipientes; vasos sanguíneos
41	**Wrap it up**	terminar, concluir, cerrar; también literal: envolverlo
42	**Fish fights**	disputas pesqueras, conflictos por la pesca
43	**Windscreen**	parabrisas (inglés británico/australiano; en EE. UU.: windshield)
44	**Bulb**	bombilla, foco (de luz); bulbo (de planta)
45	**Waiter**	mesero, camarero, mozo
46	**Solely**	únicamente, solamente, exclusivamente
47	**Pitfalls**	trampas, escollos, obstáculos, riesgos ocultos
48	**Cannonball**	bala de cañón; clavado "en bomba"
332	**Stack**	pila, montón (de cosas ordenadas una sobre otra); apilar, amontonar; conjunto de tecnologías de un proyecto (tech stack); estructura de datos LIFO en programación; chimenea industrial alta; estanterías de una biblioteca (the stacks); "stacks of" = montones de, un montón de; "stack up" = acumularse, compararse con algo; "stack the deck" = amañar las cartas, hacer trampa

333	**Waterproof**	impermeable, a prueba de agua (adjetivo: waterproof jacket, waterproof watch); impermeabilizar, hacer resistente al agua (verbo: to waterproof the boots); matiz: waterproof = no deja pasar el agua en absoluto, water-resistant / water-repellent = solo resiste salpicaduras o lluvia ligera; en contexto militar aparece en equipo de campaña (waterproof bag, waterproof cover); mismo patrón que bulletproof, fireproof, soundproof, foolproof
334	**Basement**	sótano (piso de una casa o edificio que queda bajo el nivel de la calle, usado como bodega, lavandería o cuarto extra: the boiler is in the basement); planta baja subterránea de tiendas y grandes almacenes (bargain basement = sección de ofertas, y por extensión "de saldo", muy barato: bargain-basement prices); matiz: basement = sótano habitable o de uso general; cellar = sótano de almacenamiento, sobre todo de vino o comida (wine cellar); en jerga de fútbol americano / béisbol, "in the basement" = en el último lugar de la tabla; no confundir con "base" (base militar) ni con "foundation" (cimientos)
335	**Pull up**	Llegar; aparecer (llegar en un vehículo y detenerse: «A taxi pulled up outside»); acercar algo (una silla: «pull up a chair»); abrir o mostrar algo en una pantalla (an email, a file); detenerse; hacer un pull-up (dominada) en ejercicio
336	**Pull out**	Retirarse; sacar; abandonar un acuerdo, proyecto o competencia («They pulled out of the deal»); retirar tropas de una zona (uso militar); salir un vehículo de su lugar a la vía; extraer (a tooth, a gun)
337	**Pull off**	Lograr algo difícil (registro informal: «He pulled off a surprise win»); quitarse algo de un tirón (boots, a jacket); salir de la carretera hacia un lado
338	**Pull through**	Salir adelante; sobrevivir o recuperarse de una enfermedad grave o una crisis («The patient pulled through»); ayudar a alguien a superar algo («Her friends pulled her through»)
339	**Pull away**	Alejarse; arrancar y apartarse un vehículo del lugar donde estaba («The bus pulled away»); apartarse bruscamente de alguien; sacar ventaja en una carrera o competencia («She pulled away from the pack»)
340	**Pull over**	Orillar el carro; detenerse al costado de la vía («The police pulled him over»); hacer que un conductor se detenga (uso policial)
341	**Pull back**	Echarse para atrás; retroceder o retirarse (tropas); replegarse; reducir la participación o el gasto en algo («The company pulled back on expansion»); recuperar posiciones en un juego o negocio

342	**Fellowship**	Compañerismo, camaradería: el vínculo entre quienes comparten algo («the fellowship of soldiers»); beca de investigación o de posgrado, normalmente para graduados («he won a research fellowship»); en medicina, la subespecialidad que se hace después de la residencia; agrupación o hermandad de personas con un interés común (también con matiz religioso: congregación, comunidad de fieles)
343	**Dirty**	Sucio, mugroso («dirty boots», «dirty dishes»); como verbo, ensuciar («don't dirty your uniform»); deshonesto, tramposo: juego sucio o trampa («a dirty trick», «he plays dirty»); obsceno, grosero, de doble sentido («a dirty joke», «dirty words»); en «a dirty look», mirada de reproche o de desprecio; en «the dirty work», el trabajo pesado o desagradable que nadie quiere hacer, a menudo el turbio que otro delega
344	**Ajar**	Entreabierto, entornado: dicho de una puerta o ventana que quedó apenas abierta, no del todo cerrada («the door was ajar», «leave the window ajar»); matiz: se usa casi solo con door/window/gate y va después del verbo (posición predicativa), no antes del sustantivo: se dice «the door is ajar», no «an ajar door»; para dejarla así, «leave it ajar»; en sentido figurado, «to leave the door ajar» = dejar la puerta entreabierta, es decir, mantener abierta una posibilidad o una negociación; no confundir con «afar» (a lo lejos, «from afar»)
345	**Warm**	Tibio, templado, cálido: temperatura agradable, entre «cool» y «hot» («warm water», «a warm day»); ojo con el matiz, «warm» no es «caliente» (eso es «hot») ni «frío»; de la ropa, abrigado, que da calor («warm clothes», «a warm coat»); de una persona o un recibimiento, afectuoso, cordial, caluroso («a warm welcome», «a warm smile», «warm regards» al cerrar una carta); de los colores, cálido (rojos, naranjas, amarillos); como verbo, calentar o entibiar algo sin llegar a hervir («warm the soup»), y «warm up» = calentar comida, calentar antes de entrenar o de un examen, o ir entrando en confianza («he warmed up to the idea»); en juegos, «you're getting warm» = «caliente, caliente», estás cerca de adivinar; derivados útiles: «warmth» (calidez, calor), «lukewarm» (tibio, y en figurado, poco entusiasta: «a lukewarm response»), «warm-hearted» (de buen corazón)

346	**Lazy**	Perezoso, flojo, haragán: de una persona que evita el esfuerzo («a lazy student», «don't be lazy»); matiz: es una crítica, no un descriptor neutro, y en Colombia equivale a «perezoso/flojo»; de un trabajo o razonamiento, descuidado, hecho sin esfuerzo («lazy thinking», «a lazy translation»); de un rato o un día, tranquilo y sin prisa, con matiz positivo («a lazy Sunday afternoon», «lazy days of summer»); de un río o movimiento, lento y pausado («the lazy river»); en informática, «lazy evaluation» / «lazy loading» = evaluación o carga perezosa, se calcula solo cuando hace falta (opuesto: «eager»); expresiones: «a lazybones» = un flojo, un vago; «bone idle» = flojo de remate (más fuerte, británico); «the lazy man's way» = el camino fácil; derivados: «laziness» (pereza), «lazily» (con pereza, sin prisa)
347	**Tent**	Carpa, tienda de campaña: refugio de tela que se arma con varillas y vientos («we pitched a tent», «a two-man tent»); el verbo para armarla es «pitch a tent» o «set up a tent», y para desarmarla «take down / strike a tent» (en el ALCPT sale mucho en contextos de campaña y maniobras); en el campo militar, «tent city» = campamento de carpas montado para alojar tropa o damnificados, y «tent peg / tent stake» = estaca, «guy rope» = viento o tirante, «tent pole» = varilla o parante; también la carpa grande de una feria o un circo («the big tent»), y de ahí el sentido figurado «big tent» = movimiento o partido amplio que acoge posturas distintas; como verbo, acampar («they tented by the river») o formar una figura de triángulo con algo («he tented his fingers»); en medicina y construcción, «tenting» = cubrir o fumigar algo con una lona; ojo: en español «tienda» a secas es «shop/store», la de acampar es «tent»

B. Vocabulario extraído del Form 62

49	**Airmen**	aviadores, personal de la fuerza aérea
50	**Club (militar)**	club social de una base (NCO Club, Officers' Club)
51	**Kerosene**	queroseno (combustible para estufas y lámparas)
52	**Heater**	calentador, calefactor, estufa
53	**Ashes**	cenizas
54	**Absent**	ausente (to be absent = faltar, no asistir)
55	**Disrupt**	interrumpir, alterar, perturbar
56	**Piece**	pedazo, trozo, porción
57	**Just as**	justo cuando, en el mismo momento en que
58	**Sleeves**	mangas (de una prenda)
59	**Trousers**	pantalones

60	**Slacks**	pantalones de vestir informales
61	**Slip**	resbalar(se), perder el equilibrio
62	**Sidewalk**	acera, vereda, banqueta
63	**Icy**	helado, cubierto de hielo
64	**Paved**	pavimentado
65	**Traction**	tracción, agarre
66	**A bit**	un poco, un poquito (cuantificador idiomático)
67	**Shift**	cambiar de dirección, desplazarse; turno de trabajo
68	**Rumor**	rumor, información no confirmada
69	**Unconfirmed**	no confirmado, sin verificar
70	**Scuttlebutt**	chisme, rumor (jerga militar/naval)
71	**Airbase**	base aérea
72	**Separately**	por separado, individualmente
73	**Divided up**	dividido, repartido en partes
74	**Tear (tore, torn)**	rasgar, romper (tela o papel)
75	**Rip**	desgarrar, rasgar (sinónimo de tear)
76	**Fence**	cerca, valla, cerco
77	**Soiled**	ensuciado, manchado
78	**Wrinkled**	arrugado
79	**Disregard**	ignorar, hacer caso omiso de, desatender
80	**Stand for**	significar, representar, simbolizar
81	**Trailer**	remolque, tráiler
82	**Haul**	transportar, acarrear (carga pesada)
83	**Freight**	carga, flete, mercancía
84	**Drain**	drenar, desaguar
85	**Fall apart**	desarmarse, caerse a pedazos
86	**Brand new**	nuevo, recién estrenado, flamante
87	**Disrepair**	mal estado, deterioro
88	**Controversial**	controvertido, polémico
89	**Anger (to)**	enojar, enfurecer, indignar
90	**Deep water**	aguas profundas

91	**Thick forest**	bosque espeso, bosque denso
92	**Chaplain**	capellán (oficial a cargo del bienestar espiritual)
93	**Service**	servicio religioso, oficio; también: servicio militar
94	**Chapel**	capilla
95	**Abrupt**	abrupto, repentino, brusco
96	**Sudden**	repentino, súbito
97	**Ending**	final, desenlace
98	**At all**	en absoluto, para nada (intensifica la negación)
99	**Printing**	impresión (gerundio usado como sustantivo)
100	**Keep (someone) up**	mantener despierto a alguien
101	**About to**	a punto de
102	**Marry**	casarse (con)
103	**NCO (Non-Commissioned Officer)**	suboficial
104	**Expect**	esperar, exigir, prever
105	**Fine**	fino, delgado (además de "bien")
106	**Thread**	hilo
107	**Sew**	coser
108	**Thin**	delgado, fino
109	**Deliver / delivered**	entregar, repartir a domicilio
110	**Newsstand**	quiosco de periódicos
111	**Worse**	peor (comparativo de bad; superlativo: worst)
112	**Mud**	barro, lodo
113	**Whooping crane**	grulla trompetera (ave en peligro)
114	**Diminishing**	disminuyendo, mermando
115	**Torn up**	roto, hecho pedazos
116	**A piece at a time**	de a un pedazo, por partes
117	**Statement**	declaración, afirmación
118	**Train station**	estación de tren
119	**Theater**	teatro
120	**Spray paint**	pintar con aerosol

C. Vocabulario extraído del Form 50

121	**For good**	para siempre, definitivamente (modismo)
122	**For the time being**	por el momento, por ahora
123	**Temporarily**	temporalmente, provisionalmente
124	**Permanently**	permanentemente, de forma definitiva
125	**In a hurry**	con prisa, apurado
126	**Foggy**	con niebla, neblinoso
127	**Fog**	niebla
128	**Haze**	bruma, calima (polvo o partículas en el aire)
129	**Dust**	polvo
130	**Steady breeze**	brisa constante
131	**Repel / repelled**	repeler, rechazar (un ataque)
132	**Fight off**	repeler, rechazar, combatir
133	**Reinforce**	reforzar (agregar personal o equipo)
134	**Retreat**	retirarse, replegarse
135	**Assault**	asalto, ataque
136	**Work out**	resolver, solucionar (un problema)
137	**Solve**	resolver
138	**Thunder shower**	chubasco con truenos, aguacero eléctrico
139	**Thunder**	trueno
140	**Lightning**	relámpago, rayo
141	**Storm**	tormenta
142	**Hole / whole**	agujero / entero (homófonos)
143	**Dig (dug, dug)**	cavar, excavar
144	**Filling**	empaste (dental); relleno
145	**Cavity**	caries, cavidad (en un diente)
146	**Decay**	caries, deterioro; descomponerse
147	**Dentist**	dentista
148	**Cartoons**	caricaturas, tiras cómicas; dibujos animados
149	**Headlines**	titulares (de prensa)
150	**Drawings**	dibujos

151	**Dense**	denso, espeso
152	**Thick**	grueso, espeso, denso
153	**Sea level**	nivel del mar
154	**Altitude**	altitud
155	**Spread out**	extender, desplegar, abrir (un mapa)
156	**Fold**	doblar, plegar
157	**Mark**	marcar, señalar
158	**Inspect**	inspeccionar, examinar, revisar
159	**Oxygen mask**	máscara de oxígeno
160	**Cadet**	cadete
161	**Guilty**	culpable
162	**Innocent**	inocente
163	**Charge**	cargo, acusación; también: cobrar, cargar
164	**Verdict**	veredicto
165	**Fine**	multa (además de "fino/bien")
166	**Sentenced to prison**	condenado a prisión
167	**Efficient**	eficiente
168	**Supervise**	supervisar
169	**Complain**	quejarse
170	**In all / Altogether**	en total, en conjunto
171	**Zoo**	zoológico
172	**Take up**	empezar (una actividad, afición o profesión)
173	**Medicine**	medicina
174	**Lay (laid, laid)**	poner, colocar (en posición horizontal)
175	**Bookcase**	estantería, librero
176	**Bookstore**	librería (tienda)
177	**Alike**	parecidos, similares, iguales
178	**Wheat**	trigo
179	**Damage**	dañar, perjudicar; daño
180	**Hurt**	lastimar, dañar, doler
181	**Blow down**	derribar, tumbar (el viento)

182	**Crops**	cultivos, cosechas
183	**Opposite**	enfrente de, al lado opuesto de
184	**Across the street**	al otro lado de la calle
185	**Behind**	detrás de
186	**Next to**	junto a, al lado de
187	**Post office**	oficina de correos
188	**Light**	ligero, liviano (además de "luz")
189	**Heavy**	pesado
190	**Handle**	asa, mango; manejar
191	**Lift**	levantar, alzar
192	**Rare (carne)**	poco hecha, jugosa, roja
193	**Roast beef**	rosbif, carne asada
194	**Apple pie**	tarta o pastel de manzana
195	**Chicken noodle soup**	sopa de pollo con fideos
196	**Cold meats**	fiambres, embutidos

D. Vocabulario extraído del Form 63

197	**Issued**	de dotación, entregado oficialmente (issued gear, issued ID cards)
198	**Provided that**	siempre que, a condición de que (conector condicional formal)
199	**Finicky**	quisquilloso, maniático, remilgado
200	**Tell time**	leer la hora en un reloj; ojo: NO se dice "say the time"
201	**Get in**	llegar (un vuelo, tren o autobús a su destino)
202	**Get by**	arreglárselas, ir tirando, apañárselas
203	**Honoree**	homenajeado, galardonado (sufijo -ee: quien recibe la acción)
204	**Stub**	talón, resguardo (de un boleto o entrada)

E. Vocabulario extraído del Form 69

205	**Make up (a bed)**	tender la cama, hacer la cama (colocar sábanas y mantas)
206	**Eventually**	finalmente, con el tiempo, tarde o temprano; FALSO AMIGO: no es "eventualmente"
207	**Drizzle**	llovizna; lloviznar

208	**Sleet**	aguanieve, cellisca (mezcla de lluvia y nieve o granizo fino)
209	**Befuddled**	aturdido, confundido, hecho un lío
210	**Baffling**	desconcertante, incomprensible
211	**Obsolete**	obsoleto, en desuso
212	**Give (someone) a shot**	poner una inyección; inject = inyectar
213	**Lubricate**	lubricar, engrasar (mantenimiento mecánico)
214	**Bare (head)**	descubierto, sin cubrir (bare head = sin gorra ni casco)
215	**Cover (militar)**	cubrecabeza, gorra reglamentaria; "uncovered" = sin gorra
216	**Add up to / amount to**	sumar un total de, ascender a (una cantidad)

F. Vocabulario extraído del Form 70

217	**Lumber**	madera aserrada, tablas, maderamen (lumber company = maderera)
218	**Moisture**	humedad (causa de óxido y corrosión en el equipo)
219	**Tear down**	desmontar, desarmar por completo (un motor o unidad, para revisarlo)
220	**Steer**	gobernar, timonear, dirigir (una embarcación o vehículo)
221	**Run short of**	quedarse corto de, irse quedando sin (dinero, provisiones)
222	**Nothing but**	nada más que, solamente (nothing but the truth = solo la verdad)
223	**Attorney**	abogado (AmE); attorney at law = letrado
224	**Bivouac**	vivac, campamento provisional sin instalaciones; vivaquear
225	**Carve**	trinchar (la carne); tallar, esculpir
226	**Safe**	caja fuerte (sustantivo); no confundir con el adjetivo "seguro"
227	**Take charge**	hacerse cargo, tomar el mando
228	**Wind up**	concluir, rematar, terminar (un trabajo); dar cuerda a un reloj
229	**Pallid**	pálido, desvaído; soso, sin brillo (de una actuación)
230	**Detain**	detener, retener bajo custodia (uso legal y militar)
231	**Loosen**	aflojar (una tuerca, un tornillo); antónimo de tighten
232	**Come off**	soltarse, desprenderse, salirse (una pieza)
233	**Nut**	tuerca (mecánica); también nuez
234	**Boast**	alardear, fanfarronear, presumir de algo (boast about/of)
235	**Exploits**	hazañas, proezas, gestas

236	**Distort**	distorsionar, tergiversar, deformar
237	**Utter (verbo)**	pronunciar, proferir, emitir (una palabra o sonido)
238	**Impart**	impartir, transmitir, comunicar (conocimiento, información)

G. Vocabulario extraído del Form 71

239	**Expressway**	autopista, vía rápida (AmE); sinónimo de freeway

H. Vocabulario extraído del Form 73

240	**Make up one's mind**	decidirse, tomar una decisión
241	**Bellboy**	botones, mozo de hotel
242	**Pen**	corral, redil, cercado para animales; no confundir con "pin"
243	**In the open**	a la intemperie, al raso, sin techo ni tienda de campaña
244	**Watchman**	vigilante, sereno, guarda
245	**Blinking / flashing**	intermitente, que parpadea (una luz de señalización)
246	**Steady (luz)**	fija, continua, sin parpadeo (opuesto a flashing)
247	**Bend**	curva, recodo (de una carretera); doblar, torcer
248	**Small print**	letra pequeña, letra chica (de un contrato)
249	**Head first**	de cabeza (lanzarse de cabeza al agua); dive = zambullirse
250	**Rush through**	despachar a toda prisa, tramitar con urgencia (un pedido)
251	**Level**	nivelado, horizontal, a nivel; nivel de burbuja
252	**Tilted**	inclinado, ladeado
253	**Slanted**	sesgado, en pendiente, oblicuo
254	**Break away**	zafarse, desprenderse, separarse (de un grupo o una sujeción)
255	**Encircle**	rodear, cercar, envolver (uso táctico)
256	**Spoiled (child)**	malcriado, consentido, mimado
257	**Overindulged**	consentido en exceso, sobreprotegido
258	**Barricade**	barricada, barrera, valla de contención; levantar una barricada
259	**Puffy**	hinchado, abotargado (ojos, cara)
260	**Swollen**	hinchado, inflamado (participio de swell)
261	**Heel**	talón (del pie); tacón (del zapato)
262	**Dull**	aburrido, soso; romo, sin filo; apagado (un color)

263	**Count on**	contar con, confiar en (alguien)
264	**Leap over**	saltar por encima de, franquear de un salto
265	**Tarnished**	empañado, deslustrado, ennegrecido (metal, plata)
266	**Discolored**	descolorido, decolorado, manchado

I. Vocabulario extraído del Form 75

267	**Pile (up)**	amontonar, apilar; montón, pila
268	**Goof**	meter la pata, pifiarla (jerga); goof off = holgazanear
269	**Gamble**	apostar, jugar por dinero; arriesgarse
270	**Keep up with**	seguir el ritmo de, mantenerse a la altura de
271	**Dispose of**	deshacerse de, desechar (formal, técnico)
272	**Raze**	arrasar, demoler hasta los cimientos
273	**Demolition crew**	cuadrilla de demolición
274	**Skip**	saltarse, omitir (skip a meal = saltarse una comida)
275	**Cantankerous**	cascarrabias, malhumorado, pendenciero
276	**Mean (adj.)**	malintencionado, mezquino, antipático; NO significa "medio"
277	**Fumes**	gases tóxicos, humos, vapores (de un motor)
278	**Vent**	respiradero, rejilla de ventilación, conducto de escape

J. Vocabulario extraído del Form 82

279	**Splice**	empalmar, unir (cables, cuerdas); empalme
280	**Take over**	asumir el mando, hacerse cargo, tomar el control
281	**Assume command**	asumir el mando (fórmula militar)
282	**Swanky**	elegante, lujoso, de postín (informal)
283	**Have a screw loose**	faltarle un tornillo, estar mal de la cabeza (idiom)
284	**Splinter**	astilla; astillarse; splinter group = grupo escindido
285	**Extract**	extraer, sacar (una astilla, una muela)
286	**Surveillance**	vigilancia, seguimiento (under surveillance = bajo vigilancia)
287	**Antifreeze**	anticongelante (aditivo del radiador)
288	**In way over one's head**	estar sobrepasado, quedar muy por encima de tu capacidad
289	**Be out of (gas)**	quedarse sin (gasolina, provisiones)

290	**Hold up**	retrasar, demorar; también atracar, asaltar
291	**Unveil**	descubrir, develar (una estatua, un plan)
292	**Appraise**	tasar, valorar, peritar; no confundir con apprise (informar)
293	**Scared to death**	muerto de miedo, aterrado (hipérbole)

K. Vocabulario extraído del Form 87

294	**Rule of thumb**	regla general, criterio práctico
295	**Outfit**	conjunto de ropa, atuendo
296	**Concentrate (troops)**	concentrar, agrupar (tropas)
297	**Dismiss**	dar permiso para salir; despedir, expulsar
298	**Thrown out**	expulsado, echado
299	**Hardships**	penurias, adversidades, dificultades
300	**Pester**	fastidiar, importunar, molestar insistentemente
301	**Dud**	cartucho fallido, algo que no funciona ni detona
302	**Firecrackers**	petardos, cohetes
303	**Terrestrial**	terrestre
304	**Overturn**	volcarse, dar vuelta
305	**Upside down**	boca abajo, al revés
306	**Unconscious**	inconsciente, sin conocimiento
307	**Inconsolable**	inconsolable
308	**Right away**	de inmediato, ahora mismo
309	**Fasten**	abrochar, sujetar, atar
310	**Shoelaces**	cordones de zapato
311	**A good Joe / a good fellow**	buen tipo, buena gente (informal)
312	**Okay (verbo)**	aprobar, autorizar
313	**Expenditure**	gasto, desembolso
314	**Cover the costs**	cubrir los gastos
315	**Irrigate**	irrigar, regar
316	**Toot**	pitar, tocar el claxon o una bocina
317	**Whisper**	susurrar
318	**Counterattack**	contraatacar

319	**Surrender**	rendirse
320	**Give up**	rendirse, darse por vencido
321	**Sore (throat)**	dolorido, irritado (garganta)
322	**Gloves**	guantes
323	**Lack (to)**	carecer de, faltar
324	**Take along**	llevar consigo, llevarse a alguien
325	**Brag**	fanfarronear, presumir (sinónimo de boast)
326	**Discouraged**	desanimado, desalentado (pérdida de moral)
327	**The cleaner's**	la tintorería, la lavandería
328	**Greasy**	grasiento, aceitoso
329	**Parade**	desfile, formación; desfilar

L. Vocabulario extraído de Technical & Action Verbs

330	**Surplus (verbo)**	dar de baja por excedente, declarar material sobrante
331	**Hold back**	retener, contener, frenar; ocultar información

Parte II · Phrasal verbs de los formularios 50 a 87

Los phrasal verbs son la trampa clásica del ALCPT para un hispanohablante: el significado casi nunca se deduce de las partes. «Wind up» no tiene nada que ver con viento, y «hold up» puede ser retrasar o atracar. Todos los que están aquí aparecieron de verdad en los formularios 50 a 87, con la frase textual del examen.

• La partícula manda: agrupados por partícula porque cada una carga un sentido bastante estable.

• Separables: el objeto puede ir en medio (tear the unit down). Si el objeto es un pronombre, TIENE que ir en medio: tear it down, nunca tear down it.

• Inseparables: el objeto va siempre después (count on me, nunca count me on).

• Los de tres palabras (keep up with, look forward to) nunca se separan.

• Ojo con las que se parecen sin serlo (take place, run short of, tell time): son verbo + sustantivo o modismos fijos. Están en la sección de idioms.

UP

Terminar, completar, llevar algo hasta el final. También aumentar o juntar.

wind up **[SEPARABLE]**
concluir, rematar, dar por terminado

Nada que ver con «viento». Su otro sentido es dar cuerda a un reloj.

"When will Ray wind up the job?" *Form 70 #93, Form 75 #93*

add up to **[INSEPARABLE (3 PALABRAS)]**
sumar un total de, ascender a

Sin «to» significa solo «cuadrar, tener sentido»: it doesn't add up.

"The things I bought added up to $17.50." *Form 69 #93*

add up **[SEPARABLE]**
sumar, totalizar

Ojo con el distractor «add down», que no existe en inglés.

"The waiter added up the cost of the food and drinks." *Form 75 #95*

make up (a bed) **[SEPARABLE]**
tender la cama, arreglarla con sábanas y mantas

No es lavarla ni fabricarla. En cuartel es tarea diaria de revista.

"We had already made up our beds." *Form 69 #36*

make up one's mind **[FIJO]**
decidirse, tomar una decisión

Mismo verbo que el anterior, sentido totalmente distinto.

"Have you made up your mind about which car you want?" *Form 73 #3*

set up **[SEPARABLE]**
montar, armar, instalar; establecer

Para una tienda de campaña también sirve «put up».

"Why did the police set up a barricade?" *Form 73 #55, Form 63 #91*

hold up **[SEPARABLE]**

retrasar, demorar; también atracar, asaltar

Dos sentidos opuestos en tono. El literal, «sostener», casi nunca es la respuesta.

"What's holding up the movie?" *Form 82 #89*

keep up with **[INSEPARABLE (3 PALABRAS)]**

seguir el ritmo de, mantenerse a la altura de

No es «mantener». Implica ir al mismo paso que alguien.

"John could not keep up with me." *Form 75 #91*

take up **[SEPARABLE]**

empezar a estudiar o practicar algo; ocupar espacio o tiempo

«Take up medicine» es ponerse a estudiar medicina, no tomar un medicamento.

"He is going to take up medicine this year." *Form 50 #34*

OFF · AWAY

Separarse, desprenderse, quitar de en medio. La idea base es alejamiento.

come off **[INSEPARABLE]**

soltarse, desprenderse, salirse (una pieza)

Es lo que pasa solo, no lo que uno hace. Si tú lo quitas, es «take off».

"When you loosen this nut, it will come off." *Form 70 #98*

give off **[SEPARABLE]**

despedir, emitir (gases, olor, calor)

No es «regalar» (eso es give away). Muy usado en mecánica y seguridad.

"The engines give off poisonous fumes." *Form 75 #100*

throw away **[SEPARABLE]**

botar, desechar, tirar a la basura

Su sinónimo formal y técnico es «dispose of».

"The engine part was thrown away." *Form 75 #92*

dispose of **[INSEPARABLE]**

deshacerse de, desechar (formal)

Sin «of» cambia por completo: «dispose» solo es disponer o predisponer.

"The engine part was disposed of." *Form 75 #92*

break away (from) **[INSEPARABLE]**

zafarse, desprenderse, separarse de un grupo

No es romper nada: es soltarse de una sujeción o de una multitud.

"He broke away from the crowd." *Form 73 #53*

take away **[SEPARABLE]**

quitar, llevarse, retirar

Contrasta con «take along», que es llevar consigo a alguien.

"The man extended his hand… (contrast item)" *Form 70 #39*

OUT

Sacar hacia afuera, extraer. También agotarse por completo.

take out **[SEPARABLE]**

sacar, extraer (una astilla, una muela)

Su equivalente formal y médico es «extract».

"The doctor had to take the splinter out." *Form 82 #50*

run out of **[INSEPARABLE (3 PALABRAS)]**

quedarse sin, agotársele a uno algo

El sujeto es quien se queda sin: we ran out of gas, no the gas ran out of us.

"We're out of gas." *Form 82*

watch out for **[INSEPARABLE (3 PALABRAS)]**

tener cuidado con, estar pendiente de un peligro

No es mirar: es una advertencia de seguridad. «Look at» nunca es la respuesta.

"Watch out for speeding cars on the expressway." *Form 71 #93*

rush through **[SEPARABLE]**

despachar a toda prisa, tramitar con urgencia

Fíjate cómo el objeto va EN MEDIO: rush this order through.

"Rush this order through." *Form 73 #50*

OVER

Pasar por encima o de un lado a otro. De ahí: asumir el control, revisar de punta a punta, excederse.

take over **[SEPARABLE]**

asumir el mando, hacerse cargo, tomar el control

En contexto militar equivale a «assume command».

"General Adams took over yesterday." *Form 82 #46*

leap over **[INSEPARABLE]**

saltar por encima de, franquear de un salto

Literal, sin sorpresa; el distractor «climbed into» sí cambia el sentido.

"The deer leaped over the fence." *Form 73 #93, Form 82 #91*

watch over **[INSEPARABLE]**

cuidar, velar por, vigilar a alguien

No confundir con «watch out for», que es cuidarse de un peligro.

"Marge watched over her child throughout the night." *Form 82 #85*

check over **[SEPARABLE]**

revisar a fondo, inspeccionar por completo

Más minucioso que un simple «check».

"He told Smith to check over his jeep." *Form 87 #40*

be in over one's head **[FIJO]**

estar sobrepasado, quedar muy por encima de tu capacidad

Imagen de agua por encima de la cabeza. Nada que ver con inteligencia.

"I'm in way over my head in that class." *Form 82 #65*

DOWN · BACK

Bajar, desarmar, reducir. Con «back», retener o echarse atrás.

tear down **[SEPARABLE]**

desmontar, desarmar por completo (un motor, una unidad)

En mantenimiento no es destruir: es despiezar para revisar. Lo contrario es «assemble».

"When will you tear down the unit?" *Form 70 #53*

blow down **[SEPARABLE]**

derribar, tumbar (el viento)

Aparece como distractor frente a «damage»: derribar es un tipo de daño, no un sinónimo.

"The wind blew down the wheat." *Form 50*

hold back **[SEPARABLE]**

retener, contener, frenar; ocultar información

Contrario a «hold up» (retrasar) aunque se parezcan.

"held back" *Technical & Action Verbs #10*

write down **[SEPARABLE]**

anotar, apuntar por escrito

Distractor de «obey»: anotar una orden no es cumplirla.

"He obeyed all the orders he was given." *Technical & Action Verbs #9*

back down **[INSEPARABLE]**

echarse atrás, recular, ceder en una postura

No es retroceder físicamente; eso es «back up» o «move back».

"(registrado en el vocabulario del Form 62)" *Form 62*

ON · IN · FOR · ALONG · TOGETHER · APART

Partículas sueltas cuyo sentido depende más del verbo que las acompaña.

count on **[INSEPARABLE]**

contar con, confiar en alguien

Nada que ver con contar números. «Count for» es otra cosa: valer, importar.

"You can count on me." *Form 73 #82*

stand for **[INSEPARABLE]**

significar, representar; también tolerar

No es estar de pie. En mensajes cifrados es «equivaler a».

"Every number stands for a letter." *Form 62 #53*

get in **[INSEPARABLE]**

llegar (un vuelo, tren o autobús a su destino)

Compara: get over = recuperarse, get up = levantarse, get by = arreglárselas.

"What time does the flight get in?" *Form 63 #99*

give up **[SEPARABLE]**

rendirse, entregarse; abandonar algo

En contexto militar es «surrender», el opuesto exacto de defenderse.

"The enemy in the village gave up." *Form 87 #39*

come together **[INSEPARABLE]**

concentrarse, reunirse en un punto

Es el sentido de «concentrate» aplicado a tropas: agruparlas, no enfocarse.

"The troops are being concentrated in this area." *Form 87 #31*

take along **[SEPARABLE]**

llevar consigo, llevarse a alguien

«Take around» sería pasearlo o mostrarle el lugar, no acompañarlo.

"Mary can go to the movies if she takes her little brother along." *Form 87 #89*

get along (with) **[INSEPARABLE]**

llevarse bien con alguien

Aparece explicando qué es «a good Joe»: alguien con quien es fácil llevarse.

"The new supervisor is a good Joe." *Form 87 #64*

look forward to **[INSEPARABLE (3 PALABRAS)]**

esperar algo con ganas, tener ilusión por

El «to» es preposición: va seguido de -ing, nunca de infinitivo. Looking forward to seeing, no to see.

"I'm looking forward to seeing my family." *Form 73 #23*

look after **[INSEPARABLE]**

cuidar de, ocuparse de alguien

Familia traicionera: look like = parecerse, look for = buscar, look at = mirar.

"Margaret looks like her father. (look after es el distractor)" *Form 73 #25*

fall apart **[INSEPARABLE]**

desarmarse, caerse a pedazos, deteriorarse

También sirve para planes o personas: the plan fell apart.

"David's car is ready to fall apart." *Form 62 #55*

Parte III · Idioms y expresiones militares

Dos frentes que el ALCPT castiga sin piedad. Los idioms, porque su significado no está en las palabras: «a good Joe» no habla de nadie llamado Joe. Y el léxico militar, porque el examen está escrito para personal de la fuerza y da por sabidas cosas como «sick call» o «tear down the unit». Todo lo de aquí salió de los formularios 50 a 87, con la frase textual del examen.

• Muchas de estas palabras ya están en el diccionario numerado. Aquí vuelven agrupadas por uso y con la frase del examen, que es como de verdad se fijan.

• En los idioms nunca traduzcas palabra por palabra: busca la idea completa.

• El léxico militar suele tener un sentido corriente y otro de servicio: «cover» es tapar, pero también el cubrecabeza reglamentario.

Idioms y expresiones

Expresiones fijas cuyo significado no se deduce de las palabras sueltas. Se agrupan por lo que expresan, que es como suelen preguntarse.

Tiempo y urgencia

Cuándo pasa algo y con cuánta prisa. Es de lo más preguntado en las secciones de comprensión.

right away **[MUY FRECUENTE]**
de inmediato, ahora mismo, sin demora
«Right» aquí no es «derecha» ni «correcto»: es un intensificador. «Go to the right» sería otra cosa.
“Go to sick call right away.” *Form 70 #92, Form 73 #91, Form 87 #61*

at once **[SINÓNIMO DE RIGHT AWAY]**
en el acto, inmediatamente
También puede significar «a la vez», según el contexto: don't all talk at once.
“Go at once.” *Form 70 #92*

in a hurry
con prisa, a las carreras
«Get it out in a hurry» = despáchalo ya, no «sácalo apurado».
“Get it out in a hurry.” *Form 73 #50*

sooner or later
tarde o temprano
Es el equivalente de «eventually», que NO significa «eventualmente».
“Sooner or later another branch will be added.” *Form 69 #49*

for good **[ENGAÑOSO]**
para siempre, definitivamente
Nada que ver con «bueno». Lo contrario es «for the time being», por ahora.
“The student has gone back to his country for good.” *Form 50 #53*

for the time being

por ahora, de momento, provisionalmente

Marca algo temporal; «for good» marca lo permanente.

“(contrasta con for good)” *Form 50*

Cantidad, límite y dificultad

Cuánto hay, cuánto falta y cuándo algo queda grande.

run short of [NO ES PHRASAL VERB]

quedarse corto de, irse quedando sin

Expresión fija: no admite objeto en medio. Distinto de «run out of», que es quedarse sin nada.

“I'm running short of cash this week.” *Form 70 #55*

be in way over one's head

estar totalmente sobrepasado, quedarle a uno grande

Imagen de agua por encima de la cabeza. No habla de inteligencia sino de exceso de exigencia.

“I'm in way over my head in that class.” *Form 82 #65*

a piece at a time

por partes, de a poco, pieza por pieza

Describe el modo, no la cantidad total.

“(registrado en el vocabulario del Form 50)” *Form 50*

in all / altogether

en total, en conjunto

«Altogether» junto es «en total»; «all together» separado es «todos juntos».

“(registrado en el vocabulario del Form 50)” *Form 50*

Cómo es una persona

Juicios sobre el carácter de alguien. Casi siempre informales.

a good Joe [JERGA]

buen tipo, buena gente, alguien con quien es fácil llevarse

No existe ningún Joe. Es un nombre genérico para «un fulano cualquiera», y en positivo es un elogio.

“Everyone says that the new supervisor is a good Joe.” *Form 87 #64*

have a screw loose [INFORMAL]

faltarle un tornillo, estar mal de la cabeza

Metáfora de máquina con una pieza floja. Es informal y algo despectivo, no un diagnóstico.

“I think Robert has a screw loose.” *Form 82 #49*

get along with

llevarse bien con alguien

Sin «with» significa «ir tirando, arreglárselas».

“…is friendly, kind and easy to get along with.” *Form 87 #64*

Estados, reacciones y modo

Cómo queda alguien o cómo se hace algo.

scared to death [HIPÉRBOLE]

muerto de miedo, aterrado

Nadie se muere: es exageración pura. Mide intensidad, no consecuencia.

"Lawrence scared me to death when he came in." *Form 82 #100*

nothing but

nada más que, únicamente

No es una negación: «nothing but the truth» es SOLO la verdad, no «ninguna verdad».

"You must tell the attorney nothing but the truth." *Form 70 #56*

head first

de cabeza, de cabeza al agua

Describe la postura al entrar, no el orden de llegada. Zambullirse así es «to dive».

"Bob jumped into the water head first." *Form 73 #48*

in the open [USO MILITAR]

a la intemperie, al raso, sin techo

En campaña es dormir sin carpa ni barraca. También «al descubierto», sin secreto.

"Bob slept in the open." *Form 73 #33*

small print

la letra pequeña de un contrato

Literalmente es tipografía diminuta, y de ahí las condiciones que nadie lee.

"Why does he have difficulty reading small print?" *Form 73 #46*

a rule of thumb

una regla general, un criterio práctico

No es una norma escrita ni obligatoria: es lo que la experiencia aconseja.

"This is a general rule for the school." *Form 87 #24*

tell time [COLOCACIÓN FIJA]

leer la hora en un reloj

En español «decir la hora» lleva a «say the time», que suena mal. Es siempre «tell».

"Can the child tell time yet?" *Form 63 #98*

take place [NO ES PHRASAL VERB]

ocurrir, tener lugar, celebrarse

Verbo + sustantivo fijo: no se puede partir. «Take charge» es otra cosa: tomar el mando.

"It happened at 10 o'clock." *Form 70 #91*

take charge [NO ES PHRASAL VERB]

hacerse cargo, tomar el mando

Se confunde con «take place» por empezar igual, pero hablan de cosas distintas.

"(distractor del ítem 91)" *Form 70 #91*

Léxico y expresiones militares

El examen está escrito para personal de la fuerza y da por sabido este vocabulario. Se agrupa por ámbito, como se usa en el servicio.

Mando, disciplina y rutina

Jerarquía, órdenes y vida diaria en la unidad.

sick call [CLAVE]

revista médica, hora de reportarse a enfermería

No es «llamada de enfermo»: es el horario fijo en que el personal pasa a consulta.

“Go to sick call right away.” *Form 70 #92, Form 73 #91*

take over / assume command

asumir el mando, hacerse cargo de la unidad

«Take over» es el término corriente; «assume command» es la fórmula oficial.

“General Adams took over yesterday.” *Form 82 #46*

dismiss / be dismissed [DOBLE SENTIDO]

dar permiso para retirarse; romper filas

En formación es «pueden retirarse», neutro. Fuera de ahí puede ser despedir o expulsar.

“Students will be dismissed from class today.” *Form 87 #33*

NCO (Non-Commissioned Officer) [SIGLA]

suboficial

Se dice deletreada. Es el escalón de mando entre la tropa y los oficiales.

“The NCO expects his men to wear the proper uniform.” *Form 70 #86*

make up a bed [RUTINA]

tender la cama para revista

Tarea diaria de barraca. No es lavarla: es dejarla tensa y presentable.

“We had already made up our beds.” *Form 69 #36*

issued

de dotación, entregado oficialmente por la unidad

«Issued gear» es el equipo que da la fuerza, no el que uno compra.

“The issued ID cards were collected.” *Form 63 #87*

cover / uncovered [ENGAÑOSO]

cubrecabeza reglamentario; ir sin él

«Cover» como sustantivo es la gorra. Entrar a un recinto se hace «uncovered», descubierto.

“His head was bare.” *Form 69 #88*

parade

desfile, formación; desfilar

No es «parada». La parada militar en español corresponde a esto.

“The band led the parade.” *Form 87 #54*

Operaciones y combate

Movimiento de tropas, enfrentamiento y control del terreno.

concentrate troops / come together

concentrar tropas, agruparlas en un punto

«Concentrate» aquí no es «concentrarse mentalmente»: es reunir fuerza en un sitio.

"The troops are being concentrated in this area." *Form 87 #31*

give up / surrender

rendirse, entregarse

«Give up» es el coloquial; «surrender» el formal. Lo opuesto es defenderse o contraatacar.

"The enemy in the village gave up." *Form 87 #39*

counterattack

contraatacar; contraataque

Aparece como distractor de «surrender»: son acciones opuestas.

"(distractor del ítem 39)" *Form 87 #39*

terrestrial [TÉCNICO]

terrestre, de uso en tierra

Del latín «terra». Un «terrestrial weapon» es de tierra, no aéreo ni submarino.

"This weapon is for terrestrial use only." *Form 87 #43*

dud [CLAVE]

cartucho o proyectil que no detonó; algo que falla

Munición sin explotar: peligrosa justamente por seguir activa.

"The firecrackers that Jim gave me were duds." *Form 87 #42*

barricade

barricada, barrera de contención

Se pone para impedir el paso, nunca para facilitarlo.

"Why did the police set up a barricade?" *Form 73 #55*

under surveillance

bajo vigilancia, bajo observación

Vigilar para reunir información, no detener. «Arrested» es otra cosa.

"The police put the man under surveillance." *Form 82 #52*

detain [LEGAL]

detener, retener bajo custodia

Más formal que «arrest» y no implica cargos: es retener.

"Those immigrants will have been detained two months." *Form 70 #95*

Mantenimiento y equipo

Taller, vehículos y material. Vocabulario muy técnico que el examen usa sin explicar.

tear down the unit [CLAVE]
despiezar la unidad, desarmarla por completo
En mantenimiento NO es destruir: es desmontar para revisar. Lo contrario es «assemble».
"When will you tear down the unit?" *Form 70 #53*

splice [TÉCNICO]
empalmar cables o cuerdas; empalme
Unir dos extremos entrelazándolos. Lo opuesto es separarlos.
"The pieces of wire were spliced together." *Form 82 #42*

give off fumes [SEGURIDAD]
despedir gases tóxicos
«Fumes» no es humo (smoke): son vapores químicos, y por eso son venenosos.
"The engines give off poisonous fumes." *Form 75 #100*

antifreeze
anticongelante del radiador
Sin él, el agua se congela y parte el bloque del motor.
"I only had plain water in the radiator last night." *Form 82 #58*

moisture
humedad, causa de óxido y corrosión
El equipo se protege «against moisture»; no es la lluvia, es el vapor de agua.
"Tools should be protected against moisture." *Form 70 #47*

loosen a nut
aflojar una tuerca
Al aflojarla, la pieza «comes off», se suelta sola. Lo contrario es «tighten».
"When you loosen this nut, it will come off." *Form 70 #98*

Información, moral y vida en la base

Lo que circula en la unidad: noticias, rumores, servicios y penurias.

scuttlebutt [JERGA NAVAL]
rumor de cuartel, chisme que corre entre la tropa
Era el bebedero del barco, donde se cotilleaba. Hoy es el rumor mismo.
"(registrado en el vocabulario del Form 62)" *Form 62*

rumor / unconfirmed statement
rumor, versión sin confirmar
Lo contrario de un comunicado oficial: no está verificado.
"Joe heard a rumor that the airbase was going to close." *Form 62 #48, Form 73 #49*

chaplain
capellán de la unidad
Oficia el «service» en la «chapel». Nada que ver con «chaperone».
"(registrado en el vocabulario del Form 62)" *Form 62*

okay the expenditure [ADMINISTRATIVO]

autorizar el gasto, dar el visto bueno al desembolso

«Okay» funciona aquí como verbo: aprobar. «Expenditure» es el gasto autorizado.

“Did the commander okay the expenditure for the party?” *Form 87 #66*

hardships

penurias, adversidades, condiciones duras

En campaña son frío, falta de sueño, agotamiento. No es «dureza» de carácter.

“Our trip was full of hardships.” *Form 87 #36*

bivouac

vivac, campamento provisional sin instalaciones

Se pronuncia «BIV-uac». Puede ser sustantivo o verbo: to bivouac.

“There's a good place over by those big trees.” *Form 70 #65*

weather hazards

riesgos meteorológicos

«Hazard» es peligro potencial, no una señal ni un aviso.

“Sleet and snow are weather hazards.” *Form 69 #81*

airbase

base aérea

Va en una sola palabra. La unidad es «air force base» en registro formal.

“Joe heard a rumor that the airbase was going to close.” *Form 62 #48, Form 73 #49*

Parte IV · Preguntas ALCPT resueltas

Each item below reproduces the question, all answer options, the correct answer and a detailed explanation. This part is written entirely in English on purpose, so that reviewing it doubles as reading practice at test level.

Form 50

16. (Audio item, no printed stem.)

– chicken noodle soup
– rare roast beef
– **apple pie** [CORRECT]
– cold meats

Explanation. A food-vocabulary item. Note that "rare," when applied to meat, means lightly cooked and still red inside, not "unusual."

19. The bank is opposite the post office.

– The bank is on a different street.
– **The bank is across the street from the post office.** [CORRECT]
– The bank is just behind the post office.
– The bank is next to the post office.

Explanation. The preposition "opposite" is used to describe a position on the other side of a particular area, such as a road or a room, facing someone or something else. In urban navigation and giving directions, saying one building is opposite another means they are facing each other, typically separated by a street. "On a different street" is incorrect because "opposite" implies a specific spatial relationship along the same street. The preposition"opposite" is used to describe a position on the other side of a particular area, such as a road or a room, facing someone or something else. In urban navigation and giving directions, saying one building is "opposite" another means they are facing each other, typically separated by a street. "The bank is on a different street." is incorrect because "opposite" implies a specific spatial The bank is next to the post office.

28. The box is light.

– **The box is not heavy.** [CORRECT]
– The box is not hard.
– The light is on.
– It has a handle.

Explanation. In the context of this sentence, the word "light" is an adjective describing weight. It means that the object has little weight and is easy to move or lift. Therefore, saying the box is "not heavy" is the correct paraphrase. "It has a handle" is incorrect because, while a handle might make a box easier to lift, the sentence says nothing about a handle. In the context of the sentence, the word "light" is an adjective describing weight. It means that the object has little weight and is easy to move or lift. Therefore, saying the box is "not heavy" is the correct paraphrased meaning. Understanding physical descriptions is a basic component of English vocabulary tested in the Al cpt.

30. Are they alike?

– **Yes, they look the same.** [CORRECT]
– Yes, I like them.
– Yes, they will go on a trip.

Explanation. The adjective "alike" means having a resemblance or being similar to each other. When asking if two people are alike, the speaker is inquiring whether they share similar physical traits or characteristics. "Yes, I like them" is incorrect because it uses the verb "like" (to enjoy or appreciate), which is a different word entirely. The adjective "alike" means having a resemblance or being similar to each other. When asking if two people are "alike," the speaker is inquiring if they share similar physical traits or characteristics.

32. Where did you put my pencil?

– **I laid it on the bookcase.** [CORRECT]
– I bought it at the bookstore.
– I got it from Miss Bell.

Explanation. The question asks where you put the pencil, seeking the specific location where an object was placed. The verb "laid" is the past tense of "lay," which means to put or place something down horizontally. "On the bookcase" correctly answers the "where" part of the question. "I got it from Miss Bell" is incorrect because it describes the source or origin of the item (from whom) rather than where it was placed. The question asks "where did you put my pencil," seeking the specific location where an object was placed. The verb "laid" is the past tense of "lay," which means to put or place something down horizontally."On the bookcase"correctly answers the "where" part of the question. "I got it from Miss Bell." is incorrect because it describes the source or origin of the item(from whom) rather than where it was placed.

34. He is going to take up medicine this year. What is he going to do?

– **He's going to study medicine.** [CORRECT]
– He's going to continue working as a doctor.

Explanation. The phrasal verb "take up" means to begin a new activity, hobby, or profession. When someone says they are going to take up medicine, it indicates they are starting their path in the medical field, which involves beginning a course of study to become a doctor. "Continue working as a doctor" is incorrect because "take up" implies a new start, whereas continuing suggests he was already doing it. The phrasal verb"take up"means to begin a new activity, hobby, or profession. When someone says are starting their path in the medical field, which involves beginning a course of study to become a doctor. The phrasal verb "take up" means to begin a new activity, hobby, or profession. When someone says are starting their path in the medical field, which involves beginning a course of study to become a doctor.

38. Twenty-five students in all made a trip to the zoo.

– **Altogether, there were 25 students on the trip.** [CORRECT]
– There were 25 trips made to the zoo.
– The students all were 25 years old.
– There were 25 students who called the zoo.

Explanation. The phrase "in all" is an idiomatic expression used to indicate a total count or the entirety of a group. In the original sentence, "25 students in all" means that the total number of students who visited the zoo was 25. The phrase "altogether" is a synonym for "in all," and "on the trip" accurately reflects the action of making a trip to the zoo. The phrase "in all" is an idiomatic expression used to indicate a total count or the entirety of a group. In the original sentence, "25 students in all" means that the total number of students who visited the zoo was25.

39. James is an efficient worker.

– **He does his work quickly and well.** [CORRECT]
– He supervises other workers.
– He complains a lot.

Explanation. The term "efficient" describes a person who works in a way that produces the desired results without wasting time, effort, or resources. Doing work quickly and well is a direct definition of efficiency. In military and professional contexts, efficiency is a key performance trait denoting high productivity and competence. Supervising others is a different role and is not implied by the word. The term "efficient" describes a person who works in a way that produces the desired results without wasting time, effort, or resources. Doing work "quickly and well" is a direct definition of efficiency. In military and professional contexts, efficiency is a key performance trait denoting high productivity and competence.

40. The cadet was not guilty of the charge.

– **The cadet was found innocent.** [CORRECT]
– The cadet was given a fine.
– The cadet was sentenced to prison.
– The cadet was found guilty.

Explanation. In a legal or military justice context, the phrase "not guilty" is a verdict indicating that the person accused (the cadet) did not commit the offense. Being found innocent is the direct synonym for being not guilty of a specific charge. "The cadet was given a fine" is incorrect because a fine is a form of punishment, which would only occur if the cadet were found guilty. In a legal or military justice context, the phrase "not guilty" is a verdict indicating that the person accused (the cadet)did not commit the offense.Being found "innocent" is the direct synonym for being "not guilty" of a specific charge. "The cadet was given a fine." is incorrect because a fine is a form of punishment, which would only occur if the cadet were found guilty.

41. Bob Moore wanted to inspect the new oxygen mask.

– He wanted to leave it.
– **He wanted to look at it.** [CORRECT]
– He wanted to get one.
– He wanted to buy it.

Explanation. To "inspect" means to examine something carefully and closely, in other words, to look at it. Wanting to buy, obtain, or leave the mask are different actions not implied by the verb "inspect."

42. Mike spread out the maps.

– **He opened the maps.** [CORRECT]
– He folded the maps.
– He marked the maps.
– He copied the maps.

Explanation. The phrasal verb "spread out" means to extend, unfold, or open something so that it covers a larger area, often to make it easier to see or use. In military operations, spreading out maps is a standard procedure for mission planning, navigation, and briefings, to allow personnel to view the entire terrain. "He folded the maps" is incorrect because folding is the opposite action; it involves making the maps smaller for storage or transport. The phrasal verb"spread out"means to extend, unfold,or open something so that it covers a larger area, often to make it easier to see or use. In military operations, spreading out maps is a standard procedure for mission planning, navigation, and briefings to allow personnel to view the entire terrain. "He folded the maps." is incorrect because folding is the opposite action of spreading out; it involves making.the maps smaller for stora qe or transport.

43. The air is dense at sea level.

– **The air is thick.** [CORRECT]
– The air is thin.
– The air is hot.
– The air is cool.

Explanation. In the context of meteorology and aviation, "dense" refers to the high concentration of molecules in the air. This is synonymous with saying the air is thick. At sea level, atmospheric pressure is at its highest, meaning the air is at its most dense. As altitude increases, the air becomes less dense, or thin. "The air is thin" is incorrect because thin is the antonym of dense. In the context of meteorology and aviation,"dense" refers to the high concentration of molecules in the air. This is synonymous with saying the air is "thick." At sea level, atmospheric pressure is at its highest, meaning the air is at its most dense (thickest). In the context of meteorology and aviation, "dense" refers to the high concentration of molecules in the air. This is synonymous with saying the air is "thick." At sea level, atmospheric pressure is at its highest, meaning the air is at its most dense (thickest).

45. Mr. Long liked the cartoons in the evening newspaper. What were they?

– headlines
– **drawings** [CORRECT]
– stories
– news

Explanation. In a newspaper, cartoons are drawings or comic panels, often humorous or satirical. Headlines are the titles of articles, while stories and news refer to written reporting, none of which are drawings.

46. And it said she got a new filling yesterday. What did she get?

– **a cavity filled by the dentist** [CORRECT]
– her car filled with gasoline

Explanation. In a medical or dental context, a "filling" refers to the material (such as composite or amalgam) used to fill a hole or cavity in a tooth caused by decay. This is a common term used in general English and often tested in military language proficiency exams to ensure personnel understand health-related terminology. "Her car filled with gasoline" is incorrect because, while "fill" is used for fuel tanks, the noun "a filling" refers specifically to dentistry. In a medical or dental context, a "filling" refers to the material (such as composite or amalgam) used to fill a hole or cavity in a tooth caused by decay. This is a common term used in general English and often tested in military language proficiency exams to ensure personnel understand health-related terminology. "her car filled with gasoline" is incorrect because while "fill" is used for fuel tanks, the noun "a filling"

47. How did the hole get there?

– **Edward dug it.** [CORRECT]
– Edward wrote it.
– Edward bought it.
– Euwaiu wiu ie il.

Explanation. This question tests the understanding of homophones and their associated actions. The word "whole" is phonetically identical to "hole." In the context of English language proficiency tests like the ALCPT, the verb associated with creating a hole in the ground is "to dig." The past tense of dig is dug. Therefore, the most logical answer is "Edward dug it." This question tests the understanding of homophones and their associated actions. The word "whole" in the question is phonetically identical to "hole." In the context of English language proficiency tests like the Al cpt, the verb associated with creating a hole in the ground is "to dig." The past tense of "dig" is "dug." Therefore, the most logical answer to "How did the hole get there?" is "Edward dug it."

48. We're having a thunder shower. What are we having?

– **a storm** [CORRECT]
– a bath
– a sunny day

Explanation. A "thunder shower" is a specific type of weather event characterized by rain, lightning, and thunder. In this context it is synonymous with a brief storm. "A bath" is incorrect because, although the word "shower" can refer to personal hygiene, the addition of "thunder" clarifies that the term refers to a weather event. A "thunder shower" is a specific type of weather event characterized by rain, lightning, and thunder. In this context, it is synonymous with a brief storm. The question asks for a synonym or a categorization of what a thunder shower is, making "a storm" the correct choice.

49. Carol kept working on the problem until she solved it.

– **She worked it out.** [CORRECT]
– She is working on it.

Explanation. The sentence states that Carol continued her efforts until she reached a solution. The phrasal verb "worked it out" is an idiomatic expression meaning to solve a problem or find a solution through effort or calculation, which directly matches the meaning of "solved it." "She is working on it" is incorrect because it uses the present continuous tense, suggesting the action is still in progress, while the original sentence is in the past and completed.

51. The attack was repelled.

– **It was fought off.** [CORRECT]
– It was reinforced.
– It was ordered.

Explanation. The verb "repelled" means to drive or force back an attacker or an offensive action. In a military context, if an attack is repelled, the defending force has successfully resisted the assault and forced the enemy to retreat. Therefore "fought off" is a direct synonym for repelled. "It was reinforced" is incorrect because reinforcing means to strengthen a position or unit by adding more personnel or equipment.

52. The temperature was around 70 degrees and it was a foggy morning.

– **You couldn't see the sun.** [CORRECT]
– There was some dust in the air.
– There was a steady breeze blowing.

Explanation. Fog is defined as a thick cloud of tiny water droplets suspended in the atmosphere at or near the Earth's surface. This condition significantly restricts visibility. Because fog is essentially a cloud at ground level, it obscures the sky and prevents a person from seeing the sun clearly. "There was some dust in the air" is incorrect because dust suspended in the air is referred to as haze or a dust storm, whereas fog is composed of water.

53. The student has gone back to his country for good.

– **He has left permanently.** [CORRECT]
– He has left for the time being.
– He has left temporarily.
– He left in a hurry.

Explanation. The idiom "for good" means forever or permanently. In this context, saying the student has gone back to his country for good implies that he has no intention of returning and the move is final. "For the time being" means temporarily or for now, and "temporarily" indicates a short duration; both contradict the meaning of "for good." The idiom "for good" means forever or permanently. In this context, saying the student has gone back to his country "for good" implies that he has no intention of returning and the move is final.

— The wind did not damage the wheat. (Item number not visible in the screenshot.)

– The wind blew down the wheat.
– **The wind did not hurt the wheat.** [CORRECT]
– The wind did not bring rain for the wheat.
– The wind turned the wheat yellow.

Explanation. The verb "damage" means to cause physical harm or injury to something, reducing its value or usefulness. In the context of crops and weather, to damage is synonymous with to hurt. Therefore, saying the wind did not damage the wheat is the same as saying it did not hurt the wheat. "The wind blew down the wheat" is incorrect because blowing down the wheat is a specific type of damage, which contradicts the statement that no damage occurred. The verb "damage" means to cause physical harm or injury to something, reducing its value or usefulness. In the context of crops and weather, "to damage" is synonymous with "to hurt." Therefore, saying the wind"did not damage"the wheat is the same as saying it "did not hurt" the wheat. "The wind blew down the wheat." is incorrect because blowing down the wheat is a specific type of damage, which contradicts the statement that no damage occurred.

Form 51

20. That street is very straight.

– It is long.
– **It has no curves.** [CORRECT]
– It has many stores.
– It is not very wide.

Explanation. The word "straight" is an adjective used to describe something that extends in one direction without bending or turning. In the context of a street, a straight road is one that does not deviate from a direct line. Therefore, saying a street has no curves is a direct paraphrase of saying it is straight. "It is long." is incorrect because "straight" refers to the direction or shape of the road, not its length or distance from start to finish.

25. 033:50 _____ 25% 25/100.

– John will turn away the visitors.
– John will frighten the visitors.
– John will examine the visitors.
– John will amuse the visitors.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded. The four verbs contrast sharply in meaning: "turn away" is a phrasal verb meaning to refuse someone entry or to send them back; "frighten" means to make someone afraid; "examine" means to inspect or study something closely (and, in a medical context, to check a patient); "amuse" means to entertain someone or make them laugh.

29. Bill and David want to take a walk after dinner. What do they want to do after dinner?

– (Correct option not visible — the review screen was scrolled past it.)
– drill after dinner
– walk from the BOQ to class
– take a long hike

Correct answer. (Not shown — the capture only includes the incorrect-answer analysis; the correct choice was scrolled off the review screen.)

Explanation. The intended answer restates "take a walk" as a synonym of a common verb phrase (the opening lines of the explanation were cut off in the capture). Incorrect Answers: "drill after dinner" is incorrect because "drill" specifically refers to military training, such as marching or weapon handling, which is a formal duty rather than a casual walk. "walk from the BOQ to class" is incorrect because the original sentence provides no specific location (Bachelor Officer Quarters) or destination (class). This choice adds details not present in the premise. "take a long hike" is incorrect because a "hike" implies a more strenuous, long-distance trek, typically in a natural or rugged environment, whereas a "walk" is generally shorter and more casual. "drill after dinner" is incorrect because "drill" specifically refers to military training, such as marching or weapon handling, which is a formal duty rather than a casual walk. "walk from the BoQ to class" is incorrect because the original sentence provides no specific location (Bachelor Officer Quarters) or destination (class). This choice adds details not present in the premise. "take a long hike" is incorrect because a "hike" implies a more strenuous, long-distance trek, typically in a natural or rugged environment, whereas a "walk" is generally shorter and more casual.

30. The instructor said, "I can hardly hear you." What did the instructor mean?

– **You are not speaking loud enough.** [CORRECT]
– You are not speaking.
– You are speaking too loudly.
– (Fourth option not visible — the review screen was scrolled past it.)

Explanation. The word "hardly" is a negative adverb that means "scarcely" or "almost not." When the instructor says, "I can hardly hear you," they are expressing that your voice is so quiet that it is nearly impossible for them to perceive the sound. This indicates a need for the speaker to increase their volume. Incorrect Answers: "You are not speaking." is incorrect because "hardly" implies that some sound is being made, but it is at (the rest of the analysis was cut off in the capture). "You are speaking too loudly." is incorrect because it states the opposite of what "hardly hear" conveys: the problem is too little volume, not too much. The word "hardly" is a negative adverb that means "scarcely" or "almost not." when the instructor says, "I voice is so quiet that it is nearly impossible for them to perceive the sound. This indicates a need for the speaker to increase their volume.

33. Joe doesn't like to go to the movies alone.

– Joe dislikes the movies.
– (Option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)
– Joe prefers going to the movies by himself.
– **Joe wants company when he goes to the movies.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The sentence states that Joe does not like to go to the movies "alone." In English, "alone" means by oneself or without others. Therefore, if he dislikes being alone, it implies he prefers to have someone with him. "Company" is a common term used to describe the presence of another person or a group of people. Incorrect Answers: "Joe dislikes the movies." is incorrect because the (rest of the analysis was covered by the explanation panel in the capture). "Joe prefers going to the movies by himself." is incorrect because it states the opposite of the premise: going "by himself" is exactly the same as going "alone," which is what Joe does not like.

34. These shoes are worn out. What should I do with them?

– **throw them away.** [CORRECT]
– polish them.
– (Option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)
– get them stretched.

Explanation. The phrase "worn out" means that an item (such as clothing or equipment) has been used so much that it is damaged, useless, or no longer in good condition. In military and everyday contexts, once a piece of gear or footwear is worn out, the standard procedure is to discard or replace it. Therefore, throwing them away is the logical action. Incorrect Answers: "polish them." is incorrect because polishing is a maintenance task for shoes that are still in good (the rest of the analysis was covered by the explanation panel in the capture). "get them stretched." is incorrect because stretching only corrects shoes that are too tight, which is a problem of fit, not of wear and damage.

35. 028:58 _____ 35% 35/100.

– It was too tough.
– It was well-cooked.
– It was very delicious.
– It was not cooked enough.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

42. (Listening item — the audio prompt is not visible in the screenshot. The answer choices refer to a lecture and who has to hear it.)

– The lecture will be delivered by everybody.
– Everybody has heard the lecture today.
– Everybody needn't hear today's lecture.
– Everybody should hear today's lecture.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

43. The supermarket is out of fruit.

– **There isn't anymore.** [CORRECT]
– There is a lot of fruit.
– It is never empty.
– (Option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. The phrase "out of" is an idiomatic expression meaning that the supply of a particular item has been exhausted or used up. If the supermarket is "out of fruit," it means they have sold all the fruit they had and currently have no more in stock. Incorrect Answers: "It is never empty." is incorrect because it refers to the store's general state rather than the specific lack of fruit mentioned in the statement. "There is a lot of fruit." is incorrect because it states the opposite of the premise: being out of an item means the quantity available is zero, not abundant. (The analysis of the remaining option was covered by the explanation panel in the capture.) The phrase "out of" is an idiomatic expression meaning that the supply of a particular item has been exhausted or used up. If the supermarket is "out of fruit," it means they have sold all the fruit they had and currently have no more in stock. "It is never empty." is incorrect because it refers to the store'sgeneral state rather than the specific lack of fruit mentioned in the statement.

46. The doctor wants to check John's pulse. What does the doctor want to check?

– his ears.
– his throat.
– his fever.
– **his heartbeat.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The "pulse" is the rhythmic throbbing of the arteries that can be felt at points such as the wrist or the neck, and it is produced by each contraction of the heart. Because every beat of the heart pushes blood through the arteries, taking someone's pulse is the standard way of measuring the heartbeat and its rate. Therefore, checking John's pulse means checking his heartbeat. Incorrect Answers: "his ears." is incorrect because the ears are examined with an otoscope for hearing or infection, and they have nothing to do with the circulation of blood. "his throat." is incorrect because a doctor looks at the throat for signs of soreness or infection; although a pulse can be felt in the neck, the throat itself is not what the pulse measures. "his fever." is incorrect because a fever is a rise in body temperature and is measured with a thermometer, not by feeling the beat of the arteries. The word "pulse" refers to the rhythmic expansion and contraction of an artery as blood is pumped through it by the heart. In a medical context, checking someone's pulse is the primary method of determining their heart rate or "heartbeat." "his ears." is incorrect because the pulse is a vestibular function associated with the ears.

47. Tom will lend you some money.

– **You can borrow money from Tom.** [CORRECT]
– Tom will send for some money.
– Tom left his money in the bank.
– Tom needs to borrow some money.

Explanation. The spoken statement conveys that Tom has money available and is willing to let someone else use it, so the listener is the one who may take the money temporarily. To "borrow" is to receive something from another person with the intention of returning it, which is exactly the relationship described: Tom is the lender and the listener is the borrower. Incorrect Answers: "Tom will send for some money." is incorrect because "send for" means to summon someone or to request that something be brought from elsewhere, which would mean Tom does not have the money at hand; this reverses the situation, since the point of the statement is that the money is already available. "Tom left his money in the bank." is incorrect because it describes where Tom keeps his money rather than the fact that it can be lent, and nothing in the statement mentions a bank or a deposit. "Tom needs to borrow some money." is incorrect because it reverses the direction of the transaction: it makes Tom the borrower who lacks money, when the statement presents him as the person who is able to supply it. The verb "lend" means to give something to someone for a period of time with the expectation that it will be returned. Conversely, "borrow" means to receive something from someone with the intention of returning it. These are reciprocal verbs: if Tom lends money to you, it means you borrow money from Tom.

49. How long does it take to go from San Antonio to Chicago?

– It's about 1100 miles.
– It's a long distance between them.
– **about a day and a half by car** [CORRECT]
– by bus, car, train, or plane

Explanation. The question word combination "how long" asks about duration, that is, the amount of time an action requires. When it is used with the expression "take to go," it specifically requests the length of the trip in units of time such as hours or days. The choice "about a day and a half by car" answers exactly that, because it gives a period of time and also names the means of transport that produces it. Incorrect Answers: "It's about 1100 miles." is incorrect because miles measure distance, not time; that answer would fit the question "how far is it," not "how long does it take." "It's a long distance between them." is incorrect for the same reason, and it is even less precise: it describes the extent of the journey in space and gives no measurement at all. "by bus, car, train, or plane" is incorrect because it names the possible means of transportation, which answers "how do you get there," not the duration of the trip.

50. Be sure you watch carefully before you drive onto the highway.

– Be sure to get off the road.
– **Be sure to look around.** [CORRECT]
– Be sure to take care of the car.
– Be sure to look at your watch.

Explanation. Here "watch" is a verb meaning to observe attentively, and the adverb "carefully" together with the situation (merging onto a highway) shows that the driver is being told to check the traffic in every direction before entering the road. "Look around" is the natural paraphrase of that instruction, because it means to direct your eyes at your surroundings in order to notice what is there. Incorrect Answers: "Be sure to get off the road." is incorrect because "get off the road" means to leave the road or pull over, which is the opposite of the premise: the driver is about to drive onto the highway, not away from it. "Be sure to take care of the car." is incorrect because "take care of" refers to maintaining a vehicle in good condition, a matter of upkeep rather than of observing traffic at the moment of merging. "Be sure to look at your watch." is incorrect because it treats "watch" as the noun meaning a timepiece; in this sentence "watch" is a verb about looking, and nothing in the statement concerns the time.

52. Harry was told to attend class. What did he have to do?

– **go to class** [CORRECT]
– pay attention in class
– leave the class
– (Fourth option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. The verb "attend" means to be present at an event, meeting, or function. In an educational or military training context, if someone is told to attend a class, it means they are required to go to the location of the class and be present for the instruction. Incorrect Answers: "pay attention in class" is incorrect because while paying attention is a behavior expected during class, "attend" specifically refers to the act of being physically present or going to the session. "leave the class" is incorrect because it states the opposite of the premise: attending means going to the class and staying for it, not departing from it. (The analysis of the remaining option was covered by the explanation panel in the capture.) The verb "attend" means to be present at an event, meeting, or function. In an educational or military training context, if someone is told to attend a class, it means they are required to go to the location of the class and be present for the instruction. "pay attention in class" is incorrect because while paying attention is a behavior expected during class, "attend" specifically refers to the act of being physically present or going to the session.

53. Why did the welder use goggles?

– **to protect his sight** [CORRECT]
– to protect his feet
– to protect his hands
– to protect his hearing

Explanation. In a technical or military maintenance context, goggles are a specific type of Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) designed to shield the eyes from hazards. A welder uses goggles to protect their sight from the intense ultraviolet and infrared light, as well as sparks and flying debris produced during the welding process. Incorrect Answers: "to protect his feet" is incorrect because footwear, such as safety boots, is used for foot protection (the rest of the analysis was cut off in the capture). "to protect his hands" is incorrect because hand protection comes from welding gloves or gauntlets, not from a device worn over the eyes. "to protect his hearing" is incorrect because hearing is protected with earplugs or ear defenders, and welding is a visual hazard rather than a noise hazard.

54. The enemy gave up to the superior forces. What did the enemy do?

– **surrendered** [CORRECT]
– counterattacked
– defended
– (Fourth option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. The phrasal verb "gave up" (the past tense of "give up") in this context means to cease resistance and submit to an opponent. In a military scenario, when a force "gives up" to a "superior force" (a force that is larger or more powerful), it is synonymous with surrendering. The sentence implies that the enemy realized they could not win and chose to stop fighting. Incorrect Answers: "counterattacked" is incorrect because it refers to an offensive action taken in response to an enemy attack (the rest of the analysis was cut off in the capture); attacking back is the opposite of ceasing resistance. "defended" is incorrect because defending means continuing to resist and hold a position against the attacker, whereas giving up means abandoning that resistance altogether. The phrasal verb "gave up" (the past tense of "give up") in this context means to cease resistance and submit to an opponent. In a military scenario, when a force"gives up" to a "superior force" (a force that is larger or more powerful), it is synonymous with surrendering. The sentence implies that the enemy realized they could not win and chose to stop fighting.

61. Why does Billy want a blanket? (The review screen shows the stem twice and partly garbled: "what does Billy want a blanket / why does Billy want a blanket".)

– **He's cold.** [CORRECT]
– He's hurt.
– He's thirsty.
– (Fourth option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. A blanket is a thick covering made of wool or other fabric used primarily to keep a person warm. When a person asks for a blanket, it is logically because they are experiencing low temperatures or feeling chilly. In the context of the ALCPT, this tests basic cause-and-effect vocabulary associated with physical needs. Incorrect Answers: "He's hurt." is incorrect because while a blanket might be used in first aid to treat shock, it is not the standard or primary request for an injury compared (the rest of the analysis was cut off in the capture). "He's thirsty." is incorrect because thirst is relieved by drinking a liquid, and a blanket provides warmth rather than hydration. A blanket is a thick covering made of wool or other fabric used primarily to keep a person warm. When a person asks for a blanket, it is logically because they are experiencing low temperatures or feeling chilly.In the context of the Al cpt, this tests basic cause-and- effect vocabulary associated with physical needs.

62. 016:54 _____ 62% 62/100.

– He won't leave on the plane.
– He knows when it leaves.
– He doesn't know George.
– He doesn't know when it leaves.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

63. What caused the engine to fail? It failed because of poor maintenance. What did the man blame the failure on? (The review screen shows the stem twice and partly garbled: "what caused the engine to fail it failed because of poor maintenance / what did the man blame the failure on".)

– **improper care** [CORRECT]
– rough roads
– proper lubrication
– (Fourth option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. In the dialogue, the speaker identifies the cause of the engine failure as "poor maintenance." In a mechanical or military context, maintenance refers to the routine actions performed to keep equipment in good working order. "Improper care" is a direct synonym for poor maintenance, as it describes a failure to look after the equipment correctly. Incorrect Answers: "rough roads" is incorrect because the dialogue focuses on the mechanical upkeep (maintenance) of the vehicle (the rest of the analysis was covered by the explanation panel in the capture), not on the driving surface or terrain. "proper lubrication" is incorrect because it names correct servicing rather than a defect: applying oil or grease as required is part of good maintenance, so it would prevent the failure instead of causing it. (The analysis of the remaining option was covered by the explanation panel in the capture.) In the dialogue, the speaker identifies the cause of the engine failure as "poor maintenance." In a mechanical or military context, maintenance refers to the routine actions performed to keep equipment in good working order. "lm proper care" is a direct synonym for poor maintenance, as it describes a failure to look after the equipment correctly.

68. A pharmacist is a _____ .

– **druggist** [CORRECT]
– farmer
– dentist
– doctor

Explanation. A "pharmacist" is a person who is professionally trained and licensed to prepare and dispense medicinal drugs. A "druggist" is simply the more common, everyday synonym for that same occupation in American English, since the person works with drugs (medicines) in a drugstore or pharmacy. The item tests occupational vocabulary by asking for an exact equivalent, not for a related job. Incorrect Answers: "farmer" is incorrect because a farmer cultivates land and raises crops or livestock, an agricultural occupation with no connection to preparing medicine. "dentist" is incorrect because a dentist specializes in the care of the teeth, gums, and mouth; although a dentist may prescribe medication, the job is dental treatment rather than dispensing drugs. "doctor" is incorrect because a doctor (physician) diagnoses illnesses and writes the prescription, while the pharmacist is the one who fills that prescription and hands over the medicine; the two roles are complementary but not the same. A pharmacist is a professional trained to prepare and dispense medications. The word "druggist" is a direct synonym for pharmacist, particularly in American English, referring to someone who operates or works in a drugstore. "farmer" is incorrect because a farmer is someone who manages a farm or works in agriculture, which is unrelated to the medical field.

79. This is how it actually happened. (The first two options were covered by the explanation panel on the review screen and are reconstructed from the analysis text.)

– **really** [CORRECT]
– probably
– mistakenly
– supposedly

Explanation. The word "actually" is an adverb used to emphasize that something is factual, real, or true, often in contrast to what was previously believed or expected. In the sentence "This is how it actually happened," it indicates the speaker is describing the true version of events. "Really" is a direct synonym used to confirm the reality or truth of a situation. Incorrect Answers: "probably" is incorrect because it refers to something that is likely to happen or be true, rather than (the rest of the analysis was covered by the answer choices on the review screen) something confirmed as fact; it expresses probability, not certainty. "mistakenly" is incorrect because it means that something was done in error or by accident, which says how an event came about rather than affirming that it truly took place. "supposedly" is incorrect because it reports what people assume or claim without proof, which is the opposite of "actually": it casts doubt on the account instead of confirming it. (The analyses of these last two options were not visible in the capture.)

80. The class was bored with the movie. (The stem was scrolled off the review screen and is reconstructed from the explanation text.)

– happy to see it
– glad to be there
– **not interested in it** [CORRECT]
– (Fourth option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. The word "bored" describes the feeling of being weary or restless because one lacks interest in the current activity or surroundings. In this context, if the class was bored with the movie, it means the students found the movie dull and were "not interested in it." Incorrect Answers: "happy to see it" is incorrect because being happy is a positive emotional state, whereas being bored is a state of dissatisfaction or lack of engagement. "glad to be there" is incorrect because gladness expresses pleasure at attending, while boredom means the students would rather have been somewhere else. (The analyses of the remaining options were cut off in the capture.) The word "bored" describes the feeling of being weary or restless because one lacks interest in the current activity or surroundings. In this context, if the class was bored with the movie, it means the students found the movie dull and were "not interested in it." "happy to see it" is incorrect because being happy is a positive emotional state,whereas being bored is a state of dissatisfaction or lack of engagement.

83. (Word-order item: choose the sentence with the correct word order. The stem was scrolled off the review screen, which only showed the answer and the last two choices.)

– **I'll have coffee later, please.** [CORRECT]
– I'll have later coffee, please.
– I'll later have coffee, please.
– (Fourth option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. This sentence follows the standard English word order for a declarative statement with a future intention and a time adverbial. The structure is: Subject (I) + Auxiliary Verb (will) + Main Verb (have) + Direct Object (coffee) + Adverb of Time (later). The word "please" is added as a politeness marker, usually at the beginning or the end of the sentence. In this context, placing the time adverb "later" at the end of the verb phrase is the most natural and grammatically correct construction. Incorrect Answers: "I'll have later coffee, please." is incorrect because it puts "later" in the attributive position of a noun phrase, where English expects an adjective; "later coffee" would describe a kind of coffee rather than the time of the action. "I'll later have coffee, please." is incorrect because inserting the time adverb between the auxiliary and the main verb is an unnatural placement in this kind of request; adverbs of time normally go at the end (or, more formally, at the front) of the clause, not in mid-position. (The analysis of the remaining option was covered by the explanation panel in the capture.) This sentence follows the standard English word order for a declarative statement with a future intention and a time adverbial. The structure is: Subject (l) + Auxiliary Verb (will) + Main Verb (have) + Direct Object (coffee) + Adverb of Time (later). The usually at the beginning or the end of the sentence. In this context, placing the time adverb "later" at the end of the verb phrase is the most natural and grammatically correct construction. I'll have later coffee, please. I'll later have coffee, please.

84. They work _____ . (Adverb item: the blank calls for an adverb modifying the verb "work." The stem was scrolled off the review screen, which only showed the explanation and the last two choices.)

– slow
– **well** [CORRECT]
– careful
– good

Explanation. The sentence requires an adverb to modify the verb "work," describing the manner in which the subjects perform their tasks. "Well" is the adverbial form of the adjective "good." In military and academic contexts, adverbs are used to provide detail on how actions or drills are executed. Incorrect Answers: "slow" is incorrect because it is primarily an adjective; the standard adverbial form is "slowly." "careful" is incorrect because it is an adjective used (the rest of the analysis was cut off in the capture) to describe a noun, whereas modifying the verb "work" would require the adverb "carefully." "good" is incorrect because it is the adjective form and cannot modify a verb; the adverb "well" is what corresponds to it. (The first two choices were covered by the explanation panel in the capture and are reconstructed from the analysis text.) The sentence requires an adverb to modify the verb "work," describing the manner in which the subjects perform their tasks. "Well" is the adverbial form of the adjective "good." In military and academic contexts, adverbs are used to provide detail on how actions or drills are executed. "slow" is incorrect because it is primarily an adjective; the standard adverbial form is "slowly."

88. He realized _____ . (Noun-clause item: the blank calls for a noun clause working as the direct object of the verb "realized." The stem was scrolled off the review screen, which only showed the explanation and the last two choices.)

– it that time was for class
– **that it was time for class** [CORRECT]
– (Option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)
– (Option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)

Explanation. This sentence requires a noun clause to serve as the direct object of the verb "realized." A noun clause typically begins with the conjunction "that" (which can sometimes be omitted, but is required here for the best structure) followed by a subject and a verb. "It was time for class" uses the dummy subject "it" to describe a situation or scheduled event, which is the standard way to express the arrival of a specific time in English. Incorrect Answers: "it that time was for class" is incorrect because it scrambles the word order: the conjunction "that" must introduce the clause, and the subject "it" must be followed directly by the verb "was." (The analyses of the remaining options were cut off in the capture.) This sentence requires a noun clause to serve as the direct object of the verb"realized." A noun clause typically begins with the conjunction "that" (which can sometimes be omitted, but is required here for the best structure) followed by a subject and a verb. "It was time for class" uses the dummy subject "it" to describe a situation or scheduled event, which is the standard way to express the arrival of a specific time in English.

90. Above the atmosphere there is nothing but empty space. That empty space is _____ . (The stem was scrolled off the review screen and is reconstructed from the explanation text.)

– **a vacuum** [CORRECT]
– a breeze
– air layers
– atmospheric pressure

Explanation. In scientific and aviation contexts, a space that contains no matter or air is defined as a vacuum. Since the prompt describes the area above the atmosphere as "nothing but empty space," it is referring to the vacuum of space. Understanding the characteristics of a vacuum is essential for military personnel involved in aerospace operations, high-altitude flight, and satellite technology. Incorrect Answers: "a breeze" is incorrect because it refers to a light (the rest of the analysis was covered by the answer choices on the review screen) current of moving air, and moving air can only exist where there is an atmosphere, not in empty space. "air layers" is incorrect because the layers of air are precisely what makes up the atmosphere, so they lie below the region described, not in it. "atmospheric pressure" is incorrect because pressure is exerted by the weight of the air itself; where there is no air, the pressure is effectively zero. (The analyses of these last options were not visible in the capture.) In scientific and aviation contexts, a space that contains no matter or air is defined as a vacuum. Since the prompt describes the area above the atmosphere as "nothing but empty space," it is referring to the vacuum of space. Understanding the characteristics of a vacuum is essential for military personnel involved in aerospace operations, high- altitude flight, and satellite technology.

91. You should go on sick call right away. (What does this mean? The stem was scrolled off the review screen and is reconstructed from the explanation text.)

– **go at once** [CORRECT]
– (Option not visible — the explanation panel covered it on the review screen.)
– walk straight
– go to the right

Explanation. The phrase "right away" is an idiomatic expression that means immediately, without delay, or "at once." In a military context, "sick call" is a designated time (usually early in the morning) when service members can report to a medical clinic for non-emergency medical evaluation. Therefore, the sentence "You should go on sick call right away" translates to a recommendation to report for medical evaluation immediately. Incorrect Answers: "walk straight" is incorrect because it describes the manner or direction of walking, while "right away" says nothing about how or where to move; it only sets the moment of the action. "go to the right" is incorrect because it treats "right" as a physical direction rather than as part of the fixed expression "right away," whose meaning is temporal, not spatial. (The incorrect-answer analysis itself was cut off in the capture, and the remaining option was covered by the explanation panel.) The phrase "right away" is an idiomatic expression that means immediately, without delay, or "at once." In a military context, "sick call" is a designated time (usually early in the morning)when service members can report to a medical clinic for non-emergency medical evaluation. Therefore, the sentence "You should go on sick call right away"translates to a recommendation to report for medical evaluation immediately.

94. Do you _____ go to the city library? (The stem was scrolled off the review screen and is reconstructed from the explanation text.)

– **ever** [CORRECT]
– never
– can
– how

Explanation. In English, the word "ever" is an adverb used in questions to mean "at any time." When placed between the subject "you" and the main verb "go" in a question starting with the auxiliary verb "do," it asks about the frequency or existence of a habit. The question "Do you ever go to the city library?" is a standard way to ask if someone visits that location. Incorrect Answers: "never" is incorrect because, while it is an adverb of frequency, it is typically used in statements rather (the rest of the analysis was cut off in the capture) than in questions, where the negative meaning would clash with the interrogative "do" construction. "can" is incorrect because it is a modal verb of ability or permission, and a question cannot take both the auxiliary "do" and a modal in that position. "how" is incorrect because it is a question word that introduces a question about manner, so it cannot sit inside a clause already opened by "do you." (The analyses of these last two options were not visible in the capture.) In English, the word "ever" is an adverb used in questions to mean "at any time." When placed between the subject "you" and the main verb "go" in a question starting with the auxiliary verb "do," it asks about the frequency or existence of a habit. The question"Do you ever go to the city library?" is a standard way to ask if someone visits that location.

95. Only people from the upper _____ of the company were there.

– stage
– place
– entrance
– **echelon** [CORRECT]

Explanation. An "echelon" is a level or rank within an organization, and the term is especially common in military usage, where "upper echelon" refers to the highest levels of command or leadership. The sentence says that only people from the top ranks of the company attended, so the blank calls for a word that names a tier of authority inside a hierarchy. Incorrect Answers: "stage" is incorrect because a stage is a step in a process or a period in a sequence of events (as in "the final stage of training"), which describes a moment in time rather than a rank held by a group of people. "place" is incorrect because it refers to a physical location or a general position, and "upper place" is not an English collocation for organizational rank; the sentence is about status within the company, not about where someone stands. "entrance" is incorrect because it names the door or opening through which one enters a building, or the act of entering, and it has no relation to hierarchical level. The word "echelon" refers to a level or rank in an organization, a profession, or society. In both corporate and military contexts, the phrase "upper echelon" is a common idiomatic expression used to describe the highest levels of command, leadership, or management. The sentence implies that only senior-level officials were present.

97. We are going to have a meeting at noon. Can you _____ ?

– go it
– do it
– **make it** [CORRECT]
– succeed it

Explanation. "Make it" is a fixed idiomatic expression that means to manage to be present at an event, or to arrive somewhere in spite of the difficulties involved. When someone announces a meeting and then asks "Can you make it?", they are asking whether the listener is able to attend at that time. This use of "make" has nothing to do with building or producing something: the verb combines with the pronoun "it" to refer to the whole appointment being discussed. Incorrect Answers: "go it" is incorrect because "go" is an intransitive verb of movement and does not take "it" as an object in this sense; the idiom "go it alone" exists, but "Can you go it?" is not English for asking about attendance. "do it" is incorrect because "do it" refers to performing a task or carrying out an action, so it would ask whether the listener is capable of completing some job, not whether they can be present at a scheduled meeting. "succeed it" is incorrect because "succeed" means to achieve a desired result, and when it is transitive it means to come after someone in a position ("he succeeded his commander"); neither meaning fits a question about attending a meeting at noon. The phrase"make it" is a common idiomatic expression in English that means "to be able to attend" or "to be present at" a specific event, meeting, or appointment. In military and professional contexts, it is the standard way to ask if someone is available to participate in a scheduled briefing or gathering.

100. The recurrent bad weather does not _____ well for the timely completion of the stadium.

– **augur** [CORRECT]
– predict
– foretell
– prognosticate

Explanation. All four choices are related to announcing the future, so the item is decided by collocation rather than by meaning alone. "Augur" is the only one that combines with the adverb "well" (or "ill") in the fixed pattern "to augur well for something," which means to be a good sign or a favorable omen for a future outcome. Here the recurrent bad weather is a bad sign for finishing the stadium on time, so "does not augur well for the timely completion" is the natural English construction. Note also that in this pattern the subject is the omen (the weather), not a person making a forecast. Incorrect Answers: "predict" is incorrect because it is a transitive verb that requires a direct object naming what is forecast ("predict a delay"); it cannot be followed by "well for," and it presents the subject as someone who states a forecast, which bad weather cannot do. "foretell" is incorrect for the same structural reason: it also takes a direct object ("foretell the future") and belongs to a more literary register about revealing events in advance, so "foretell well for" is not English. "prognosticate" is incorrect because it is a formal, mostly technical or medical synonym of "predict" that likewise needs a direct object; it describes the deliberate act of forecasting an outcome and does not enter the omen pattern with "well." The sentence requires a verb that fits into the idiomatic expression "[verb] well for," which means to be a sign of a good or bad outcome. The word "augur" (meaning to portend or be a sign of) is the standard choice for this specific structure. While other choices have similar meanings related to the future, "augur well for" (or "bode well for") is the correct linguistic collocation used to describe how current circumstances might affect future results, such as the completion of a military or construction project.

Form 59

17. Mrs. Wilson needs a match.

– She wants to pay the bill.
– **She wants to make a fire.** [CORRECT]
– She wants to know the time.
– She wants to play a game.

Explanation. The word "match" refers to a small wooden or cardboard stick tipped with chemicals that ignite when struck against a rough surface. Therefore, needing a "match" implies a desire to start a fire, light a cigarette, or light a stove. In Al cpt vocabulary tests, this often requires identifying the primary function of common household objects. "She wants to pay the bill." is incorrect because paying a bill is associated with words like "cash,"

21. To 21 the school has a new system for teaching students. How to type?

– **It has a new method.** [CORRECT]
– It has a new typewriter.
– It has a new instructor.
– It has a new textbook.

Explanation. In the sentence, the word "system" refers to a specific approach, procedure, or organized way of doing something. In an educational context, a "system for teaching" is synonymous with a "method for teaching." Therefore, saying the school has a new method conveys the same meaning as saying it has a new system.

26. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– Iuolitstayimiveuaitei7.uu.
– My roommate wakes me at 7 :15.

Correct answer. (Correct answer not visible in this capture.)

Explanation. The phrasal verb"get up" means to leave one's bed after waking up or sleeping. If someone gets up at 7:00, it logically follows that they are no longer in bed once that time has passed. This is a common way to describe a daily routine in both general and military contexts (such as during basic training or daily muster).

29. John said Bill might go to town. What did John say?

– Bill is definitely going to town.
– Bill went to town.
– Bill isn't going to town.
– **Bill may go to town.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

32. What does that pipe carry?

– twelve men
– bricks
– **water** [CORRECT]
– heavy bundles

Explanation. In standard English and technical contexts, a pipe is a hollow cylinder or tube used to transport liquids or gases. Among the options provided, "water" is the only substance that is typically conveyed through a pipe system. This question tests basic vocabulary related to infrastructure and utility maintenance, which is common in military and civil facility management.

35. The ride was bumpy. How was the ride?

– smooth
– fast
– **rough** [CORRECT]
– comfortable

Explanation. In English, the word "bumpy" is used to describe a ride or a surface that is uneven and causes jolts or bouncing. In the context of transportation (such as a flight or a car ride), a "bumpy" ride is synonymous with a "rough" ride. "smooth" is incorrect because it is the direct antonym of bumpy; it describes a ride with no jolts or disturbances.

38. Robert said I'm going to keep this book.

– Robert has no books.
– Robert is reading the book.
– **Robert wants the book.** [CORRECT]
– Robert will give the book away.

Explanation. The verb 'keep' means to retain possession of something, to continue to have it, or not to give it away. If Robert states that he is going to 'keep' the book, it implies that he intends to remain its owner or holder, which suggests he wants to have it. "Robert has no books." is incorrect because the phrase 'this book' indicates that there is at least one book in his possession or immediate vicinity that he is referring to.

39. It takes 15 minutes to record the tape.

– The recording will start in 15 minutes.
– **The recording is 15 minutes long.** [CORRECT]
– The tape speed is 15feet per minute.
– The tape recorder can be used in 15 minutes.

Explanation. The phrase "it takes 15 minutes" describes the duration of time required to complete the action of recording. In the context of audio or video, if the process of recording the content consumes 15 minutes, then the resulting media (the recording) has a temporal length of 15 minutes. "The recording will start in 15 minutes." is incorrect because "it takes"refers to the duration of the task, not the point in time when the task begins.

44. The pill brought Jon some relief.

– He became hungry.
– He felt very sad.
– **He had less pain.** [CORRECT]
– He became thirsty.

Explanation. In a medical or health context, the noun "relief" refers to the alleviation or removal of pain, distress, or discomfort. If a pill "brought relief," it means the medication successfully reduced the negative symptoms Jon was experiencing, most commonly pain. "He became hungry." is incorrect because hunger is a desire for food and is not a synonym for the medical concept of relief.

45. Let's wind up this job as soon as possible.

– Let's start it.
– **Let's finish it.** [CORRECT]
– Let's turn it around.
– Let's start the fan.

Explanation. The phrasal verb "wind up" means to bring an activity, meeting, or job to a conclusion or to finish it. In a professional or military context, it is frequently used to signal that a task is nearing completion and the final steps should be taken to close it out. "Let's start it." is incorrect because it is the antonym of winding something up; starting occurs at the beginning of a process, not the end.

46. Tools should be protected against moisture. What should they be protected against?

– dry weather
– **dampness** [CORRECT]
– oil and grease
– improper use

Explanation. The term "moisture" refers to the presence of water or liquid, often in the form of vapor or condensation. In military maintenance, protecting tools and equipment from moisture is a standard procedure to prevent oxidation and rust. "Dampness" is a direct synonym for moisture, referring to a state of being slightly wet or humid.

47. We're having abnormal weather for this time of year. What are we having?

– typical weather
– **unusual weather** [CORRECT]
– bad weather
– nice weather

Explanation. The word "abnormal" means deviating from what is normal, usual, or expected. In the context of weather patterns for a specific time of year, "abnormal weather"is a direct synonym for"unusual weather." 'typical weather" is incorrect because typical is the opposite of abnormal; it refers to what is expected or normal.

48. The woman told her daughter to spread out the tablecloth on the table. What was the daughter told to do with a tablecloth?

– fold it up
– **stretch it out** [CORRECT]
– roll it up
– take it away

Explanation. The phrasal verb "spread out" means to open something up and cover a wider area or surface. In the context of a tablecloth, it involves unfolding the fabric so it covers the table. "Stretch it out" serves as the best synonym among the choices, as it implies extending the material across the surface to its full length.

50. Sylvia poured the coffee.

– **She filled the cup with coffee.** [CORRECT]
– She drank the coffee from a cup.
– She made the coffee in a pot.
– She warmed the coffee on the stove.

Explanation. The verb "pour" means to cause a liquid to flow from a container in a steady stream, typically into another container such as a cup. Therefore, when Sylvia "poured the coffee," the result of that action is that she filled a cup or container with the liquid. "She drank the coffee from a cup." is incorrect because drinking refers to the consumption of the liquid, which is a different action than pouring.

53. How does he make his living?

– He goes to the movies after work.
– He walks around the block.
– **He works at the base.** [CORRECT]
– He eats the proper food.

Explanation. The idiom "to make a living" means to earn enough money to support oneself or to have a job. Asking "how does he make his living?" is a common way of asking what someone's occupation is. "He works at the base" is the only option that describes a job or a source of income, which directly answers the question.

56. The downtown area was neglected.

– beautiful
– **deteriorated** [CORRECT]
– faraway
– divided

Explanation. The word "neglected" means that something has not been properly cared for or attended to. When applied to a location like a "downtown area," it implies that buildings and infrastructure are in a state of disrepair. "Deteriorated" is the most accurate synonym, as it describes something that has become progressively worse in condition or quality over time due to lack of maintenance.

60. And after that. What did the soldiers do they took off their shirts what did the man say about the soldiers?

– that they had washed their shirts
– **that they removed their shirts** [CORRECT]
– that they arranged their shirts
– that they recovered their shirts

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

65. Jim certainly looks happy yes he does his wife just gave birth. Why is Jim happy?

– His wife just bought him a present.
– He and his wife are going on a trip.
– His wife helps him in his work.
– **He has just become a new father.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The dialogue states that Jim's wife "just gave birth." This is a standard idiomatic expression meaning that a child was born. Since Jim is the husband, the logical conclusion is that he has recently become a father, which explains his happiness. "His wife just bought him a present." is incorrect because the context specifically mentions childbirth, not the purchase of a gift.

66. Can you meet me at the restaurant Mary yes it's a very convenient place why will? They meet at the restaurant.

– **Mary can go there very easily.** [CORRECT]
– It's a good place to eat.
– Not many people go there.
– Mary has never been there before.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

78. Harry and I don't eat lunch at the snack bar.

– still
– already
– anyone
– **since** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In this sentence, "since" functions as an adverb meaning "from a past time until now." It indicates bar, but at some point in the past, they stopped and have not eaten there from that point onward. while typically seen with the Present Perfect tense (e.g., "haven't eaten"), in certain contexts or informal military English assessments, it can be used to denote a status change regarding a current habit.

87. I'll be looking forward to _____ you soon.

– seen
– having seen
– saw
– **seeing** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The phrase "look forward to" is an idiomatic phrasal verb where "to" functions as a preposition rather than part of an infinitive. In English grammar, prepositions must be followed by a noun, a pronoun, or a gerund (the "-ing" form of a verb). Therefore, "seeing" is the correct form to follow the preposition. This structure is frequently used in formal military and professional communication to express positive anticipation for a future event or meeting.

91. She doesn't mind doing the dishes. She doesn't.

– **object to it** [CORRECT]
– like to
– want to
– pay attention to it

Explanation. In this context, the verb 'mind' means to feel annoyance, displeasure, or opposition toward something. When someone says they 'don't mind' doing something, it means they do not have a problem with it and are willing to do it. Therefore, 'she doesn't object to it' is the synonymous expression. This is a common idiomatic usage in both general and military English when discussing willingness to perform duties or tasks.

93. The deer _____ the fence to get into the vegetable garden.

– arranged to
– stood up
– **leaped over** [CORRECT]
– climb into

Explanation. Deer are known for their ability to jump high and describes the physical action of a deer clearing a barrier like a fence. Grammatically, "leaped" is the past tense of leap, which fits the sentence structure describing a completed action. "arranged to" is incorrect because it implies planning or organizing a meeting or event, which is not an action an animal takes to cross a physical barrier.

94. Do you _____ go to the city library?

– how
– can
– **ever** [CORRECT]
– never

Explanation. In English grammar, the adverb "ever" is used in questions to mean "at any time." In the structure "Do you + [adverb] + [verb]," "ever" is the standard frequency adverb used to ask if an action occurs. In military instruction and standardized testing like the Al cpt, this pattern is frequently used to test the student's understanding of question formation and adverb placement.

95. If you stop at the BX, _____ me some cigarettes.

– **buy** [CORRECT]
– would buy
– should have bought
– will buy

Explanation. This sentence follows a conditional structure where the 'if' clause uses the Present Simple tense ("stop") and the result clause uses the imperative mood. The imperative ("buy") is used here to make a direct request or give an instruction based on a specific condition. In a military context, the BX (Base Exchange) is a common facility where service members purchase goods, making this a practical, everyday request.

97. Selecting students for this society"

– (Options screen not captured yet.)

Correct answer. (Correct answer not visible in this capture.)

Explanation. The paragraph explicitly lists five distinct criteria for membership: scholarship, leadership, citizenship, service, and character. This confirms that the selection process involves evaluating several different factors rather than just one. This type of reading comprehension task requires identifying a summary statement that encompasses the details provided in the text.

Form 62

14. The Airmen decided to have their party at the club where they would have more space for dancing. Where would they have more space?

– **at the club** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The question asks where they would have more space. The statement says the Airmen chose the club specifically because that is where the additional dancing space was available. In a military context, a "club" (such as an NCO Club or Officers' Club) is a common social venue on a base used for events and recreation. The question asks "where" they would have more space. In the statement provided, the Airmen chose the location "at the club" specifically because that is where the additional space for dancing was available. In a military context, a "club" (such as an NCo Club or Officers' Club) is a common social venue on a base used for events and recreation.

18. Mary's husband went out to buy more fuel for the heater. What is he going to bring home?

– **kerosene** [CORRECT]

– ashes

– Mary

Explanation. The sentence states he went out to buy "fuel for the heater." Kerosene is a flammable hydrocarbon liquid commonly used as fuel in heaters, lamps, and cooking stoves. "Mary" is incorrect because she is the wife mentioned in the sentence, not the item being purchased. The sentence states that Mary's husband went out to buy "fuel for the heater." Kerosene is a specific type of flammable hydrocarbon liquid commonly used as fuel in heaters, lamps, and cooking stoves. Therefore, he is bringing back kerosene.

28. Bert has never been absent from class.

– **He always goes to school.** [CORRECT]

– He left school.

– He never listens in class.

– He disrupted class.

Explanation. To be "absent" means to be missing or not present. Since Bert has never been absent, the logical meaning is that he has attended every class session. "He disrupted class" is incorrect because disrupting refers to behavior during class, not attendance. The sentence "Bert has never been absent from class" describes Bert's attendance record. To be "absent" means to be missing or not present. Since he has "never" been absent, the logical meaning is that he has attended every class session. Therefore, he always goes to school.

29. Sam liked the cake so much that he got a second piece. How many pieces of cake did Sam have?

– **two** [CORRECT]
– three
– a large piece
– a small piece

Explanation. Sam had a first piece and then a second one, for a total of two. "A large piece" and "a small piece" describe size rather than quantity.

30. Susan came at the time we were leaving. When did Susan come?

– **just as we were leaving** [CORRECT]
– some time after we left

Explanation. The phrase "at the time" is a temporal connector indicating simultaneity. Combined with the past continuous "were leaving" (an action in progress), it shows Susan's arrival coincided exactly with the departure. "Just as" is a synonymous expression for two events happening at the same moment. The phrase"at the time" functions as a temporal connector indicating simultaneity. When combined with the past continuous"were leaving"(an action in exactly with the departure process. "Just as"is a synonymous expression used to describe two events happening at the same moment.

34. Why are sleeves needed?

– **to cover the arms** [CORRECT]
– to cover the table
– to cover the legs

Explanation. Sleeves are the part of a garment, such as a shirt, jacket, or sweater, designed to cover the arms. "To cover the legs" is incorrect because legs are covered by the legs of trousers, pants, or slacks. Sleeves are the specific part of a garment, such as a shirt, jacket, or sweater, designed to cover the arms. This is a fundamental vocabulary question related to clothing and personal equipment often found in military uniform descriptions.

39. 39.

– He wanted to review the lessons.
– He asked the students to write the lessons.
– He thought the lessons were well explained.
– He thought he overlooked the lessons.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

42. She slipped on the sidewalk.

– The walk was clean.
– The walk was level.
– **The walk was icy.** [CORRECT]
– The walk was paved.

Explanation. To "slip" means to lose one's footing by sliding on a smooth or slippery surface. An icy sidewalk is the only condition listed that directly explains why someone would slip, since ice significantly reduces friction. A clean or paved walk would normally provide better traction. To"slip"means to lose one's footing or balance by sliding on a smooth or slippery surface. Among the choices provided, an "icy" sidewalk is the only condition that directly explains why someone would slip, as ice significantly reduces friction.

46. Ted said he would have a bit more. How much did he want?

– **a little more** [CORRECT]
– a lot more
– no more

Explanation. "A bit" is an idiomatic quantifier meaning a small amount or degree, so "a bit more" is synonymous with "a little more." "A lot more" signifies a large quantity, the opposite of "a bit," and "no more" indicates zero. In English, the phrase "a bit" is an idiomatic quantifier that means a small amount or degree. Therefore, saying Ted wants "a bit more" is synonymous with saying he wants "a little more." "a lot more" is incorrect because it signifies a large quantity, which is the opposite of "a bit."

47. Yesterday the wind came from the south and it was warm. Today the wind is from the north and it is cold. Why is it cold today?

– **because the wind shifted** [CORRECT]
– because the weather is mild
– because the wind died down
– because a storm is coming

Explanation. The prompt describes a change in the wind's direction from south to north, resulting in a temperature change from warm to cold. In meteorological and navigational contexts, when the wind changes its source direction it is said to have "shifted." This explains why the air mass changed from warm (southern origin) to cold (northern origin). The prompt describes a change in the wind's direction from south to north, which resulted in a temperature change from warm to cold. In meteorological and navigational contexts,when the wind changes its source direction, it is said to have "shifted." This shift explains why the air mass changed from warm (southern origin) to cold (northern origin).

48. Joe heard a rumor that the airbase was going to close. What did he hear?

– a statement of fact
– an official statement
– a statement of authority
– **an unconfirmed statement** [CORRECT]

Explanation. A "rumor" is information or a story that circulates but has not been proven or confirmed to be true. In military environments, rumors (sometimes called "scuttlebutt") are unofficial reports that lack verification until a formal announcement is issued by leadership. A "rumor" is defined as information or a story that is circulated but has not been proven or confirmed to be true. Therefore, if Joe heard a rumor, he heard an unconfirmed statement. In military environments, rumors (sometimes called 'scuttlebutt') are unofficial reports that lack verification until a formal announcement is issued by leadership. adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

49. The stereo equipment cannot be sold separately. How will it be sold?

– divided up
– a piece at a time
– torn up
– **all at one time** [CORRECT]

Explanation. "Separately" means individually, one by one, or as independent parts. If the equipment cannot be sold separately, the entire set must be purchased together as a single unit. "Divided up" is incorrect because it means to split the set into smaller portions, which contradicts the statement. The term "separately" means individually, one by one, or as independent parts. If stereo equipment can not be sold separately, it implies that the entire set must be purchased together as a single unit. Therefore, the equipment will be sold "all at one time." "divided up" is incorrect because it means to split the set into smaller portions, which contradicts the adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

50. When he jumped from the fence Peter tore his trousers.

– **He ripped them.** [CORRECT]
– He dirtied them.
– He soiled them.
– He wrinkled them.

Explanation. To "tear" is to rip, that is, to pull the fabric apart. "Dirtied" refers to getting dust, mud, or grime on the clothing, which does not break the fabric fibers. "Soiled" refers to staining or making something filthy. "Wrinkled" refers to creating creases or folds, which is minor compared to the material actually pulling apart.

52. I want you to disregard that letter.

– **Pay no attention to it.** [CORRECT]
– Read it immediately.
– Answer it right now.
– Do not destroy it.

Explanation. The verb "disregard" means to ignore something, to treat it as if it has no importance, or to pay no attention to it. In a military or professional context, if a command or letter is to be disregarded, the information within it is no longer valid and should be ignored by the recipient. The verb "disregard" means to ignore something, to treat it as if it has no importance, or to pay no attention to it. In a military or professional context, if a command or a letter is to be disregarded, it means the information within it is no longer valid and should be ignored by the recipient. "Do not destroy it." is incorrect because "disregard" adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

53. In this coded message each number represents a letter of the alphabet.

– **Every number stands for a letter.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In coding and cryptography, "represents" means that one symbol (a number) is used to signify or substitute for another symbol (a letter). The phrasal verb "stands for" is a direct synonym for "represents" in this context. In the context of coding and cryptography, the verb "represents" means that one symbol (in this case, a number) is used to signify or substitute for another symbol (a letter). The phrasal verb "stands for" is a direct synonym for "represents" in this context. Therefore, if each number represents a letter, every number stands for a letter. adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

54. What are you going to use that trailer for?

– **to haul freight** [CORRECT]
– to drain the field
– to pump water
– to spray paint

Explanation. A trailer is a non-motorized vehicle designed to be towed by a powered vehicle, such as a truck or tractor. Its primary purpose is to transport or "haul" goods, materials, or equipment, collectively known as "freight." This is a standard logistical function in both military and civilian contexts. A trailer is a non-motorized vehicle designed to be towed by a powered vehicle, such as a truck or tractor. Its primary purpose is to transport or 'haul' goods, materials, or equipment, which is collectively known as 'freight'. This is a standard logistical function in both military and civilian contexts. "to drain the field" is incorrect because draining a adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

55. David's car is ready to fall apart.

– brand new
– **in poor condition** [CORRECT]
– a rental car
– -10%

Explanation. The idiom "ready to fall apart" means that something is in such bad shape that it is likely to break into pieces or stop working soon. Applied to a car, it suggests the vehicle is old, unreliable, and in a state of extreme disrepair, which is synonymous with being "in poor condition." "Brand new" is the opposite.

56. The new movie has angered a lot of people.

– **controversial** [CORRECT]
– very sad
– -10%

Explanation. The phrase "has angered a lot of people" suggests the movie provoked strong negative reactions, public disagreement, or heated debate. "Controversial" specifically describes something that gives rise to public disagreement or intense discussion. "Very sad" describes sorrow, not conflict. The phrase "has angered a lot of people" suggests that the movie has provoked strong negative reactions, public disagreement, or heated debate. The word "controversial" specifically describes something that gives rise to public disagreement or intense discussion, making it the most appropriate synonym for the situation described.

57. "I hope you don't fall." "So do I. I can't swim." Where are the man and woman?

– **by deep water** [CORRECT]
– by a thick forest

Explanation. The speaker mentions "I can't swim" as the direct reason for their concern about falling. The mention of swimming, or the inability to swim, is a contextual clue pointing toward a water-based environment. If someone falls into deep water and cannot swim, they are in danger of drowning, which explains the apprehension in the dialogue. The speaker mentions"I can't swim" as the direct reason for their concern about falling. In language comprehension tasks, the mention of swimming or the inability to swim serves as a contextual clue pointing toward a water-based environment. If someone falls into deep water and can not swim, they are in danger of drowning, which explains the apprehension expressed in the dialogue.

59. "Here's a nice chair for you." "Oh no, it's much too big." What did the woman say about the chair?

– **It is not the right size.** [CORRECT]
– It is not the right shape.
– It is not the right price.

Explanation. The woman responds to the offer of a chair by saying it is "much too big." The word "big" describes the dimensions, scale, or magnitude of an object, so her comment specifically addresses the chair's size. Since it is too big, it is not the correct size for her. The woman responds to the offer of a chair by saying it is "much too big." In the English language, the word "big" is used to describe the dimensions, scale, or magnitude of an object. Therefore, her comment specifically addresses the chair's size. Since it is "too big," it is not the correct size for her. "It is not the right price." is incorrect because the adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

62. "Have you talked to the chaplain yet?" "No, I will see him after the service." Where are the man and woman?

– in a restaurant
– in a train station
– **in a chapel** [CORRECT]
– in a theater

Explanation. The dialogue mentions two key terms: "chaplain" and "service." In a military context, a chaplain is a commissioned officer responsible for the spiritual well-being of service members, and a "service" refers to a religious ceremony. These activities primarily occur in a chapel. The dialogue mentions two key terms: "chaplain" and "service." In a military context, a chaplain is a commissioned officer responsible for the spiritual well-being of service members, and a"service"refers to a religious ceremony. These activities primarily occur in a chapel. "in a restaurant" is incorrect because while people adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

66. "What did you think of the book?" "The ending was very abrupt." What did the woman think?

– **She thought the ending was sudden.** [CORRECT]
– She thought the ending was sad.

Explanation. The word "abrupt" means sudden or unexpected. When the woman describes the book's ending as very abrupt, she is indicating that it finished quickly and without much warning. Therefore "She thought the ending was sudden" is the correct interpretation. When the woman describes the book's ending as "very abrupt," she is indicating that it finished quickly and without much warning. Therefore, the choice "She thought the ending was sudden" is the correct interpretation. adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

71. The new student _____.

– in class at all this morning wasn't
– at all wasn't this morning in class
– **wasn't in class at all this morning** [CORRECT]

Explanation. This sentence follows the standard English word order for a negative statement: Subject (The new student) + Negative Verb (wasn't) + Prepositional Phrase of Place (in class) + Intensifier (at all) + Adverbial of Time (this morning). In English, expressions of place usually precede expressions of time, and the intensifier "at all" is correctly placed after the complement to emphasize the negation. This sentence follows the standard English word order for a negative statement: Subject(The new student) + Negative Verb (wasn't) + Prepositional Phrase of Place (in class) + Intensifier (at all) + Adverbial of Time (this morning). In English, expressions of place usually precede expressions of time, and the intensifier "at all" is correctly placed after the complement to emphasize the negation. "in class at all this.mornin a. wasn't" is incorrect_ adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

75. The report was ready for _____.

– **printing** [CORRECT]
– printed
– be printed

Explanation. In English, the preposition "for" is followed by a noun or a gerund (an -ing verb form acting as a noun). In "The report was ready for printing," the word "printing" serves as the object of the preposition "for," indicating the specific process the report is prepared for. If the sentence used the adjective "ready" without "for," it would require an infinitive, for example "The report was ready to print." In English, the preposition "for" is followed by a noun or a gerund (an "-ing" verb form acting as a noun). In the sentence "The report was ready for printing," the word"printing"serves as the object of the preposition "for," indicating the specific process the report is prepared for. If the sentence used the adjective "ready" without "for," it would require an infinitive (e.g., "The report was ready to print"). printed be printed adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

84. The dog kept us up all night _____.

– **barking** [CORRECT]
– barks
– bark

Explanation. The verb "keep" (past tense "kept") followed by an object and an action requires the present participle (the -ing form) to describe a continuous or repeated activity. In "The dog kept us up all night barking," the word "barking" functions as a participle describing the ongoing action of the dog that caused the speakers to stay awake. The structure Subject + keep + Object + -ing is standard for indicating that an action continued over a period. The verb "keep" (past tense "kept") followed by an object and an action requires the present participle (the "-ing" form) to describe a continuous or repeated activity. In this sentence, "The dog kept us up all night barking," the word "barking" functions as a participle describing the ongoing action of the dog that caused the speakers to stay awake. This structure (Subject + keep + Object + -ing) is standard for indicating that an action continued over a period barks bark adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

85. Did you hear that Janelle is _____ marry?

– about
– about for
– **about to** [CORRECT]
– about for to

Explanation. The phrase "be about to" is a fixed idiomatic structure used to describe an action that is going to happen in the very near future. "Janelle is about to marry" means she will marry very soon. This construction requires the infinitive marker "to" followed by the base form of the verb ("marry"). "About" alone is incorrect because it lacks the necessary infinitive marker. The phrase "be about to" is a fixed idiomatic structure used to describe an action that is going to happen in the very near future. In this sentence, "Janelle is about to marry" means she will marry very soon. This construction requires the infinitive marker "to" followed by the base form of the verb ("marry").

87. The NCO expects his men _____ their uniforms.

– **to wear** [CORRECT]
– are wearing
– be wearing

Explanation. The verb "expect" follows the grammatical pattern expect + object + to-infinitive when indicating a requirement or anticipation of an action. In this sentence, "the NCO" is the subject, "his men" is the object, and "to wear" is the infinitive phrase that completes the thought. In a military context, this structure is frequently used to describe orders, standards, or behavioral expectations set by leadership. The verb "expect" follows the grammatical pattern "expect + object + to-infinitive" when indicating a requirement or anticipation of an action. In this sentence, "the Nco" is the subject, "his men" is the object, and "to wear" is the infinitive phrase that completes the thought. In a military context, this structure is frequently used to describe orders, standards, or behavioral expectations set by leadership. to wear are wearing ? adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

90. The woman used fine thread to sew the dress.

– heavy
– new
– **thin** [CORRECT]
– dark

Explanation. Here "fine" is an adjective meaning thin or delicate in width, not "good" or "excellent." Fine thread is thin thread. "Heavy" and "dark" describe weight and color, which are not what "fine" indicates in this context.

91. Mr. and Mrs. Jackson have their evening paper delivered. The paper is _____.

– mailed by them
– bought at a newsstand
– **brought to their home** [CORRECT]
– sent to the newsstand

Explanation. In English, when a newspaper is "delivered," it means it is brought directly to the subscriber's residence or place of business by a delivery person. The phrase "have their evening paper delivered" uses the causative structure (have + object + past participle), indicating that they arrange for someone else to perform the task of bringing the paper to them. In English, when a newspaper is "delivered," it means it is brought directly to the subscriber's residence or place of business by a delivery person. The phrase "have their evening paper delivered" uses the indicating that they arrange for someone else to perform the task of bringing the paper to them. adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

94. There was _____ mud than we had expected.

– **worse** [CORRECT]
– as worse as
– more worse

Explanation. The sentence uses the conjunction "than," which indicates a comparison between two things (the actual amount of mud versus the predicted amount). In English, the adjective "bad" has irregular degrees of comparison: bad (positive), worse (comparative), and worst (superlative). The comparative form "worse" is required when followed by "than." "More worse" is a double comparative and is ungrammatical. The sentence uses the conjunction "than," which indicates a comparison between two things (the actual amount of mud versus the predicted amount). In English, the adjective "bad" has irregular degrees of comparison: "bad" (positive), "worse" (comparative), and "worst" (superlative).

95. The number of whooping cranes _____ diminishing.

– **is** [CORRECT]
– being
– are

Explanation. The subject of the sentence is "The number," which is a singular noun phrase. In English grammar, the expression "the number of" is followed by a plural noun (whooping cranes) but always takes a singular verb. Conversely, the expression "a number of" takes a plural verb. Since "The number" is singular, the verb must be "is." Together with "diminishing," it forms the present progressive tense to describe an ongoing trend.

Form 63

12. 12.

– a house
– an animal
– the sun
– a book

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

20. 21.

– a salad
– a bar of soap
– a candle
– a comb

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

21. (Listening item — the audio prompt is not visible in the screenshot.)

– a salad
– a bar of soap
– a candle
– a comb

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

22. (Listening item — the audio prompt is not visible in the screenshot.)

– a drop of water
– colors in the sky
– a waterproof coat
– a stub from a ticket

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

23. 22.

– a drop of water
– colors in the sky
– a waterproof coat
– a stub from a ticket

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

30. 30.

– the owner
– a friend
– the store manager
– a store worker

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

32. (Listening item — the audio prompt is not visible in the screenshot.)

– in her eyes
– in her ears
– in her throat
– in her teeth

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

33. 32.

– in her eyes
– in her ears
– in her throat
– in her teeth

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

37. 37.

– She can't hear.
– She can't walk.
– She can't talk.
– She can't see.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

78. Sally has been waiting since Thursday. Peter apologizes and says he told her he would get here today. Sally says it is Saturday. On which day did Peter arrive?

– **Saturday** [CORRECT]
– Sunday
– Tuesday

Explanation. In the dialogue, Sally explicitly identifies the current day by saying, "It's Saturday." Peter apologizes and says, "I told you I'd get here today." Since "today" refers to the day the conversation is taking place (Saturday), Peter arrived on Saturday. The mention of Thursday refers to when Sally began waiting, not when Peter arrived.

80. Did you recognize him in his costume? (Select the closest synonym for "recognize".)

– **know** [CORRECT]
– envy
– admire

Explanation. The verb "recognize" means to identify someone or something from having seen them before. In the context of wearing a costume, the question asks if the listener was able to identify the person despite their altered appearance. "Know" serves as a synonym in this context, referring to the act of knowing or realizing who the person was. "admire" is incorrect because it means to regard someone with respect or pleasure, which is not the same as identifying them.

82. What did you do besides exercise? (Select the closest synonym for "besides".)

– **in addition to** [CORRECT]
– in place of
– with
– before

Explanation. The word "besides" functions as a preposition meaning "in addition to," "as well as," or "apart from." In the sentence "What did you do besides exercise?", the speaker is inquiring about other activities that were performed alongside the exercise. Thus, "in addition to" is the accurate synonym in this context. "in place of" is incorrect because it means "instead of" or "as a substitute for." This would imply that the exercise was not done, which contradicts the sentence. The word "besides" functions as a preposition meaning "in addition to," "as well as," or "apart from." In the sentence "what did you do besides exercise?", the speaker is inquiring about other activities that were performed alongside the exercise. Thus, "in addition to" is the accurate synonym in this context.

84. _____ pants need to be cleaned.

– **These** [CORRECT]
– This
– Any
– Such

Explanation. "Pants" is a plural noun (specifically a pair noun). In English grammar, items that consist of two parts, like pants, trousers, scissors, or glasses, are always treated as plural. Therefore, they must be preceded by a plural demonstrative adjective like "These" and followed by a plural verb form like "need." "This" is incorrect because it is a singular demonstrative adjective and cannot modify the plural noun "pants." "Pants" is a plural noun (specifically a pair noun). In English grammar, items that consist of two parts, like pants, trousers, scissors, or glasses, are always treated as plural. Therefore, they must be preceded by a plural demonstrative adjective like "These" and followed by a plural verb form like "need." "This" is incorrect because it is a singular demonstrative adjective and can not modify the plural noun"pants."

86. Do you enjoy _____ to classical music?

– listened
– **listening** [CORRECT]
– listen
– to listen

Explanation. In English grammar, certain verbs are followed specifically by a gerund (the -ing form) rather than an infinitive. The verb "enjoy" is a primary example of this rule. When describing an activity one takes pleasure in, the structure must be "enjoy + [verb]-ing." Therefore, "listening" is the only grammatically correct option to follow "Do you enjoy..." "listened" is incorrect because it is the past tense or past participle form, which cannot function as the object of "enjoy".

87. The _____ ID cards were collected. (Choose the correct form.)

– **issued** [CORRECT]
– to issue
– are issuing

Explanation. In this sentence, the past participle "issued" functions as an adjective modifying the noun phrase "ID cards." It describes the state of the cards (those that have already been officially distributed). This is a common structure in military and administrative contexts where documents or equipment are referred to by their status (e.g., "issued gear" or "issued permits"). "to issue" is incorrect because the infinitive form cannot modify a noun in this position.

88. Mary tried not to look _____, but we knew that she was upset.

– short
– pretty
– happy
– angry

Correct answer. (Not shown — the review screen for this item was not captured.)

Explanation. The item was captured during the test, so the app's correct answer and explanation were not recorded.

91. They were _____ up the tent. (Select the closest synonym for "setting up".)

– **putting** [CORRECT]
– cleaning
– folding
– messing

Explanation. In military and outdoor contexts, "setting up" a tent means to assemble, erect, or prepare it for use. The phrasal verb "putting up" is a direct synonym for "setting up" in this context. While the choice only provides "putting," it refers to the phrasal verb construction "putting up the tent." "cleaning" is incorrect because it refers to washing or removing dirt from the tent, which is not the same as assembling it. In military and outdoor contexts, "setting up" a tent means to assemble, erect, or prepare it for use. The phrasal verb"putting up"is a direct synonym for "setting up" in this context. While the choice only provides "putting," it refers to the phrasal verb construction "putting up the tent." "cleaning" is incorrect because it refers to washing or removing dirt from the tent, which is not the same as assembling it.

95. Gilbert and Douglas _____ their lessons.

– **study** [CORRECT]
– are studied
– were studied
– studying

Explanation. The sentence requires a verb in the active voice to describe the action being performed by the subjects, Gilbert and Douglas. "Study" is the base form of the verb, which functions as the simple present tense for a plural subject. In English, when a subject (Gilbert and Douglas) performs an action on an object (their lessons), the active voice is used. "are studied" is incorrect because it uses the passive voice, which would imply that someone else is studying them.

96. Ms. Stickler, who is a finicky traveler, is willing to travel to the tropics _____ that she has access to constant air-conditioning.

– beyond
– only
– if
– **provided** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The sentence requires a conditional conjunction that introduces a necessary requirement for the main action to occur. "Provided that" is a formal expression meaning "on the condition that" or "only if." It is used here to show that Ms. Stickler's willingness to travel is strictly dependent on the availability of air-conditioning. In military and professional English, "provided that" or "providing that" are common ways to state requirements or contingencies. The sentence requires a conditional conjunction that introduces a necessary requirement for the main action to occur. "Provided that" is a formal expression meaning"on the condition that"or"only if." It is used here to show that Ms. Stickler's willingness to travel is strictly dependent on the availability of air-conditioning. In military and professional English, "provided that" or"providing that" are common ways to state requirements or contingencies.

98. Can the child _____ time yet?

– say
– speak
– **tell** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In English, the specific idiomatic expression used to describe the ability to read a clock or watch is "to tell time." While other verbs like 'say' or 'speak' relate to communication, they are not used in this fixed collocation. This is a common phrase taught in early English proficiency levels to describe the skill of interpreting the hour and minutes from a timepiece. "say" is incorrect because while we use "say" for reporting what a clock shows (e.g., "The clock says three o'clock"), it is not used for the skill itself.

99. What time does the flight _____ ?

– **get in** [CORRECT]
– get over
– get up
– get by

Explanation. In English, the phrasal verb "get in" is used specifically to describe the arrival of a flight, train, or bus at its destination. In an aviation or travel context, asking what time a flight will "get in" is equivalent to asking what time it will arrive. "get over" is incorrect because it means to recover from an illness, an emotional issue, or to overcome a physical obstacle. "get up" is incorrect because it means to wake up or rise. In English, the phrasal verb "get in" is used specifically to describe the arrival of a flight, train, or bus at its destination. In an aviation or travel context, asking what time a flight will "get in" is equivalent to asking what time it will arrive. 'get over" is incorrect because it means to recover from an illness, an emotional issue, or to overcome a physical obstacle.

100. The honor_____ declined to attend the award ceremony. (Choose the correct suffix.)

– **-ee** [CORRECT]
– -ific

Explanation. The sentence requires a noun that refers to a person because the subject "declined to attend the award ceremony." The suffix "-ee" is used in English to create a noun representing the recipient of an action or an honor. Therefore, an "honoree" is a person being honored at an event. This fits both the grammatical requirements (a noun subject) and the semantic requirements (a person who can attend or decline a ceremony).

Form 64

14. 10:21C _____ ■ 71 the student went to the beach and got a severe burn. What caused the burn?

– exposure to the sand
– exposure to the sea
– exposure to the surf
– **exposure to the sun** [CORRECT]

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

22. 10:21C _____ 72 Peter is weak.

– **He is not strong.** [CORRECT]
– He is not intelligent.
– He is not tall.

Explanation. The adjective "weak" refers to a lack of physical power or strength. Therefore, saying Peter is "weak" is equivalent to saying "He is not strong." This is a basic vocabulary test on antonyms and their negated forms. "He is not tall." is incorrect because "weak" refers to strength or power, whereas "tall" refers to physical height.

23. 10:21C _____ 72 the cold weather bothered the woman very much.

– **She was uncomfortable.** [CORRECT]
– She was afraid.
– She was happy.
– She was sorry.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

24. 10:21C _____ 72 pennies watch keeps accurate time.

– 'Her'waf cns rops a"rew ur mes'eacn- day.
– **Her watch keeps correct time.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The phrase "keeps accurate time"means that a timepiece functions correctly and shows the exact, current time without being fast or slow. In this context, "accurate" is a synonym for "correct." Therefore, saying the watch keeps correct time is a direct paraphrase of the original statement. "Her watch doesn't show the right time." is incorrect because it is the opposite of being accurate.

26. Sylvia is mentally ill.

– **Her mind is disturbed.** [CORRECT]
– Her fever is elevated.
– Her leg is broken.

Explanation. The phrase"mentally ill" refers to a health condition that changes a person's thinking, feelings, or behavior (or all three) and that causes the person distress and difficulty in functioning. "Her mind is disturbed" is a direct synonym for being mentally ill, indicating that her psychological or emotional state is not functioning normally.

32. The irritated man went on his way. How was the man feeling?

– **angry** [CORRECT]
– happy

Explanation. The word "irritated" is an adjective that describes a state of feeling annoyed or slightly angry. In the sentence provided, it characterizes the man's emotional state as he went on his way. Therefore, the man was feeling "angry." "happy" is incorrect because "irritated" is a negative emotion, whereas "happy" is a positive emotion representing joy or satisfaction.

36. The lecture was lengthy.

– **It was long.** [CORRECT]
– It was short.
– It was interesting.

Explanation. The word "lengthy" is an adjective derived from the noun "length." It specifically means lasting for a considerable time or being very long in duration. Therefore, a "lengthy" lecture is synonymous with a "long" lecture. "It was short." is incorrect because it is the antonym (opposite) of lengthy.

41. 10:19L _____ 72 1 of the important rights guaranteed by the Bill of Rights is the right to assemble peacefully.

– **To meet peacefully is an important right.** [CORRECT]
– There are no real important rights.

Explanation. The original sentence states that "the right to assemble peacefully" is "one of the important rights guaranteed by the Bill of Rights." In English, the verb "assemble" is a synonym for "to meet" or "to gather." Therefore, saying "to meet peacefully is an important right" is a direct and accurate paraphrase of the original statement.

42. I substituted for my brother while he was ill.

– **I did his work.** [CORRECT]
– Tio ok eu'a it ei
– I wrote to him.
– I bought medicine for him.

Explanation. The verb phrase "substitute for" means to take the place of someone or to perform their duties and responsibilities because they are unable to do so. In this context, if the speaker substituted for their brother while he was ill, it means the speaker took over the brother's tasks or job. This is common in military and workplace environments when someone is on sick leave.

46. What caused the car wheel to wobble?

– **It was unbalanced.** [CORRECT]
– It was stable.
– It was balanced.

Explanation. In the context of vehicle maintenance and mechanics, a "wobble" refers to an unsteady, vibrating, or oscillating movement. This typically happens when the mass of a tire or wheel is not distributed evenly around the center of rotation.

49. 10:18L _____ 72 Rush this order through.

– **Get it out in a hurry.** [CORRECT]
– Examine it carefully.

Explanation. The phrase "rush [something] through" is a common expression used in logistics and administrative tasks meaning to handle or process a task with speed or urgency. In a military or supply context, if you are told to rush an order through, it means you must bypass standard wait times or routine procedures to ensure the request is fulfilled as quickly as possible. "Examine it carefully." is incorrect because rushing implies speed,whereas examining something Check to see if it is all there.

50. My daughter went to public school. When she was 6 years old?

– **The school was open to all.** [CORRECT]
– The school was six years old.
– The school was very expensive.

Explanation. In the American English context (which the Al cpt follows), a "public school" is a government-funded educational institution that is free of charge and open to all children living within a specific district or community. "The school was very expensive." is incorrect because this describes a private school. Public schools are funded by taxes and do not charge tuition.cio.

51. Since his illness he can't do any heavy work.

– **He can't do any lifting.** [CORRECT]
– He can't work at night.

Explanation. In English, the phrase "heavy work" refers to tasks that require significant physical exertion, manual labor, or strength. Among the choices provided, "lifting" is the activity that most directly aligns with the definition of heavy work. When someone is restricted from heavy work due to illness or injury, they are typically prohibited from lifting heavy objects or performing intense physical maneuvers.

52. Oil is abundant in this state.

– **It is plentiful.** [CORRECT]
– It is black.
– It is expensive.

Explanation. The word "abundant" is an adjective meaning existing or available in large quantities. In the context of resources like oil, describing it as abundant means there is a lot of it available. Therefore, "It is plentiful" is the correct synonym and interpretation of the sentence. "It is expensive." is incorrect because "abundant" refers to the quantity or supply of a resource, not its monetary.value or market price.

53. Jack said the little animal was slippery.

– **It was hard to hold.** [CORRECT]
– It was asleep.
– It was hard to see.

Explanation. The word "slippery" is an adjective used to describe something that is smooth, wet, or oily, making it difficult to grasp or maintain a firm grip on. If an animal is slippery, it would be difficult to hold onto without it sliding out of one's hands. "It was hard to see." is incorrect because slippery refers to the tactile surface of an object, not its visibility or camouflage.

54. 10:17L _____ 72 william thanked the woman for her help.

– **He was grateful.** [CORRECT]
– He was req ret ful.

Explanation. The sentence "william thanked the woman for her help" indicates that William expressed appreciation for the assistance he received. To be "grateful" means to feel or show an appreciation of kindness; it is the direct adjective form associated with the act of giving thanks. This is a common social interaction scenario tested in Al cpt to evaluate vocabulary related to emotions and social responses.

56. There was a big rumpus during the hockey game. What happened at the game?

– **There was a fight.** [CORRECT]
– There was an important ceremony.
– There was a high score.

Explanation. The word "rumpus" is a noun used to describe a noisy disturbance, a commotion, or a physical altercation (a row). In the context of a hockey game, which is often known for physical play, a "big rumpus" specifically implies that a fight or a significant disturbance occurred between players or spectators.

65. What time did you get home? I don't know but the East was just barely light when did the man get home.

– **early in the morning** [CORRECT]
– about noon
– late in the afternoon

Explanation. The phrase "the East was just barely light" refers to the period of dawn, which is when the sun begins to rise. This occurs very early in the morning. Therefore, the man returned home as the day was breaking. "about noon" is incorrect because at noon the sun is high in the sky and the light is at its peak, not "just barely" appearing.

76. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **at** [CORRECT]
– to

Explanation. In English, the preposition "at" is used to indicate attendance or presence at a social event, gathering, or specific location. Therefore, "at the party" is the standard idiomatic expression for describing where an activity took place during a social event. "to" is incorrect because it indicates direction or movement toward a destination, not a location where an action (dancing) is currently happening.

84. 10:15C _____ 72.

– **dried** [CORRECT]
– for drying

Explanation. In this sentence, we need an adjective to describe the state of the fruit being packed into boxes. "Dried" is a past participle (v3) used as an adjective. It indicates that the process of removing moisture from the fruit is completed. In English, past participles are frequently used as modifiers before nouns to show a state resulting from a past action (e.g., "frozen food", "broken glass").

85. 10:15C _____ 72.

– **will** [CORRECT]
– (Options screen not captured yet.)

Explanation. In this sentence, "will" is used to express a prediction of a certain future consequence based on a specific condition (lighting a match near gasoline fumes). This is a common structure for warnings: [Command/Condition] + [Prediction of Consequence]. Using "will" indicates that the explosion is a definite result of the dangerous action. In military safety contexts, clear and direct modal verbs like "will," "must," or "can" are used to describe the properties of hazardous materials.

88. 10:14C _____ 72.

– **covered** [CORRECT]
– cooled

Explanation. In an electrical and technical context, to insulate a wire means to coat or wrap it with a non-conductive material (such as rubber or plastic) to prevent electricity or heat from escaping or causing a short circuit. Therefore, "covered" is the closest synonym in this context. "cooled" is incorrect because it refers to reducing the temperature of the object,which is unrelated to electrical insulation.

91. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **new islands are made by volcanic eruptions** [CORRECT]
– volcanoes made all the islands

Explanation. The paragraph explicitly states that volcanoes are "some of the earth's greatest builders" and follows with the direct statement: "New islands have been made by volcanoes erupting."This directly supports the choice that new islands are created by volcanic activity.

93. 10:14C _____ 72.

– arranged to
– stood up
– **leaped over** [CORRECT]
– climbed into

Explanation. The verb "leaped" (past tense of leap) means to jump a great distance or over an obstacle. Since deer are biologically known for their high-jumping ability to bypass barriers like fences, "leaped over" is the most logically and physically accurate choice. In the Al cpt, this tests your ability to match a subject (an animal) with its characteristic physical action.

94. 10:13C _____ 72.

– **told** [CORRECT]
– (Options screen not captured yet.)

Explanation. The sentence requires the passive voice because the subject "we"(the students) received the instruction from someone else (such as a school administrator or supervisor) because the teacher was absent. In English, the passive voice is formed using the verb "to be" + the past participle. Since the first part of the sentence ("didn't come") is in the past tense, the correct passive form is "were told".

96. 10:13C _____ 72.

– **not be able to catch up** [CORRECT]
– (Options screen not captured yet.)

Explanation. This question tests the correct word order for negating a modal verb phrase involving ability. The standard structure is [Modal] + [Negative] + [be able to] + [Main Verb]. In the sentence "I may not be able to catch up if I get behind," "may" is the modal indicating possibility, "not" provides the negation, and "be able to" indicates ability.

97. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **They do not wipe the windshield.** [CORRECT]
– They do not work the generator.
– The windshield doesn't have wipers.
– The windshield wipers do not clean the dashboard.

Explanation. Windshield wipers are essential safety components on vehicles or aircraft designed to clear rain, snow, or debris from the glass. If they are 'not working properly' it implies they are failing to perform their primary function, which is to wipe the windshield surface to ensure visibility.

99. 10:13C _____ 72.

– **-ial** [CORRECT]
– (Options screen not captured yet.)

Explanation. The sentence requires an adjective to complete the idiomatic expression "to be partial to something," which means to have a strong liking for or a preference for something. The root word "part" is combined with the suffix "-ial" to form the adjective "partial." In this context, it describes the subject's flavor preference at a restaurant.

Form 65

10. 10.

– They laughed at me.
– They injured me.
– They called me.
– They were behind me.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

19. Some accidents occur in heavy traffic. Where do some accidents occur?

– ont the open highway
– on small bridges
– **on crowded streets** [CORRECT]
– in small garages

Explanation. The sentence states that accidents occur in "heavy traffic." The term "heavy traffic" refers to a high volume of vehicles on the road, creating a congested environment. "On crowded streets"is a synonymous phrase that accurately reflects the location and condition described in the original statement.

23. 23.

– They will sit.
– They will fight.
– They will talk.
– They will slip

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

24. 033:43 _____ 24% 24/100.

– He has the power.
– He has the excuse.
– He has the time.
– He has the money

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

26. 032:37 _____ 26% 26/100.

– His clothing must be in fashion.
– His clothing must be fireproof.
– His clothing must not be brand new.
– His clothing must not be a red colour.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

27. 27.

– Mike was the first to finish.
– Mike tied his work together.
– Mike is very old.
– Mike is a good worker.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

28. 031:39 _____ 28% 28/100.

– He looked at a ship.
– He arrived on a ship.
– He went past a ship.
– He walked up to a ship.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

29. 031:12 _____ 28% 29/100.

– close to Evanston
– close to Chicago
– in the centre of Chicago
– in neither Evanston nor Chicago

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

33. The tale of the airplane was damaged. What part of the airplane was damaged?

– **the rear** [CORRECT]
– the left side
– the front
– the top

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

35. They finally reached the peak.

– **They got to the top.** [CORRECT]
– They learned the truth.
– They made a decision.
– They finally gave up.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

38. He was sure he could pass the test.

– **He knew he could pass it.** [CORRECT]
– He hoped he could pass it.
– He wanted to pass it.
– He didn't think he could pass it.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

39. Mrs. Barnett caught the bus.

– She was too late for the bus.
– **She was in time for the bus.** [CORRECT]
– She was waiting for the bus.
– She was asking for the bus.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

40. He is willing to travel.

– He is refusing to travel.
– **He is agreeing to travel.** [CORRECT]
– He is forced to travel.
– He is afraid to travel.

Explanation. The word“willing” means being ready, eager, or prepared to do something of one's own free will. If someone is willing to travel, it means they are consenting or agreeing to the action without being coerced. "He is refusing to travel." is incorrect because refusing is the direct antonym of being willing; it indicates a rejection of the action. The word "willing" means being ready, eager, or prepared to do something of one's own free will. If someone is willing to travel, it means they are consenting or agreeing to the action without being coerced. "He is refusing to travel." is incorrect because refusing is the direct antonym of being willing; it indicates a rejection of the action.

41. The man's wound was fatal.

– He needed a bandage.
– He needed a nurse.
– He rested.
– **He died.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The word "fatal" is an adjective that describes something (like an injury, wound, or accident) that causes death. In a military or medical context, a fatal casualty is one where the person has expired due to the severity of their injuries.Therefore,if the man's wound was fatal, the result is that he passed away. The word "fatal" is an adjective that describes something (like an injury, wound, or accident) that causes death. In a military or medical context, a fatal casualty is one where the person has expired due to the severity of their injuries. Therefore, if the man's wound was fatal, the result is that he passed away.

44. Adam took up spanish.

– He failed to learn Spanish.
– He preferred to speak Spanish.
– He appeared to know Spanish.
– **He started to learn Spanish.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The phrasal verb "take up" means to begin a new activity, hobby, or area of study. In this sentence, saying Adam "took up Spanish" indicates that he has begun the process of learning the Spanish language. This is a common idiomatic expression used in both general and military contexts to describe starting training or a new skill set.

45. My grandmother needs to take a snooze.

– She'll go shopping.
– She'll go to town.
– **She'll go to sleep.** [CORRECT]
– She'll go to walking.

Explanation. The idiomatic expression“to take a snooze"means to take a short nap or to sleep for a brief period. In the context of the sentence, if the grandmother needs to take a snooze, it implies she is tired and intends to rest or sleep. "She'll go shopping." is incorrect because "snooze" refers to sleeping and has nothing to do with buying goods or visiting stores. The idiomatic expression "to take a snooze" means to take a short nap or to sleep for a brief period. In the context of the sentence, if the grandmother needs to take a snooze, it implies she is tired and intends to rest or sleep. "She'll go shopping." is incorrect because "snooze" refers to sleeping and has nothing to do with buying goods or visiting stores. + -"$re'n'guu' sleep.

46. 10 new words appeared on the test Esther missed 4 of them. How many did she get correct?

– four
– ten
– **six** [CORRECT]
– fourteen

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

47. Sergeant James gave his captain his reason for being late. What did Sergeant James tell him?

– **how he got there** [CORRECT]
– when he would be late
– where he was late
– where he was going later

Explanation. In English,a"reason"is an explanation or justification for why something occurred.When Sergeant james gives his "reason for being late,he is explaining the circumstances that caused the delay. Among the provided choices, "how he got there"is the only option that can serve as an (for example,if he was late because his car broke down and he had to walk). In military communication,providing a reason for being late usually involves detailing the obstacles encountered during travel or the specific cause of the tardiness. In English, a "reason" is an explanation or justification for why something occurred. When Sergeant James gives his "reason for being late," he is explaining the circumstances that caused the delay. Among the provided choices, "how he got there" is the only option that can serve as an (for example, if he was late because his car broke down and he had to walk). In military communication, providing a reason for being late usually involves detailing the obstacles encountered during travel or the specific cause of the tardiness.

48. We must de-emphasize War. What must we do?

– make war less expensive
– **make war less important** [CORRECT]
– make war less dangerous
– make war less destructive

Explanation. The word "de-emphasize" is formed by adding the prefix"de-"(meaning to reverse or reduce) to the word "emphasize"(meaning to give special importance or prominence to something). Therefore, to de-emphasizewar means to make it less important or to focus on it less in a strategic or social context. The word "de-emphasize" is formed by adding the word "emphasize" (meaning to give special importance or prominence to something). Therefore, to de-emphasize war means to make it less important or to focus on it less in a strategic or social context.

49. What did your roommate wear to the party?

– He left at 8 o'clock.
– He went with a friend.
– **He had on a dark suit.** [CORRECT]
– He went to the officer's club.

Explanation. The question asks"what did your roommate wear which requires a description of clothing.The phrasal verb "had on" is an idiomatic way to say "was wearing.Therefore, “He had on a dark suit” directly answers the question about his attire for the party. "He left at 8o'clock.is incorrect because it answers the question"When did he leave?"instead of what he wore. The question asks "what did your roommate wear," which requires a description of clothing. The phrasal verb "had on" is an idiomatic way to say "was wearing." Therefore, "He had on a dark suit" directly answers the question about his attire for the party. "He left at 8 o'clock." is incorrect because it answers the question "when did he leave?" instead of what he wore.

50. Jack carried out the order. What did he do?

– He cancelled it.
– He destroyed it.
– He threw it away.
– **He executed it.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

53. We succeeded because we had determination.

– We were not interested.
– We made excuses.
– **We didn't give up.** [CORRECT]
– We needed motivation.

Explanation. Determination is the quality of being resolute and firm in purpose. It implies a refusal to quit or abandon a task despite difficulties or obstacles.In a military context,determination is essential for Therefore, saying they had determination is equivalent to saying they did not give up. Determination is the quality of being resolute and firm in purpose. It implies a refusal to quit or abandon a task despite difficulties or obstacles. In a military context, determination is essential for mission accomplishment and overcoming adversity. Therefore, saying they had determination is equivalent to saying they did not give up.

54. The foreign student had to get used to the new customs.

– He had to find out about the customs.
– He had to organize the customs.
– **He had to adjust to the customs.** [CORRECT]
– He had to disregard the customs.

Explanation. The phrase“get used to"is an idiomatic expression meaning to become accustomed to,adapt to,or familiarize oneself with a new situation or environment.In this context,a foreign student arriving in a new place must modify their behavior or expectations to fit the local traditions."Adjust to"is a direct synonym for this process of adaptation. Note: The text "adjust o" contains a minor typographical error for "adjust to." The phrase"get used to" is an idiomatic expression meaning to become accustomed to, adapt to, or familiarize oneself with a new situation or environment. In this context, a foreign student arriving in a new place must modify their behavior or expectations to fit the local traditions. "Adjust to" is a direct synonym for this process of adaptation. Note: The text "adjust o" contains a minor typographical error for "adjust to."

55. That company has a reputation for being above board.

– exorbitant
– **trustworthy** [CORRECT]
– fraudulent
– successful

Explanation. The idiom "above board" means being honest, open, and legitimate.When a company has a reputation for being above board, it means their business dealings are transparent and conducted without any intent to deceive or hide information. Therefore,"trustworthy" is the most accurate synonym in this context. "exorbitant" is incorrect because it describes prices or fees that are unreasonably high or excessive, which does not relate to honesty. The idiom "above board" means being honest, open, and legitimate. When a company has a reputation for being above board, it means their business dealings are transparent and conducted without any intent to deceive or hide information. Therefore, "trustworthy" is the most accurate synonym in this context. "exorbitant" is incorrect because it describes prices or fees that are unreasonably high or excessive, which does not relate to honesty.

56. Phyllis went to the beverage section of the grocery store.

– bread
– bacon
– **soft drinks** [CORRECT]
– green beans

Explanation. The term "beverage" refers to any liquid for drinking. "Soft drinks"(such as soda or pop) are a common category of beverages found in a grocery store. Therefore,if Phyllis went to the beverage section,she would find soft drinks. "bread"is incorrect because it is a solid food item made from flour, typically found in the bakery or bread section. The term "beverage" refers to any liquid for drinking. "Soft drinks" (such as soda or pop) are a common category of beverages found in a grocery store. Therefore, if Phyllis went to the beverage section, she would find soft drinks. "bread" is incorrect because it is a solid food item made from flour, typically found in the bakery or bread section.

65. He collects rocks from all parts of the world that's nice but do they have any value. What does the man want to know?

– Are the rocks unusual?
– Are they different shapes?
– Are they hard to find?
– **Are they worth anything?** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In this dialogue, the man asks, "do they have any value?" In the context of a collection, the word “value' refers to the monetary worth or the importance of the items. Therefore, asking if the rocks are"worth anything" is the direct synonym for asking if they have value. "Are the rocks unusual?"is incorrect because something can be unusual (strange or rare) without having significant monetary value. In this dialogue, the man asks, "do they have any value?" In the context of a collection, the word "value" refers to the monetary worth or the importance of the items. Therefore, asking if the rocks are "worth anything" is the direct synonym for asking if they have value. "Are the rocks unusual?" is incorrect because something can be unusual (strange or rare) without having siq nificant monetary value.

66. What did Tom do when the water bill came? He got kind of riled.

– injured
– happy
– **mad** [CORRECT]
– wet

Explanation. The word "riled"(often used as "riled up") is an informal term meaning to be irritated, vexed, or angry.When Tom received the water bill, his reaction of getting "kind of riled" indicates he became annoyed or mad about it. 'injured"is incorrect because"riled"describes an emotional state of agitation,not physical harm or a bodily wound. The word "riled" (often used as "riled up") is an informal term meaning to be irritated, vexed, or angry. When Tom received the water bill, his reaction of getting "kind of riled" indicates he became annoyed or mad about it. "injured" is incorrect because "riled" describes an emotional state of agitation, not physical harm or a bodily wound.

74. Adam wasn't able to go with us.

– **He couldn't go.** [CORRECT]
– He didn't want to go.
– He wasn't ready to go.
– He wasn't supposed to go.

Explanation. The phrase"wasn't able to" is the past tense form of "unable to," indicating a lack of ability, capability, or possibility. In English,"couldn't" (the contraction of "could not") is the corresponding modal verb used to express a lack of ability in the past. The phrase "wasn't able to" is the past tense form of "unable to," indicating a lack of ability, capability, or possibility. In English, "couldn't" (the contraction of "could not") is the corresponding modal verb used to express a lack of ability in the past.

76. They're planning _____ on the trip tomorrow.

– **to leave** [CORRECT]
– be leaving
– leaving
– will leave

Explanation. In English grammar, the verb“plan" is typically followed by the to-infinitive form ("to" + base verb) when it refers to an intention or a future action.In this sentence,"They're planning to leave"correctly completes the structure to show that departure is the intended action for tomorrow's trip. In English grammar, the verb "plan" is typically followed by the to-infinitive form ("to" + base verb) when it refers to an intention or a future action. In this sentence, "They're planning to leave" correctly completes the structure to show that departure is the intended action for tomorrow's trip.

81. Every elected official has an obligation to represent the voters.

– **a duty** [CORRECT]
– a problem
– a moral
– an office

Explanation. In this context,the word“obligation”means a moral or legal requirement or duty. An elected official is bound by their position to serve and represent the interests of the people who voted for them. Therefore, "a duty" is the most accurate synonym for "obligation." 'a problem"is incorrect because an obligation represents a responsibility or requirement,nota difficulty or a negative issue to be resolved. In this context, the word "obligation" means a moral or legal requirement or duty. An elected official is bound by their position to serve and represent the interests of the people who voted for them. Therefore, "a duty" is the most accurate synonym for "obligation." a problem" is incorrect because an obligation represents a responsibility or requirement, not a difficulty or a negative issue to be resolved.

82. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **He got them.** [CORRECT]
– He saw them.
– He left them there.

Explanation. The phrasal verb“pick up"in this context means to retrieve or collect something that was previously left at a specific location, such as a laundry or a dry cleaner. Therefore, saying the student “got them" is the most accurate synonym for the action performed. "He left them there."is incorrect because it describes the opposite action; leaving items signifies dropping them off rather than retrieving them. The phrasal verb "pick up" in this context means to retrieve or collect something that was previously left at a specific location, such as a laundry or a dry cleaner. Therefore, saying the student "got them" is the most accurate synonym for the action performed. "He left them there." is incorrect because it describes the opposite action; leaving items signifies dropping them off rather than retrieving them.

86. The letter may _____ in the mail.

– lost
– be losing
– **be lost** [CORRECT]
– lost

Explanation. The sentence requires the passive voice because the subject ("The letter") is receiving the action rather than performing it. In English,when using a modal verb like“may"in the passive voice, the grammatical "Lost" is the past participle of the verb "lose." Therefore,“may be lost"correctly expresses the possibility that the letter will go missing during transit. The sentence requires the passive voice because the subject ("The letter") is receiving the action rather than performing it. In English, when using a modal verb like “may" in the passive voice, the grammatical "Lost" is the past participle of the verb "lose." Therefore,“may be lost" correctly expresses the possibility that the letter will go missing during transit. The sentence requires the passive voice because the subject ("The letter") is receiving the action rather than performing it. In English, when using a modal verb like "may" in the passive voice, the grammatical structure must be "modal + be + past participle." "Lost" is the past participle of the verb "lose." Therefore, "may be lost" correctly expresses the possibility that the letter will go missing during transit.

88. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– He agreed that anyone could drive the car.
– **He agreed that he would drive the car.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. willingness or commitment to perform a specific action. In English grammar,the structure'agree + to-infinitive'expresses a promise or consent todo something.Therefore,"He agreed that he would drive the car" is the most accurate paraphrase, as it captures the intent and future-oriented commitment of the original sentence. willingness or commitment to perform a specific action. In English grammar, the structure 'agree + to- infinitive' expresses a promise or consent to do something. Therefore, "He agreed that he would drive the car" is the most accurate paraphrase, as it captures the intent and future-oriented commitment of the original sentence.

92. Do you _____ if I turn on the TV?

– want
– wish
– like
– **mind** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The phrase "Do you mind if...?" is a standard idiomatic expression used to ask for permission politely. It literally asks if the other person would be bothered or annoyed by the proposed action (turning on the TV). In military or shared environments, using polite requests like this maintains proper social decorum. "want"is incorrect because the structure“Do you want if.." is ungrammatical. The phrase "Do you mind if...?" is a standard idiomatic expression used to ask for permission politely. It literally asks if the other person would be bothered or annoyed by the proposed action (turning on the TV). In military or shared environments, using polite requests like this maintains proper social decorum. "want" is incorrect because the structure "Do you want if.." is unq ram matical.

94. That movie director has a new film which is his earlier work.

– like most
– **more like** [CORRECT]
– like to
– as likely

Explanation. The sentence compares a director's new film to their previous projects. The word"like"acts as a preposition here to show similarity. When comparing two things to say one resembles the other to a used. The sentence compares a director's new film to their previous projects. The word "like"acts as a preposition here to show similarity. When comparing two things to say one resembles the other to a greater degree, the comparative form "more like" is used.

95. If you stop at the BX, _____ me some cigarettes.

– **buy** [CORRECT]
– would buy
– should have bought
– will buy

Explanation. This sentence uses a conditional structure to express a request or command. When the 'if' clause is in the present simple tense ("lf you stop") and the result is an instruction for the listener,the imperative mood is used in the main clause. The imperative form is the base verb without a subject. In a military context, the BX (Base Exchange) is a department store found on air force bases where personnel can purchase various items. This sentence uses a conditional structure to express a request or command. when the 'if' clause is in the present simple tense ("lf you stop") and the result is an instruction for the listener, the imperative mood is used in the main clause. The imperative form is the base verb without a subject. In a military context, the BX (Base Exchange) is a department store found on Air Force bases where personnel can purchase various items.

96. Barbara's _____ her job affected her family's lifestyle tremendously.

– lost
– was lost
– was losing
– **losing** [CORRECT]

Explanation. A grammar item on the possessive + gerund construction. The blank needs a noun phrase to serve as the subject of the main verb "affected," and a gerund ("losing her job") works as a noun. The possessive "Barbara's" shows who performed the action, so the sentence means "The fact that Barbara lost her job affected her family's lifestyle tremendously." "Lost," "was lost" and "was losing" are finite verb forms; any of them would give the sentence two main verbs with no subject for "affected," and "Barbara's" cannot be a subject followed by a finite verb. In this sentence, the subject must be a noun phrase. The word "Barbara's" is a possessive noun, which is commonly followed by a gerund (the -ing form of a verb acting as a noun).

97. Two different scales are used to measure atmospheric temperatures. The older Fahrenheit scale is used mostly by the general public of the US and certain other countries, while the Celsius scale, or centigrade scale, is used by scientists nearly everywhere. The latter scale records freezing temperature as 0 degrees. According to this paragraph, the Celsius scale

– measures temperatures in different scale
– is the same as the Fahrenheit scale
– **registers the freezing point at zero** [CORRECT]
– is not often used by scientists

Explanation. A reading-comprehension item. "The latter" refers to the second of two things just mentioned, i.e. the Celsius scale, and the paragraph says it "records freezing temperature as 0 degrees," which is paraphrased as "registers the freezing point at zero." "Is not often used by scientists" contradicts the text (scientists use Celsius "nearly everywhere"); "is the same as the Fahrenheit scale" is wrong because the paragraph presents them as two different scales; and "measures temperatures in different scale" is vague and does not state a fact given in the paragraph. The paragraph identifies two scales: Fahrenheit and Celsius (the latter). It explicitly states that "The latter scale [Celsius] records freezing temperature as 0 degrees."Therefore, the Celsius scale registers the freezing point at zero. The paragraph identifies two scales: Fahrenheit and Celsius (the latter). It explicitly states that "The latter scale [Celsius] records freezing temperature as 0 degrees." Therefore, the Celsius scale registers the freezing point at zero.

98. Ms. Warren, the newly hired teacher, was asked to speak extemp _____ concerning her teaching experiences while in China.

– -oraneity
– -orary
– -prize
– **-oraneously** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The sentence requires an adverb to modify the verb 'speak.The word"extemporaneously"means to speak or perform without preparation (impromptu). In a professional or military instructional environment,this term refers to the ability to deliver information or briefings effectively without relying on a pre-written script or extensive notes. The sentence requires an adverb to modify the verb "speak."The word"extemporaneously"means to speak or perform without preparation (impromptu). In a professional or military instructional environment, this term refers to the ability to deliver information or briefings effectively without relying on a pre-written script or extensive notes.

100. When the continent was first discovered, there were vast tracts of unexplored?

– district
– inhabitants
– livestock
– **wilderness** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The sentence describes a continent at the time of its initial discovery, implying that the land was in its natural,untouched state. The term"wilderness" refers to a wild,uncultivated, and uninhabited region. The phrase "vast tracts of" is a common English collocation used to describe large areas of land, territory. The sentence describes a continent at the time of its initial discovery, implying that the land was in its natural, untouched state. The term "wilderness" refers to a wild, uncultivated, and uninhabited region. The phrase "vast tracts of" is a common English collocation used to describe large areas of land, particularly when referring to nature or unexplored territory.

Form 66

18. The student was looking at the rainbow. What was he looking at?

– **colors in the sky** [CORRECT]
– a drop of water

Explanation. A rainbow is a meteorological phenomenon that occurs when sunlight is refracted and reflected through water droplets in the atmosphere, resulting in a spectrum of light. It typically appears as a multicolored arc in the sky. Therefore, when the student looks at a rainbow, he is looking at colors in the sky.

27. The people can not hold out much longer against the powerful storm.

– The people will resist much longer.
– **The people can't resist much longer.** [CORRECT]
– The people are more powerful than the storm.
– The storm is no longer powerful.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

31. George always asks a clerk to get the item he wants. Who does George asked?

– the owner
– a friend
– the store manager
– **a store worker** [CORRECT]

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

37. In his haste he forgot to turn off the stove before he left the house. What happened to his house?

– **It burned down.** [CORRECT]
– It was constructed.
– It got cold.

Explanation. The sentence presents a cause-and-effect scenario. The subject was in a "haste" (a hurry) and left the stove on. In standard English testing and safety contexts, leaving a stove unattended while away is a primary cause of house fires.

38. The student found out about the trip yesterday. What happened yesterday?

– **The student learned about the trip.** [CORRECT]
– The student didn't think about the trip.
– The student forgot about the trip.

Explanation. The phrasal verb "found out" is synonymous with "learned,""discovered," or "became aware of." In this sentence, it indicates that the student gained new information about the trip on the previous day. This is a common idiom used in both military and civilian contexts to describe the acquisition of information.

40. Mr. Smith will train Louis for that job.

– He will thank her for doing it.
– He will take her to it.
– He will stop her from doing it.
– **He will teach her to do it.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

41. Mrs. Homer served us dinner.

– **She brought our dinner to the table.** [CORRECT]
– She bought the food for our dinner.
– She ordered dinner for us.

Explanation. In English, the verb"to serve"in the context of food means to provide, present, or bring a meal to people sitting at a table. Mrs. Homer physically brought the prepared meal to the guests, which is the standard definition of serving a meal.

42. She slipped on the sidewalk.

– **The walk was icy.** [CORRECT]
– - 'rtle'waik was icy.
– The walk was paved.
– The walk was clean.

Explanation. To "slip" means to lose one's balance or footing, usually because a surface is smooth, wet, or slick. The presence of ice ("icy") provides the logical condition that would cause someone to slip on a sidewalk. "The walk was clean." is incorrect because a clean surface is generally safer to walk on and does not provide a reason for slipping.

43. Davids car stalled right in the middle of the intersection.

– It went out of control.
– **It stopped running.** [CORRECT]
– It turned over.
– It failed to stop.

Explanation. The verb "stalled" specifically refers to a situation where an internal combustion engine suddenly stops functioning, often due to a mechanical issue, fuel problem, or improper operation. In the context of a car in an intersection, it means the engine died and the vehicle ceased to move under its own power.

46. Tom says that a great deal of cattle raising is carried on in the midwest. How many cattle are raised their?

– **a large amount** [CORRECT]
– different kinds

Explanation. The phrase "a great deal" is a common English idiom used as a quantifier to mean a large quantity,a lot,or much.In the sentence, it describes the volume of cattle raising occurring in the Midwest. Therefore, when asked"how many,"the phrase"a large amount” correctly reflects the meaning of the original statement. The phrase "a great deal" is a common English idiom used as a quantifier to mean a large quantity, a lot, or much. In the sentence, it describes the volume of cattle raising occurring in the Midwest. Therefore, when asked "how many," the phrase "a large amount" correctly reflects the meaning of the original statement.

47. Mary told Bob that she had heard the record at home. What did Mary say?

– She forgot it.
– **She listened to it.** [CORRECT]
– She broke it.
– She made it.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

49. Someone walked away with our new book. What happened to the book?

– It was printed.
– It was sold.
– **It was stolen.** [CORRECT]
– It was signed.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

50. Rush this order through.

– **Get it out in a hurry.** [CORRECT]
– Examine it carefully.

Explanation. The phrasal verb“rush (something) through"means to complete a processor handle a task with great speed or urgency. In military and logistical contexts, if an officer or supervisor tells you to rush an order through, they are prioritizing its completion and shipment over standard,slower procedures. "Examine it carefully."is incorrect because it refers to the level of scrutiny or inspection,whereas rushing often implies moving quickly,sometimes at the Check to see if it is all there. The phrasal verb "rush (something) through" means to complete a process or handle a task with great speed or urgency. In military and logistical contexts, if an officer or supervisor tells you to rush an order through, they are prioritizing its completion and shipment over standard, slower procedures. "Examine it carefully." is incorrect because it refers to the level of scrutiny or inspection, whereas rushing often implies moving quickly,sometimes at the Check to see if it is all there.

55. Each winter the pond dries up.

– **has no water** [CORRECT]
– freezes over

Explanation. The phrasal verb"dries up"means to lose all moisture or to become completely dry.In the context of a body of water like a pond, it signifies that the the pond having no water. "freezes over"is incorrect because it describes the surface of the water turning into ice during winter, not the water disappearing. The phrasal verb "dries up" means to lose all moisture or to become completely dry. In the context of a body of water like a pond, it signifies that the the pond having no water. "freezes over" is incorrect because it describes the surface of the water turning into ice during winter, not the water disappearing.

58. What are you going to do? I'm going to shave.

– fork
– pen
– truck
– **razor** [CORRECT]

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

61. What happened to Angela she Twisted her knee what did the woman say about Angela?

– She went to see a friend.
– She broke a dish.
– **She hurt her leg.** [CORRECT]
– She opened a bottle.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

89. Occasionally a language will not have a word to describe a certain occurrence or new product. In such cases a word is often borrowed from another language. This borrowing is particularly common with scientific and technical terms. According to this paragraph,.

– a language may drop technical terms
– **new words can be added to languages by borrowing** [CORRECT]
– all languages have words to describe certain occurrences
– borrowing scientific terms is not common

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

93. Before buying that car, you had better.

– carry it out
– **try it out** [CORRECT]
– put it on
– try it on

Explanation. When purchasing a vehicle,itis standard practice to test its performance,handling,and condition.The phrasal verb"try it out”means to test something to see if it works effectively or if you like it. In this context,it refers to taking the car for a test drive. When purchasing a vehicle, it is standard practice to test its performance, handling, and condition. The phrasal verb "try it out" means to test something to see if it works effectively or if you like it. In this context, it refers to taking the car for a test drive.

94. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **learned** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In this sentence,the blank requires an adjective to modify the noun"scholar."The word“learned"(often pronounced with two syllables as /l3:nid/) is a specific adjective used to describe a person who has acquired a great deal of knowledge through intensive study.While it looks like a past tense verb,it functions here as an attributive adjective in the structure:[Article] +[Adjective]+[Noun]. In this sentence, the blank requires an adjective to modify the noun "scholar." The word "learned" (often pronounced with two syllables as /l3:nid/) is a specific adjective used to describe a person who has acquired a great deal of knowledge through intensive study. While it looks like a past tense verb, it functions here as an attributive adjective in the structure: [Article] + [Adjective] + [Noun].

97. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **a word very** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In this context, the adverb“awfully" functions as an intensifier meaning“very,""extremely■or "exceedingly."When used to modify an adjective like "long,it emphasizes the degree of the quality rather than conveying a negative or "awful"meaning. A "long run"for a play indicates it has been performed for a significant period of time,which is usually a sign of popularity and success. In this context, the adverb "awfully" functions as an intensifier meaning "very," "extremely," or "exceedingly." when used to modify an adjective like "long," it emphasizes the degree of the quality rather than conveying a negative or "awful" meaning. A "long run" for a play indicates it has been performed for a significant period of time, which is usually a sign of popularity and success.

Form 67

10. Don _____ his canoe across the lake.

– tripped
– flowed
– **paddled** [CORRECT]
– stirred

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

14. There are only a few people in class today. How many are there?

– seventy
– only one
– just two
– **four or five** [CORRECT]

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

28. My watch says a quarter 8.

– It's fifteen to eight.
– It's eight fifteen.
– **It's fifteen to nine.** [CORRECT]
– It's eight thirty.

Explanation. The time expression"a quarter to" or "a quarter of" indicates that there are 15 minutes remaining before the specified hour. In the context of this military English examination (Al cpt), the prompt "a quarter 8" is most likely a transcription error or typo for "a "usu jo snb e, do ti) ,uu to anb especially since the designated correct answer is "fifteen to nine." "Fifteen to nine" and "a quarter to nine" both represent the digital time 8:45. Military personnel --hsfimieerr'tb tnt te." It's eight thirty.

37. This uniform has a vertical stripe.

– The stripe is on an angle.
– The stripe goes around the uniform.
– **The stripe goes up and down the uniform.** [CORRECT]
– The stripe is green in color.

Explanation. The word "vertical" refers to a direction that is perpendicular to the horizon, meaning it runs straight up and down. In the context of a uniform, a vertical stripe would run from the top toward the bottom (like a stripe on dress uniform trousers).

45. Let's wind up this job as soon as possible.

– Let's start it.
– **Let's finish it.** [CORRECT]
– Let's turn it around.
– Let's start the fan.

Explanation. The phrasal verb"wind up" is an idiomatic expression that means to bring something to a conclusion, to finish, or to complete a task. In a military or professional environment, when a supervisor says team to finalize the remaining work as quickly as possible.

46. The light was dim in. What condition was it?

– **It wasn't bright.** [CORRECT]
– It was blue.

Explanation. The word "dim" is an adjective used to describe a light source that is faint or has low luminosity. If a light is dim, it means it is not shining brightly. In military contexts, dim lights are often used for stealth, night operations (such as using red lens filters), or during "darken ship" conditions to maintain tactical concealment and prevent detection by the enemy.

47. Are you bored already?

– **Yes, I've lost interest.** [CORRECT]
– Yes,tieiesdiioieilit.
– Yes, I've already eaten.
– Yes, there are two here.

Explanation. The word "bored" is an adjective describing the state of feeling weary or restless because one lacks interest in the current activity. The question "Are you bored already?" is a social inquiry about the person's emotional state or level of engagement. "Yes, I've lost interest" directly answers this by confirming the lack of engagement.

48. Is there any advantage in studying English?

– Yes, there is trouble.
– **Yes, it is helpful.** [CORRECT]
– Yes, it is boring.
– Yes, there is a good way.

Explanation. The word "advantage" refers to a benefit, a gain, or a positive quality that puts someone in a favorable position. In the context of studying English, saying it is "helpful" directly aligns with the meaning of having an advantage, as it suggests the language will be useful for the learner's goals, career, or communication.

49. The weather is unusually warm.

– It will get warm.
– It isn't warm at all.
– It isn't so warm.
– **It is very warm.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The adverb "unusually" is used to describe something that is out of the ordinary or exceptional. In the context of weather, saying it is "unusually warm" means that the temperature is significantly higher than normal for that time or place. This corresponds to the meaning of "very warm." "It will get warm." is incorrect because it uses the future tense, whereas the original statement ("is") is in the present tense describing a current state.

50. When we Flew Over The Ocean there were clouds below us?

– We could have seen the water if we had been above the clouds.
– The clouds were all above our plane.
– **We saw the clouds but not the water.** [CORRECT]
– We could not fly above the clouds.

Explanation. The sentence states that there were"clouds below us" while flying over the ocean. This indicates that the aircraft was at a higher altitude than the cloud layer.Because the clouds were situated between the airplane and the ocean,they would obstruct the view of the water, meaning the people on the plane could see the clouds but not the surface of the ocean.

51. Since his illness he can't do any heavy work.

– He can't work at all.
– **He can't do any lifting.** [CORRECT]
– He can't do any sitting.
– He can't work at night.

Explanation. "Heavy work" refers to physical labor that requires significant strength and exertion. Activities such as lifting heavy boxes, manual construction, or moving equipment fall under this category. Therefore, saying someone can not do"any lifting" is a practical synonym for being unable to perform "heavy work" in a medical or physical capability context.

54. Joe is always ready to take a risk.

– afraid
– cautious
– erratic
– **daring** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The phrase "ready to take a risk" describes someone who is bold, adventurous, or willing to face danger and uncertainty. The adjective"daring" is a direct synonym for this behavior. In military contexts, being daring often describes leadership or tactical moves that involve calculated risks to achieve an objective. "afraid" is incorrect because it means feeling fear or being unwilling to face danger, which is the opposite of taking a risk.

56. Ms. Simpson is impartial.

– **fair** [CORRECT]
– prejudiced
– hateful
– kind

Explanation. The word "impartial" means to be unbiased, neutral, or not favoring one side over another. In military and professional contexts, being impartial is essential for leadership and justice, ensuring that decisions are made based on facts rather than personal bias. Therefore, "fair" is the correct synonym. "prejudiced" is incorrect because it is an antonym of impartial; it means having a preconceived opinion or bias against someone or something.

65. There is a car with its lights on in the parking lot it is a blue Mercury Cougar with Georgia license plates.

– is illegally parked
– was stolen in Georgia
– is stalled at a light
– **has its lights on** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The prompt explicitly states that "there is a car with its lights on in the parking lot." This is a descriptive sentence where the condition of the vehicle (lights being on) is a primary piece of information. The other details (color, model, and license plate origin) further identify the specific vehicle mentioned. Choice "has its lights on" is the only option that directly reflects the information provided in the sentence.

76. Portable electric hand drills are used for holes in materials.

– **boring** [CORRECT]
– to bore
– bored
– bore

Explanation. In English grammar, when the preposition "for" is used to describe the purpose or function of an object (e.g., "a tool used for.."), it must be followed by a gerund, which is the "-ing" form of the verb. Therefore, "for boring" is the correct construction. If the sentence had used the word "to" instead of "for," the base form "to bore" would have been the correct choice.

78. Lawrence is careless.

– He can't get along with people.
– He shouldn't worry so much.
– **He doesn't pay attention to anything.** [CORRECT]
– He isn't happy about anything.

Explanation. The word "careless" is an adjective used to describe a person who does not give enough attention, thought, or effort to what they are doing. This often leads to mistakes, accidents, or neglected responsibilities. Therefore, saying Lawrence is careless is synonymous with saying he does not pay attention to what he is doing.

83. The student told his roommate, "You can count on me."

– **depend on me** [CORRECT]
– count for me

Explanation. The phrase "count on [someone]" is a common English phrasal verb meaning to rely on, trust, or depend on someone. When the student says this to his roommate, he is assuring him that he is reliable and will provide support if needed. "count for me"is incorrect because"count for" typically means to have value or importance (e.g., "Your experience counts for a lot"), which does not fit the context of personal reliability.

84. Warren _____ have to stay in bed.

– can
– has got to
– was to
– **may** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In English grammar, modals like "may", "might", and "will" can be combined with the semi-modal "have to" to express the possibility or future certainty of an obligation. "Warren may have to stay in bed" means it is possible that staying in bed (likely for medical reasons or recovery) will be required. In a military medical context, this often refers to'sick in quarters' or'bed rest' orders given by a medical officer.

87. Her little daughter has been playing noon.

– for
– during
– **since** [CORRECT]
– by

Explanation. The sentence uses the Present Perfect Continuous tense ("has been playing"), which describes an action that started in the past and is still occurring. When identifying a specific starting point in time (such as "noon"), the preposition "since" is required. "for" is incorrect because it is used to denote a duration of time (e.g., "for three hours") rather than a specific point in time.

91. A person who has an ailment should.

– go back to work
– **see a doctor** [CORRECT]
– see a lawyer
– be very happy

Explanation. The word "ailment" refers to a physical disorder or illness, typically a minor one. In general English and military contexts, when a person is suffering from a health issue, the logical and recommended course of action is to seek medical attention from a physician. This question tests the understanding of medical- related vocabulary and the appropriate response to health conditions.

92. If your clothes become soaked with water, they will.

– stay dry
– become lighter
– become partly wet
– **become completely wet** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The word "soaked" means to be thoroughly wet or saturated with liquid. Therefore, if clothes become "completely wet." This is a common vocabulary check in Al cpt to ensure understanding of synonyms and degrees of adjectives (e.g., damp vs. wet vs. soaked). "stay dry" is incorrect because soaking is the direct opposite of remaining dry.

95. The weather forecast _____ by listening to the radio.

– obtains
– **is obtained** [CORRECT]
– is obtaining
– has obtained

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

98. A knife was the proper tool.

– most attractive
– requested
– most common
– **suitable** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In this context, the word "proper" is used as an adjective meaning appropriate, right, or fit for a specific purpose or situation. Therefore, "suitable" is the closest synonym. In a military or technical context, identifying the proper or suitable tool for a job is essential for safety and efficiency. "most attractive" is incorrect because attractiveness refers to physical appeal or being pleasing to the eye, which is irrelevant to the functional utility of a tool.

99. Don't _____ that old shirt; it will make a good cleaning rag.

– wipe
– **discard** [CORRECT]
– describe
– polish

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

Form 69

9. Mary is the cashier in our office. (What does this mean?)

– She types all the letters.
– She cleans the floor.
– **She handles the money.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The word "cashier" refers to a person whose primary job responsibility is to handle financial transactions, such as receiving, counting, and paying out money. In an office environment, this role involves managing the petty cash or processing payments. Therefore, saying Mary handles the money is a direct description of a cashier's duties. "She cleans the floor." is incorrect because this describes the duties of a janitor or a custodian, not a cashier.

15. If a man says that perhaps he will come, what does he mean?

– **He may or may not come.** [CORRECT]
– He can't come.
– He definitely will come.

Explanation. The word "perhaps" is an adverb used to express uncertainty or possibility. It is synonymous with "maybe." When someone says they will "perhaps" do something, it indicates that the action is possible but not guaranteed. Therefore, it means the person may or may not perform the action. "He can't come." is incorrect because "perhaps" suggests a possibility of attendance, whereas "can't" (cannot) expresses a total lack of ability or possibility.

16. Which of these might be made of plastic?

– a salad
– a bar of soap
– a candle
– **a comb** [CORRECT]

Explanation. A comb is a personal grooming tool frequently manufactured from plastic, though it can also be made from other materials like metal or wood. The question asks what might be made of plastic, and out of the options provided, a comb is the only one typically associated with synthetic polymers in a modern context. "a salad" is incorrect because it is a food item composed of organic biological materials.

18. Carl is studying chemistry at school. What is he studying?

– foreign languages
– political systems
– important dates
– **basic substances** [CORRECT]

Explanation. Chemistry is the branch of science concerned with the substances of which matter is composed — their properties, structure and reactions. Studying chemistry therefore means studying basic substances. The other options correspond to different subjects: languages, political science and history.

31. The student relies on his dictionary. What does he do?

– **depends on it** [CORRECT]
– talks about it
– doesn't use it

Explanation. The phrase "relies on" is a phrasal verb that means to depend on something or someone with trust or necessity. In an educational or military training context, if a student relies on a dictionary, it means they are using it as a vital resource for their learning and cannot succeed or understand the material without its help. "talks about it" is incorrect because relying on an object involves using it for support or information, not discussing it. The phrase "relies on" is a phrasal verb that means to depend on something or someone with trust or necessity. In an educational or military training context, if a student relies on a dictionary, it means they are using it as a vital resource for their learning and can not succeed or understand the material without its help.

36. We told the sergeant that we had already made up our beds. What had we done?

– washed the sheets and blankets
– **put the sheets and blankets on the bed** [CORRECT]
– piled the sheets and blankets on the bed

Explanation. The phrasal verb "to make up a bed" means to prepare a bed for sleeping by neatly arranging the sheets, blankets, and pillows. In a military context, this is a fundamental daily task performed by personnel in barracks to ensure their quarters meet inspection standards. "washed the sheets and blankets" is incorrect because the phrase "make up" refers to the arranging, not to laundering.

37. Many traffic laws have been revised. (What does this mean?)

– **They were changed.** [CORRECT]
– They were transferred.
– They were protected.
– They were preserved.

Explanation. The verb "revised" means to re-examine and make alterations, corrections, or improvements to something, such as a law, document, or policy. In the context of traffic laws, if they have been "revised," it means they have undergone updates or modifications. Therefore, "They were changed" is the most accurate synonym. "They were transferred." is incorrect because "transferred" means moved from one location or owner to another. The verb "revised" means to re-examine and make alterations, corrections, or improvements to something, such as a law, document, or policy. In the context of traffic laws, if they have been "revised," it means they have undergone updates or modifications. Therefore, "They were changed" is the most accurate synonym. "They were transferred." is incorrect because "transferred" means moved from one location or iiieyweiepiutecteu.

38. Mr. Walton plans to attend the concert. (What does this mean?)

– **He intends to go to the concert.** [CORRECT]
– He does not expect to go to the concert.
– He does not like concerts.
– He expects to plan a concert.

Explanation. The phrase "plans to" expresses a future intention or a decision to do something. In this context, Mr. Walton has made a decision to go to the concert. "Intends to" is a direct synonym for "plans to" in this grammatical structure, conveying the same meaning of purposeful action. "He does not expect to go to the concert." is incorrect because it expresses the opposite of the original statement; planning to attend implies an expectation of going. The phrase"plans to" expresses a future intention or a decision to do something. In this context, Mr. Walton has made a decision to go to the concert. "Intends to" is a direct synonym for "plans to" in this grammatical structure, conveying the same meaning of purposeful action.

39. The humidity is high today. (What does this mean?)

– **The air is damp.** [CORRECT]
– The wind is high.
– The clouds are high.
– The atmosphere is dry.

Explanation. Humidity refers to the amount of water vapor or moisture present in the air. When the humidity is high, the air feels moist or wet. The word "damp" is a synonym for moist or slightly wet, making it the correct description for high humidity. "The wind is high." is incorrect because wind refers to the movement of air (speed), which is unrelated to the amount of moisture (humidity) in the air.

49. The school will eventually add another branch. (What does this mean?)

– **Sooner or later another branch will be added.** [CORRECT]
– Another branch will never be added to the school.

Explanation. The word "eventually" is an adverb used to describe something that will happen at an unspecified time in the future, typically after a period of time or a series of events. The phrase "sooner or later" is a direct synonym for "eventually," expressing that the action is certain to occur at some point. Both phrases correctly convey the future intent of the original statement.

50. Yesterday it drizzled all day. (What does this mean?)

– **There was a light rain.** [CORRECT]
– Sleet fell during the storm.
– Heavy rains fell all day.

Explanation. The word "drizzle" specifically refers to very light rain falling in fine, small drops. In a military or meteorological context, accurately reporting weather conditions like drizzle is essential for determining visibility and ground conditions. The sentence "yesterday it drizzled all day" means that light rain persisted throughout the entire day. "Sleet fell during the storm." is incorrect because sleet refers to a mixture of rain and snow or small ice pellets. The word "drizzle" specifically refers to very light rain falling in fine, small drops. In a military or meteorological context, accurately reporting weather conditions like drizzle is essential for determining visibility and ground conditions. The sentence "yesterday it drizzled all day" means that light rain persisted throughout the entire day. "Sleet fell during the storm." is incorrect because sleet refers to.a mixture of rain and snow or small ice Heavyiainisieiaifuay.

51. Herbert's income is very low. (What does this mean?)

– **He doesn't make much money.** [CORRECT]
– He doesn't have much time.
– He doesn't make much progress.
– He doesn't have much education.

Explanation. The word "income" refers to the money a person receives, typically from their job (salary/wages) or investments. If an income is described as "low," it means the individual is earning a small amount of currency. Therefore, the sentence "He doesn't make much money" is a direct synonym for having a low income. "He doesn't have much time." is incorrect because "time" refers to duration or availability, which is unrelated to earnings.

55. The programming instructions on this new VCR will leave most people completely befuddled. The programming is _____ .

– **baffling** [CORRECT]
– manageable
– obsolete

Explanation. The sentence states that the instructions will leave people "completely befuddled." The word befuddled means to be utterly confused, puzzled, or muddled. Therefore, if the programming instructions have this effect, the programming itself is baffling, which is a synonym for confusing or difficult to understand. "manageable" is incorrect because it means easy to handle or deal with, which contradicts the state of being befuddled.

56. Barousse found many unusual shells while she was walking. Where was she walking?

– **on the beach** [CORRECT]
– on the highway

Explanation. The sentence describes a logical activity: finding "shells." Shells (specifically sea shells) are naturally occurring objects found along the shorelines of oceans or seas. Therefore, the most logical location for finding unusual shells while walking is "on the beach." "on the highway" is incorrect because highways are paved roads intended for motor vehicles; shells are not naturally found there.

61. "How will you get your dog to take that medicine?" "I'm going to inject it." What's the man going to do with the medicine?

– **He's going to give the dog a shot.** [CORRECT]
– He's going to throw it away.

Explanation. In the dialogue, the man states that he is going to "inject" the medicine. To "inject" something into a patient or an animal means to use a needle and syringe to put the substance into the body. This action is commonly referred to in English as "giving a shot" or an "injection." This is a common medical term tested in the ALCPT to ensure understanding of basic health procedures. In the dialogue, the man states that he is going to "inject" the medicine. To "inject" something into a patient or an animal means to use a needle and syringe to put the substance into the body. This action is commonly referred to in English as "giving a shot" or an "injection." This is a common medical term tested in the Al cpt to ensure understanding of basic health procedures. "He's going to throw it away." is incorrect because the He's going to give the dog a shot.

68. I see the girl. Jake _____ also.

– see it
– **sees her** [CORRECT]
– saw him
– seen me

Explanation. This sentence tests subject-verb agreement and pronoun reference. The first sentence establishes the context in the present tense ("I see"). For the second sentence, the subject is "Jake" (third-person singular), which requires the verb form ending in '-s' ("sees"). The object being referred to is "the girl," which is feminine and singular. Therefore, the correct object pronoun to replace it is "her." This sentence tests subject-verb agreement and pronoun reference. The first sentence establishes the context in the present tense ("I see"). For the second sentence, the subject is "Jake" (third- person singular), which requires the verb form ending in '-s' ("sees"). The object being referred to is "the girl," which is feminine and singular.

70. She bought a _____ of stockings.

– **pair** [CORRECT]
– two
– feet
– deck

Explanation. In English, items that are composed of two identical or matching parts used together (such as stockings, socks, shoes, or gloves) are referred to using the collective noun "pair." The phrase "a pair of" is the standard way to count these items. "two" is incorrect because while stockings come in sets of two, the grammatical structure "a two of" is incorrect; you would simply say "two stockings."

74. Adam wasn't able to go. (What does this mean?)

– **He couldn't go.** [CORRECT]
– He didn't want to go.
– He wasn't ready to go.
– He wasn't supposed to go.

Explanation. The phrase "wasn't able to" is the past tense negative form of "be able to," which is used to express capability or possibility. In English, "couldn't" (the contraction of "could not") is the direct modal synonym for expressing a lack of ability or possibility in the past. Therefore, "Adam wasn't able to go" carries the same meaning as "He couldn't go." "He didn't want to go." is incorrect because "want" refers to a person's desire or intent, whereas "able" refers to capability. The phrase "wasn't able to" is the past tense negative form of "be able to,"which is used to express capability or possibility. In English, "couldn't" (the contraction of "could not") is the direct modal synonym for expressing a lack of ability or possibility in the past. Therefore, "Adam wasn't able to go" carries the same meaning as "He couldn't go." "He didn't want to go." is incorrect because "want" refers to a person's desire or intent, whereas "able"

77. _____ is prohibited in this area.

– **Speeding** [CORRECT]
– Speeds

Explanation. In this sentence, the subject of the sentence is missing. A gerund (the -ing form of a verb functioning as a noun) is required to represent the activity being banned. "Speeding" is the act of driving faster than the legal limit, and it correctly functions as the singular subject for the verb "is prohibited." In military and civilian traffic regulations, specific activities like speeding are designated as prohibited within safety areas like school zones or base housing. In this sentence, the subject of the sentence is missing. A gerund (the -ing form of a verb functioning as a noun) is required to represent the activity being banned. "Speeding" is the act of driving faster than the legal limit, and it correctly functions as the singular subject for the verb "is prohibited." In military and civilian traffic regulations, specific within safety areas like school zones or base housing.

81. Sleet and snow are weather hazards. (Select the closest synonym for "hazards".)

– **dangers** [CORRECT]
– signs
– advantages

Explanation. In both general and military contexts, the word "hazards" refers to potential sources of danger, risk, or harm. When discussing weather conditions like sleet and snow, they are considered hazards because they create unsafe environments for driving, flying, and tactical operations. Identifying weather hazards is a critical part of safety briefings and risk assessment. "signs" is incorrect because weather conditions are not indicators in this sense.

82. The mechanic had to adjust the brakes. (Select the closest synonym for "adjust".)

– **reset** [CORRECT]
– lubricated
– cleaned

Explanation. In a mechanical context, to "adjust" something means to change or regulate its position or state to ensure it functions correctly or meets specific requirements. "Reset" is a synonym in this context, as it refers to setting something again or differently to achieve the correct alignment or performance. For example, when brakes wear down, a mechanic must reset or adjust them to maintain the proper distance between the brake pads and the drums/rotors. In a mechanical context, to "adjust" something means to change or regulate its position or state to ensure it functions correctly or meets specific requirements. "Reset" is a synonym in this context, as it refers to setting something again or differently to achieve the correct alignment or performance.For example, when brakes wear down, a mechanic must reset or adjust them to maintain the proper distance between the brake pads and the drums/rotors.

84. We'll write as soon as we _____ .

– **know** [CORRECT]
– will know
– knew

Explanation. This sentence involves a future time clause. In English, when a sentence refers to a future action using a conjunction of time such as "as soon as," "when," "before," or "until," the present simple tense is used in the subordinate clause even though the meaning is future. The main clause uses the future tense ("We'll write"), while the clause following "as soon as" must be in the present simple ("we know"). "will know" is incorrect because "will" is generally not used after these time conjunctions. This sentence involves a future time clause. In English, when a sentence refers to a future action using a conjunction of time such as "as soon as," "when, "before," or "until," the present simple tense is used in the subordinate clause even though the meaning is future. The main clause uses the future tense ("We'll write"), while the clause following "as soon as" must be in the present simple ("we know").

88. His head was bare. (What does this mean?)

– **not covered** [CORRECT]
– large
– small
– cold

Explanation. The word "bare" means lacking a natural or usual covering. In this context, saying a head is bare means the person is not wearing a hat, cap, helmet, or any other headgear. In military settings, this is often referred to as being "uncovered." "large" is incorrect because bare refers to the state of being uncovered, not the physical dimensions or size of the head.

93. The things I bought added up to $17.50. (Select the closest synonym for "added up to".)

– **amounted to** [CORRECT]
– afforded to
– arrived to
– averaged from

Explanation. The phrasal verb "add up to" means to result in a particular total. "Amounted to" is the direct synonym: both express that the combined cost of the purchases reached the total of $17.50. "arrived to" is incorrect because "arrive" refers to reaching a place, and the construction is not idiomatic in English.

95. By the end of the year, Mr. Henley _____ on five times.

– **will have been operated** [CORRECT]
– can operate
– is being operated

Explanation. This sentence requires the Future Perfect Passive tense. The phrase "by the end of the year" is a temporal marker that indicates an action will be completed before a specific point in the future. Because Mr. Henley is the patient (the recipient of the action, indicated by the preposition "on"), the verb must be in the passive voice. The structure "will have been" + past participle ("operated") correctly identifies that by the specified future date, the total of five surgeries will have occurred. This sentence requires the Future Perfect Passive tense. The phrase"by the end of the year"is a temporal marker that indicates an action will be completed before a specific point in the future. Because Mr. Henley is the patient (the recipient of the action, indicated by the preposition "on"), the verb must be in the passive voice. The structure "will have been"+ past participle ("operated") correctly identifies that by the specified future date, the total of five surgeries will have occurred.

99. 99. The company had to go through a lot of "red tape" to get its plans approved.

– Your Score
– 77/100 Review your answers below
– OK
– unexpected cost increases

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

Form 70

11. Rose Ellen broke her mirror. Now she cannot _____ .

– **see herself** [CORRECT]
– talk to anyone
– tell time

Explanation. A mirror is a reflective surface used primarily for seeing one's own image or reflection. If Rose Ellen broke her mirror, she has lost the tool used to see herself. This question tests the functional understanding of common household objects. "talk to anyone" is incorrect because mirrors are optical devices, not communication tools like phones.

35. I need a stamp. (What does this mean?)

– **I don't have any stamps.** [CORRECT]
– I bought a stamp.
– I have lots of stamps.

Explanation. The verb "need" indicates a requirement or a necessity arising from a lack of something. If a person says they "need a stamp," it implies that they do not currently possess one or have run out of them. Therefore, "I don't have any stamps" is the most logical inference from the statement. "I bought a stamp." is incorrect because it describes a completed purchase rather than a present lack.

37. The Airman walked into the office with his hat on. (What does this mean?)

– **He entered without removing his hat.** [CORRECT]
– He removed his hat when he entered.

Explanation. The phrase "with his hat on" (noting that "head" in the prompt is a common transcription error for "hat") indicates that the Airman was wearing his headgear (cover) as he entered the room. In military protocol, personnel are generally expected to remove their outdoor headgear when entering a building or office, so the sentence describes a person who did not do so. The phrase "with his hat on" (noting that "head" in the prompt is a common transcription error for "hat") indicates that the Airman was wearing his headgear (cover) as he entered the room. In military protocol, personnel are generally expected to remove their outdoor headgear when entering a building or office. The sentence describes a situation nat. He removed his hat when he entered. adidas?

39. The man extended his hand. (What does this mean?)

– **He held it out.** [CORRECT]
– He removed it.
– He washed it.
– He cut it.

Explanation. The verb "extended" in this context means to stretch something out or to reach out. When someone "extends their hand," they are typically reaching forward, often to shake hands or offer assistance. Therefore, "held it out" is the synonymous phrase that accurately describes the action. "He removed it." is incorrect because "remove" means to take away. The verb "extended" in this context means to stretch something out or to reach out.When someone "extends their hand," they are typically reaching forward, often to shake hands or offer assistance. Therefore, "held it out" is the synonymous phrase that accurately describes the action. "He removed it." is incorrect because "remove" means adidas?

41. He is willing to travel. (What does this mean?)

– He is refusing to travel.
– **He is agreeing to travel.** [CORRECT]
– He is forced to travel.
– He is afraid to travel.

Explanation. To be "willing" to do something means to be ready, eager or prepared to do it of one's own accord. Agreeing to travel expresses exactly that consent. "He is forced to travel" is incorrect because being forced removes the element of free consent that "willing" implies.

44. The store put a number of things on sale. What did they do?

– put them outside
– **lowered the prices** [CORRECT]
– kept prices the same
– stopped selling

Explanation. To "put something on sale" means to offer it at a reduced price for a limited period. Therefore the store lowered the prices of a number of items. "put them outside" is incorrect because it refers to physical placement, not to a price reduction.

46. My father works for a Lumber Company. Where does he work?

– in a library
– **in a forest** [CORRECT]
– in a laboratory
– in a cemetery

Explanation. Lumber is wood that has been processed into beams and planks. A lumber company harvests trees, so its work takes place in a forest. "in a laboratory" is incorrect because laboratories are used for scientific research, not for logging.

47. Tools should be protected against moisture. What should they be protected against?

– **dampness** [CORRECT]
– improper use
– -10% _____ -10%

Explanation. The word "moisture" refers to the presence of liquid, especially water, often in the form of vapor or condensation. In maintenance or military storage contexts, moisture is a primary cause of rust and corrosion on metal equipment. "Dampness" is a synonym for moisture, both describing a state of being slightly wet or humid. The word "moisture" refers to the presence of liquid, especially water, often in the form of vapor or condensation. In maintenance or military storage contexts, moisture is a primary cause of rust and corrosion on metal equipment."Dampness"is a synonym for moisture, both describing a state of being slightly wet or humid.

48. How will a new job enable him to buy a car?

– He will need it to get to work.
– He will know how to drive then.
– **He will earn enough money.** [CORRECT]
– He will have many new friends.

Explanation. To "enable" someone to do something means to give them the means or opportunity to do it. A new job provides income, so the new job enables the purchase by giving him enough money. "He will need it to get to work." is incorrect because it states a reason for wanting a car, not the means of affording one.

53. Sergeant Harris asked the mechanic, "When will you tear down the unit?" What did she want to know?

– when the unit will be in town
– when the unit will be sold
– **when the unit will be disassembled** [CORRECT]
– when the unit will be assembled

Explanation. In mechanical and military maintenance vocabulary, to "tear down" a unit means to take it apart into its component pieces for inspection, repair or overhaul. "Disassembled" is the direct synonym. "when the unit will be assembled" is incorrect because assembling is the opposite operation — putting the parts back together.

54. The sailor can steer that small boat. (What does this mean?)

– **He can guide it.** [CORRECT]
– He can get in it.
– He can take pictures of it.
– -10% _____ -10%

Explanation. The verb "steer" means to control the direction of a vessel or vehicle. In a naval or maritime context, a sailor steering a boat is responsible for guiding it along a specific course or path. Therefore, "guide" is the most accurate synonym for "steer" in this sentence. "He can get in it." is incorrect because entering a boat is not the same as directing it. The verb"steer"means to control the direction of a vessel or vehicle. In a naval or maritime context, a sailor steering a boat is responsible for guiding it along a specific course or path. Therefore, "guide" is the most accurate synonym for "steer" in this sentence.

55. I'm running short of cash this week. (What does this mean?)

– **I'm getting low on money.** [CORRECT]
– I'm looking for a lost check.
– I'm getting lots of money.

Explanation. The idiom "running short of" something means that you are close to using up your entire supply or that you do not have enough of it left. In this context, "cash" refers to money. Therefore, "running short of cash" directly translates to having very little money remaining for the rest of the week. The idiom "running short of" something means that you are close to using up your entire supply or that you do not have enough of it left. In this context, "cash" refers to money. Therefore, "running short of cash"directly translates to having very little money remaining for the rest of the week. "I'm looking for a lost check." is incorrect because the adidas Tenis Run falcon 6 ATR...

56. You must tell the attorney nothing but the truth. (What does this mean?)

– Tell him part of the truth.
– Tell him nothing at all.
– Tell him all lies.
– **Tell him only the truth.** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The expression "nothing but the truth" is a fixed legal formula meaning exclusively the truth, with nothing false added. It therefore means to tell him only the truth. "Tell him nothing at all." is incorrect because it misreads "nothing but" as a simple negation.

65. "Where are we going to camp?" "There's a good place over by those big trees." What will they do?

– **sleep overnight** [CORRECT]
– eat a big lunch

Explanation. In English, the verb "to camp" means to set up a temporary shelter, such as a tent, and stay there for a period of time, typically overnight. In a military context, this is similar to establishing a bivouac or a temporary encampment for rest. The dialogue indicates the speakers are looking for a location to perform this activity, which directly implies they will be staying through the night.

74. There were _____ dishes on the floor.

– broke
– **broken** [CORRECT]
– break

Explanation. In this sentence, an adjective is needed to describe the state or condition of the "dishes" found on the floor. In English, the past participle form of a verb (V3) is frequently used as an adjective to describe a completed action or a resulting state. "Broken" is the past participle of the verb "break" and correctly modifies the noun "dishes." In this sentence, an adjective is needed to describe the state or condition of the"dishes"found on the floor. In English, the past participle form of a verb (V3) is frequently used as an adjective to describe a completed action or a resulting state.

77. I will be at the meeting if I _____ get away.

– ought to
– will
– might
– **can** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The conditional clause needs a modal of ability. "Can" expresses the capability of getting away from another obligation, which is the condition for attending the meeting. "might" is incorrect because it expresses possibility rather than ability, and it is not normally combined with "if" in this way.

79. He cut the meat into pieces. (Select the closest synonym.)

– **carved** [CORRECT]
– bought
– cleaned

Explanation. In the context of food and dining, the verb "to carve" specifically refers to the act of cutting cooked meat into slices or pieces so that it can be served. Therefore, "carved" is a direct synonym for "cut the meat into pieces" in this sentence. "bought" is incorrect because it means to have purchased the meat, which relates to a transaction. In the context of food and dining, the verb "to carve" specifically refers to the act of cutting cooked meat into slices or pieces so that it can be served. meat into pieces" in this sentence.

82. Jack will insert the paper. (Select the closest synonym for "insert".)

– **put in** [CORRECT]
– buy
– exchange

Explanation. The verb "insert" means to place, fit, or thrust something into something else. In this context, Jack is placing a piece of paper into a device (like a printer or a typewriter). "Put in" is a phrasal verb that serves as a direct synonym for "insert." "buy" is incorrect because it means to purchase something with money, which does not relate to placing an object. The verb "insert" means to place, fit, or thrust something into something else. In this context, Jack is placing a piece of paper into a device (like a printer as a direct synonym for "insert." "buy" is incorrect because it means to purchase _something_with money, which does not relate to the adidas?

86. The NCO expects his men _____ the proper uniform.

– wear
– be wearing
– **to wear** [CORRECT]
– are wearing

Explanation. The verb "expect" follows a specific grammatical pattern when it involves an object performing an action: "expect + object + to-infinitive." In this sentence, "the NCO" is the subject, "his men" is the object, and "to wear" is the to-infinitive required to complete the structure. This is a common way to express requirements or anticipated behavior in military leadership contexts. The verb "expect" follows a specific grammatical pattern when it involves an object performing an action: "expect + object + to-infinitive." In this sentence,"the Nco" is the subject, "his men" is the object, and "to wear" is the to-infinitive required to complete the structure. This is a common way to express requirements or anticipated behavior in military leadership contexts. to wear are wearing :jor del regreso a clases es est re nar y _____ ABRIR > ① lej or que hacerlo con adidas.

87. After _____ the money, he put it in the safe.

– count
– to count
– **counting** [CORRECT]

Explanation. In this sentence, "After" functions as a preposition. In English grammar, prepositions are followed by nouns or gerunds (the -ing form of a verb). Using the gerund "counting" correctly completes the phrase, indicating the action performed before the main clause. The subject of the sentence ("he") is the one who performed the counting. In this sentence, "After" functions as a preposition. In English grammar, prepositions are followed by nouns or gerunds (the -ing form of a verb). Using the gerund "counting" correctly completes the phrase, indicating the action performed before the main clause. The subject of the sentence("he") is the one who performed the counting. adidas?

91. It happened at 10 o'clock. (Select the closest synonym for "happened".)

– **took place** [CORRECT]
– came
– took charge

Explanation. The phrase "took place" is a common idiomatic expression that means to happen or occur. In the sentence "It happened at 10 o'clock," the verb "happened" can be replaced by "took place" without changing the meaning of the statement, indicating that an event occurred at a specific time. "came" is incorrect because it refers to arrival or movement toward a place. The phrase"took place" is a common idiomatic expression that means to happen or occur. In the sentence "It happened at 10 o'clock," the verb "happened" can be replaced by "took place" without changing the meaning of the statement, indicating that an event occurred at a specific time. "came" is. incorrect because it refers to arrival or adidas?

92. Go to sick call right away. (What does this mean?)

– **go at once** [CORRECT]
– walk straight
– run away
– -10% _____ -10%

Explanation. In English, the phrase "right away" is an idiomatic expression meaning immediately, without delay, or at once. In a military context, "sick call" refers to the scheduled time when service members report for medical attention. Telling someone to go to sick call "right away" means they should report for medical evaluation immediately. In English, the phrase "right away" is an idiomatic expression meaning immediately,without delay, or at once. In a military context, "sick call" refers to the scheduled time when service members report for medical attention. Telling someone to go to sick call "right away" means they should report for medical evaluation immediately.

93. When will Ray wind up the job? (Select the closest synonym for "wind up".)

– **finish** [CORRECT]
– motivate
– join
– -10% _____ -10%

Explanation. The phrasal verb "wind up" is an idiomatic expression that means to bring something to a conclusion or to end a process. In the context of a job or a task, asking when someone will "wind up the job" is synonymous with asking when they will finish or complete it. This is a common phrase used in both general and military environments when discussing project timelines or operational phases. The phrasal verb"wind up" is an idiomatic expression that means to bring something to a conclusion or to end a process. In the context of a job or a task, asking when someone will "wind up the job" is synonymous with asking when they will finish or complete it. This is a common phrase used in both general and military environments when discussing project timelines or operational phases.

94. Mr. Stein's recital was _____ one yet.

– **the most pallid** [CORRECT]
– more pallid
– more pallid than

Explanation. This sentence requires a superlative adjective because it compares one specific recital to all of Mr. Stein's previous recitals (indicated by the word "yet"). In English, superlatives for multi-syllable adjectives are formed using "the most" + the adjective. The word "one" acts as the noun being modified, necessitating the definite article "the". Therefore, "the most pallid" is the only grammatically complete and correct choice.

95. Those immigrants _____ two months by the first of October.

– should be detained
– can detain
– **will have been detained** [CORRECT]
– will detain

Explanation. This sentence requires the Future Perfect Passive tense. The time marker "by the first of October" indicates a point in the future by which an action or state will be completed. The phrase "two months" indicates the duration of that state. In English, the construction "by + [future time]" typically triggers the Future Perfect tense ("will have + past participle"). Because immigrants are the ones being held by authorities (they are the receivers of the action), the passive voice ("been detained") must be used. This sentence requires the Future Perfect Passive tense. The time marker"by the first of October" indicates a point in the future by which an action or state will be completed. The phrase "two months" indicates the duration of that state. In English, the construction "by + [future time]" typically triggers the Future Perfect tense ("will have + past participle"). Because immigrants are the ones being held by authorities (they are the receivers of the action), the passive voice ("been detained") must be used.

98. When you loosen this nut, it will _____ .

– be tightened
– **come off** [CORRECT]
– crack
– stay tight

Explanation. To "loosen" a nut means to rotate it in a direction that reduces tension or unscrews it. In a mechanical context, the logical progression of loosening a nut is that it will eventually detach from the bolt or stud. The phrasal verb "come off" correctly describes this action of detaching or becoming removed. "be tightened" is incorrect because it is the antonym of loosening; tightening increases tension, whereas loosening decreases it. To "loosen" a nut means to rotate it in a direction that reduces tension or unscrews it. In a mechanical context, the logical progression of loosening a nut is that it will eventually detach from the bolt or stud. The phrasal verb"come off" correctly describes this action of detaching or becoming removed. "be tightened" is incorrect because it is the antonym of loosening; tightening increases tension, whereas loosening decreases it.

100. Matthew loves to _____ about his exploits on the football field.

– distort
– utter
– **boast** [CORRECT]
– impart

Explanation. To "boast" means to speak with excessive pride or self-satisfaction about one's achievements, possessions, or abilities. In English, this verb is commonly paired with the preposition "about." Given the context of "exploits" (which are bold, daring, or successful feats), "boast" is the most natural and logically fitting choice for the sentence. "distort" is incorrect because it means to twist out of shape or to misrepresent.

Form 71

93. Watch out for speeding cars on the expressway.

– Look at
– **Be careful of** [CORRECT]
– Glance at
– Take care of

Explanation. The phrasal verb "watch out for" is an idiomatic expression used to warn someone to be alert, vigilant, or cautious regarding a potential danger or hazard. In the context of an expressway with speeding cars, it serves as a safety warning to remain attentive to avoid accidents. "Look at" is incorrect because it simply means to direct your eyes toward something to see it, whereas "watch out for" implies a specific need for safety and caution.

94. Mary should _____ more film for her camera when she was shopping.

– had gotten
– get
– be getting
– **have gotten** [CORRECT]

Explanation. This sentence requires a past modal construction because the context "when she was shopping" indicates an action that took place in the past. To express a past obligation, recommendation, or a missed opportunity that did not happen, English uses the structure should + have + past participle. In this case, "should have gotten" indicates that Mary was supposed to buy film in the past, but she didn't. "had gotten" is incorrect because modal verbs like "should" cannot be followed by "had". This sentence requires a past modal construction because the context "when she was shopping' indicates an action that took place in the past. To express a past obligation, recommendation, or a missed opportunity that did not happen, English uses the structure should + have + past participle. In this case, "should have gotten" indicates that Mary was supposed to buy film in the past, but she didn't.

Form 72

9. Betty wants some rice.

– **food** [CORRECT]
– help
– rest
– water

Explanation. Rice is a cereal grain that isa staple item of nourishment globally. In this context,"rice" is a specific type of "food." The statement indicates that Betty desires something to eat. "rest"is incorrect because rice is a physical item consumed for nutrition,while rest refers to sleep or a period of inactivity to recover strength. Rice is a cereal grain that is a staple item of nourishment globally. In this context, "rice" is a specific type of "food." The statement indicates that Betty desires something to eat. "rest" is incorrect because rice is a physical item consumed for nutrition, while rest refers to sleep or a period of inactivity to recover strength.

10. Colonel Manning can't take the quiz.

– mail
– **test** [CORRECT]
– book
– call

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

26. The children will slide on the ice.

– **They will slip.** [CORRECT]
– They will sit.

Explanation. The verb“slide"means to move smoothly along a surface while maintaining continuous contact with it. Among the choices provided, "slip" is the most appropriate synonym in the context of moving on ice, as it describes the action of sliding unintentionally or moving easily over a slick surface. "They will sit." is incorrect because sitting involves resting on a surface and remaining stationary,which contradicts the moye ment implied by sliding. imi ey Willldik. The verb "slide" means to move smoothly along a surface while maintaining continuous contact with it. Among the choices provided, "slip" is the most appropriate synonym in the context of moving on ice, as it describes the action of sliding unintentionally or moving easily over a slick surface.

29. Each man was asked to arrange the objects on the table. What were they asked to do?

– **put them in order** [CORRECT]
– clean them carefully
– take them off the table
– throw them out

Explanation. The verb“arrange” means to organize, classify, or place items in a specific sequence or pattern. In this context,asking someone to arrange objects on a table is synonymous with asking them to put those objects in order. This is a common action verb used gear, or logistical items. The verb "arrange" means to organize, classify, or place items in a specific sequence or pattern. In this context, asking someone to arrange objects on a table is synonymous with asking them to put those objects in order. This is a common action verb used in military instructions for organizing equipment, gear, or logistical items.

32. Bill asked Jane to meet him for breakfast. Where will Bill and Jane meet?

– for breakfast
– at 7 a.m.
– **at the cafeteria** [CORRECT]
– bacon and eggs

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

42. They paid an average price for the house.

– The price was very high.
– The price was a little high.
– **The price was about normal.** [CORRECT]
– The price was less than normal.

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

46. Why did the wallpaper come off the wall?

– The print was no good.
– **The paste was no good.** [CORRECT]
– The cloth was no good.
– The color was no good.

Explanation. Wallpaper is applied to walls using a specific type of adhesive known as paste. If the wallpaper"comes off" the wall, it means the bonding agent failed. Therefore,the logical reason for the wallpaper detaching is that the paste was poor quality or ineffective. This question tests the understanding of cause-and-effect relationships and vocabulary related to household items and adhesives. Wallpaper is applied to walls using a specific type of adhesive known as paste. If the wallpaper "comes off" the wall, it means the bonding agent failed. Therefore, the logical reason for the wallpaper detaching is that the paste was poor quality or ineffective. This question tests the understanding of cause-and-effect relationships and vocabulary related to household items and adhesives.

49. The plane encountered a strong Tailwind. Which direction did the wind come from?

– **the back** [CORRECT]
– the front

Explanation. In aviation and nautical contexts,a tailwind is defined as a wind that blows in the same direction as the object is traveling,meaning it comes from behind or the back of the aircraft.A tailwind increases the aircraft's ground speed. "the front"is incorrect because wind coming from the front is called a headwind,which slows the aircraft down. In aviation and nautical contexts, a tailwind is defined as a wind that blows in the same direction as the object is traveling, meaning it comes from behind or the back of the aircraft. A tailwind increases the aircraft's ground speed. "the front" is incorrect because wind coming from the front is called a headwind, which slows the aircraft down.

51. Be careful or you may trigger your rifle by accident.

– **You may fire it.** [CORRECT]
– You may shove it around.
– You may drop it.

Explanation. In a military or firearms context, the verb "trigger" refers to the action of pulling the trigger mechanism on a weapon. This action causes the rifle to discharge or fire. Therefore, to"trigger your rifle” means to accidentally discharge a round. "You may drop it." is incorrect because triggering a weapon involves the internal firing mechanism, whereas dropping it refers to losing physical control or grip of the entire object. In a military or firearms context, the verb "trigger" refers to the action of pulling the trigger mechanism on a weapon. This action causes the rifle to discharge or fire. Therefore, to "trigger your rifle" means to accidentally discharge a round. "You may drop it." is incorrect because triggering a weapon involves the internal firing mechanism, whereas dropping it refers to losing physical control or trip of the entire object.

54. Everyone agrees that Bert is highly motivated.

– **inspired** [CORRECT]
– reserved

Explanation. In this context, "motivated" means having a strong desire, enthusiasm, or drive to accomplish a goal. In military and professional environments,a motivated individual is someone eager to perform their duties and excel."Inspired" is the closest synonym among the choices, as it implies being filled with the urge or energy to do something productive or creative. In this context,"motivated" means having a strong desire, enthusiasm, or drive to accomplish a goal. In military and professional environments, a motivated individual is someone eager to perform their duties and excel. "Inspired" is the closest synonym among the choices, as it implies being filled with the urge or energy to do something productive or creative.

55. Virgil has outgrown all his clothes.

– **too small** [CORRECT]
– worn out

Explanation. The verb“outgrow”means to grow too large for something, such as a piece of clothing.When a person grows physically and their clothes no longer fit because they are insufficient in size, we say the clothes have become "too small" for them. In a military context,this often refers to recruits or personnel needing new uniform sizes due to physical training and growth. The verb "outgrow" means to grow too large for something, such as a piece of clothing. When a person grows physically and their clothes no longer fit because they are insufficient in size, we say the clothes have become "too small" for them. In a military context, this often refers to recruits or personnel needing new uniform sizes due to physical training and growth.

56. Joe always has pastry for breakfast.

– **sweet rolls** [CORRECT]
– cereal

Explanation. In English, a "pastry" is a baked food item made from a dough of flour,fat,and water. It is often sweet. Among the choices provided, "sweet rolls" are a specific type of baked bread-likeproduct that falls under the category of pastry.This question tests the ability to identify synonyms or category members within a breakfast context. In English, a "pastry" is a baked food item made from a dough of flour, fat, and water. It is often sweet. Among the choices provided,"sweet rolls"are a specific type of baked bread-like product that falls under the category of pastry. This question tests the ability to identify synonyms or category members within a breakfast context.

64. House Bob doing he's okay now he just needed some first aid treatment. What did Bob need?

– **medical care before the doctor arrived** [CORRECT]
– help with his lessons before the teacher arrived
– bodybuilding exercises and good food
– some advice about his location

Explanation. (Explanation screen not captured yet.)

72. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **direct from the garden** [CORRECT]
– frozen

Explanation. In this context, the word“fresh"refers to food that has been recently harvested and has not been preserved, processed, or stored for a long time. Vegetables that come“direct from the garden"are the definition of fresh because they have just been picked and retain their natural quality and moisture. In this context, the word "fresh" refers to food that has been recently harvested and has not been preserved, processed, or stored for a long time. Vegetables that come"direct from the garden" are the definition of fresh because they have just been picked and retain their natural quality and moisture.

74. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **John IS able to play.** [CORRECT]
– John is probably playing.
– John ought to play.
– John likes to play.

Explanation. The modal verb "can" is used to express ability, capability, or the knowledge of how to do something. In the sentence "John can play tennis," the speaker is stating that John has the ability to play the game. The phrase "is able to" is the standard grammatical equivalent used to express this same meaning. "John likes to play." is incorrect because it expresses a preference or enjoyment (affection), which is not what "can" implies.

77. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **to write** [CORRECT]
– (Options screen not captured yet.)

Explanation. The verb "like" is a verb of preference that can be followed by either a gerund (verb ending in -ing) or an infinitive (to + base form of the verb). In the context of the sentence, "Sgt. Brown enjoys writing letters," the word "enjoys" is followed by the gerund "writing.' To maintain the same meaning in the second sentence, "likes" must be followed by a compatible form.

83. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **too old** [CORRECT]
– too small

Explanation. The idiomatic expression "worn out" describes an object that has been used so much that it is no longer in good condition or useful. In military and general English, when equipment or clothing is "worn out," it implies that the items have reached the end of their service life and are "too old"or decayed to be effective.

87. We saw the adjutant.

– next door to the Joneses lives who
– next door to the Joneses who lives
– who lives to the Joneses next door
– **who lives next door to the Joneses** [CORRECT]

Explanation. This question tests the correct structure of a relative clause. The relative pronoun"who" must immediately follow the noun it modifies ("the adjutant"), followed by the verb ("lives") and the adverbial phrase indicating location ("next door to the Joneses"). In a military context, an adjutant is an officer who assists a commanding officer with administrative tasks.

93. (Question stem not captured yet — only the explanation screen was sent.)

– **move into his house** [CORRECT]
– (Options screen not captured yet.)

Explanation. The idiomatic phrase "get settled in" refers to the process of becoming comfortable and organized after moving to a new place. It involves unpacking belongings, arranging furniture, and establishing a daily routine in a new home or office environment. In a military context, this often refers to the period after a Permanent Change of Station (PcS) when a service member arrives at a new duty station and establishes their residence.

Form 73

3. Have you decided what kind of car you want?

– Have you the kind of car you want?
– Have you driven the car you want?
– Have you bought the car you want?
– **Have you made up your mind about which car you want?** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The question asks if the person has "decided" on a choice. In English, the idiom "to make up one's mind" is a common synonymous expression for "to decide." Both phrases refer to the cognitive process of reaching a conclusion or selecting an option after consideration. "Have you the kind of car you want?" is incorrect because it asks about current possession.

4. He's going to the grocery store. What will he buy?

– **milk and bread** [CORRECT]
– posts and wires
– nails and lumber

Explanation. A grocery store is a retail establishment that primarily sells food products and various household items. "milk and bread" are classic examples of items purchased at a grocery store. This question tests the association between a specific location and the common items associated with it. "posts and wires" is incorrect because these are materials used for fencing and are typically sold at hardware or farm supply stores. A grocery store is a retail establishment that primarily sells food products and various household items. "milk and bread" are classic examples of items purchased at a grocery store. This question tests the association between a specific location and the common items associated with it. posts and wires" is incorrect because these are materials used for fencing and are typically sold at hardware or farm supply stores, not grocery stores.

15. The bellboy took my suitcase. What did he take?

– my purse
– **my bag** [CORRECT]
– my coat
– my key

Explanation. The noun "suitcase" refers to a large bag used for carrying personal belongings, particularly clothes, when traveling. Among the options provided, "my bag" is the most appropriate synonym for "suitcase." In military and general travel contexts, these terms are often used interchangeably to refer to luggage. "my purse" is incorrect because a purse is a small bag typically used for carrying money and small personal items. The noun "suitcase" refers to a large bag used for carrying personal belongings, particularly clothes, when traveling. Among the options provided, "my bag" is the most appropriate synonym for"suitcase." In military and general travel contexts, these terms are often used interchangeably to refer to luggage.

17. Did the commander have a fever yesterday? (The audio transcript renders "commander" as "comedone".)

– Yes, he received a gift.
– **Yes, he was ill.** [CORRECT]
– Yes, he was angry.
– Yes, he gave a party.

Explanation. The word "fever" refers to an abnormally high body temperature, which is a common symptom of being sick or "ill." Asking if someone had a fever is a way to inquire about their physical health. Therefore, the response "Yes, he was ill" directly correlates to the medical condition mentioned. The word "fever" refers to an abnormally high body temperature, which is a common symptom of being sick or "ill." In the context of the question (likely containing a typo where "come done" should be "commander"), asking if someone had a fever is a way to inquire about their physical health. Therefore, the response "Yes, he was ill" directly correlates to the medical condition mentioned.

23. Edward said, "I'm looking forward to seeing my family." What did he mean?

– **He is expecting to see them.** [CORRECT]
– He is leaving his family.
– He has already seen them.

Explanation. The idiomatic expression "looking forward to" means to anticipate a future event with pleasure or excitement. In this context, Edward is expressing that he anticipates and is happy about the upcoming visit or meeting with his family. It implies a future event that is expected to happen. "He is leaving his family." is incorrect because "looking forward to seeing" implies approaching or meeting them, not departing from them.

25. Margaret looks like her father. (What does this mean?)

– **She resembles her father.** [CORRECT]
– She is looking for her father.
– She looks after her father.
– She is fond of her father.

Explanation. The phrase "looks like" is a common expression used to indicate physical resemblance or having a similar appearance to someone else. In this sentence, it means Margaret has a physical appearance similar to her father. "She is looking for her father." is incorrect because "looking for" means to search for someone or something that is lost or missing.

28. Rufus told Jim to meet him right here. Where should Jim meet him?

– **at this exact location** [CORRECT]
– in about an hour
– a block from here
– at the movie

Explanation. The expression "right here" uses "right" as an intensifier meaning "exactly" or "precisely." It therefore designates the exact spot where the speaker is standing. "a block from here" is incorrect because it indicates a different location some distance away.

30. The animals are being kept in a pen. Why were they put there?

– **so they couldn't escape** [CORRECT]
– so they couldn't grow

Explanation. The word "pin" in the sentence is a phonetic misspelling of "pen," which refers to a small fenced enclosure for animals (such as livestock or pets). The primary purpose of placing animals in a pen is to provide containment. Therefore, the most logical reason for putting them there is to prevent them from wandering off or escaping. In ALCPT listening contexts, identifying the function of common objects or enclosures is a frequent task. The word "pin" in the sentence is a phonetic misspelling of "pen," which refers to a small fenced enclosure for animals (such as livestock or pets). The primary purpose of placing animals in a pen is to provide containment. Therefore, the most logical reason for putting them there is to prevent them from wandering off or escaping. In Al cpt listening contexts, identifying the function of common objects or enclosures is a frequent task.

33. Bob slept in the open. Where did he sleep?

– **outside** [CORRECT]
– inside
– upstairs

Explanation. The phrase "in the open" is an idiomatic expression meaning outdoors or in an unsheltered area, exposed to the sky. In a military context, sleeping "in the open" refers to sleeping without a tent, barracks, or overhead cover, typically during field exercises or deployment. "upstairs" is incorrect because "in the open" implies being outdoors, whereas "upstairs" refers to a level within a building.

34. The watchman looked downward. Where did he look?

– **to the bottom** [CORRECT]
– to one side
– to the back

Explanation. The word "downward" is an adverb used to describe movement or direction toward a lower place, point, or level. In the sentence "The watchman looked downward," the watchman is looking toward the ground or the base of his position. Therefore, "to the bottom" is the synonymous phrase that correctly identifies where he looked. "to one side" is incorrect because it describes a lateral or horizontal direction (left or right). The word "downward" is an adverb used to describe movement or direction toward a lower place, point, or level. In the sentence "The Watchmen looked downward," the watchman is looking toward the ground or the base of his position. Therefore, "to the bottom" is the synonymous phrase that correctly identifies where he looked.

35. Was the light blinking?

– **Yes, it was flashing.** [CORRECT]
– Yes, it was bright.
– Yes, it was off.

Explanation. The word "blinking" in the context of lights refers to a light that repeatedly turns on and off or fluctuates in intensity. "Flashing" is the most accurate synonym for this action. In military and aviation contexts, identifying light signals (blinking, flashing, steady) is crucial for communication and safety. "Yes, it was off." is incorrect because "blinking" implies the light was active and visible at intervals.

39. The top of the table was rough. (What does this mean?)

– The top was dirty.
– The top was shiny.
– **The top was not smooth.** [CORRECT]
– The top wasn't hard.

Explanation. The word "rough" is an adjective used to describe a surface that is uneven, coarse, or irregular. In the context of a table top, "rough" is the direct antonym of "smooth." Therefore, saying the top was rough means it was not smooth. "The top was dirty." is incorrect because "rough" refers to the physical texture of the surface, whereas "dirty" refers to the presence of grime or soil.

42. 027:17 _____ 43% 43/100.

– The road had a bend.
– The road had a line.
– The road was wide.
– The road was not long.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

46. Why does he have difficulty reading small print?

– He can't afford books.
– **His sight is poor.** [CORRECT]
– He can't borrow books.
– His printing is poor.

Explanation. The phrase "small print" refers to text that is written or printed in very small characters. If a person has difficulty reading small print, it is usually because their vision or "sight" is not sharp enough to distinguish the small letters. In a military or general context, this indicates a need for corrective lenses or a medical evaluation of one's eyesight. "He can't afford books." is incorrect because a person's financial ability to buy books is unrelated to visual acuity.

48. Bob jumped into the water head first. What did he do?

– **He dived in.** [CORRECT]
– He entered the water before anyone else.
– He went in with his feet first.
– He entered the water without looking at it first.

Explanation. To jump into water "head first" is the standard definition of the verb "to dive." In this action, the head enters the water surface before any other part of the body. "He entered the water before anyone else." is incorrect because "head first" refers to physical orientation during the jump, not the chronological order of people entering the water.

49. Joe heard a rumor that the airbase was going to close. What did he hear?

– a statement of fact
– an official statement
– a statement of authority
– **an unconfirmed statement** [CORRECT]

Explanation. A "rumor" is a piece of information or a story circulating among people whose truth has not been verified. Therefore, hearing a rumor means hearing an unconfirmed statement. "an official statement" is incorrect because official statements come from an authorized source and are verified, which is the opposite of a rumor.

50. Rush this order through. (What does this mean?)

– **Get it out in a hurry.** [CORRECT]
– Examine it carefully.
– Check to see if it is all there.

Explanation. The phrasal verb "rush through" means to handle, process, or complete a task or order with extreme speed and urgency. In a military or logistics context, if someone is told to rush an order through, it means they need to prioritize it and ensure it is dispatched or finished as quickly as possible, bypassing standard delays. "Examine it carefully." is incorrect because rushing implies speed, which is often the opposite of a slow, careful review. The phrasal verb "rush through" means to handle, process, or complete a task or order with extreme speed and urgency. In a military or logistics context, if someone is told to rush an order through, it means they need to prioritize it and ensure it is dispatched or finished as quickly as possible, bypassing standard delays. "Examine it carefully." is incorrect because rushing implies speed, which is often the opposite of a slow, Check to see if it is all there.

52. That table is not level. (What does this mean?)

– **One end is lower than the other.** [CORRECT]
– It isn't large enough.
– It isn't suitable.
– One side is longer than the other.

Explanation. The word "level" describes a surface that is perfectly horizontal and flat, with no part higher or lower than another. If a table is not level, it is tilted or slanted, which means one end or side is lower than the other. This is a common term used in carpentry, construction, and general maintenance. "It isn't large enough." is incorrect because size (area) is not related to being level (horizontal orientation). :--it nstrt su icao ie.

53. He broke away from the crowd. (What does this mean?)

– **He freed himself from the crowd.** [CORRECT]
– He got some news from the crowd.
– He joined the crowd.
– He encircled the crowd.

Explanation. The phrasal verb "break away" means to escape from a physical hold, to separate oneself from a group, or to leave a situation. In this sentence, it indicates that the person detached himself or moved out from among the people in the crowd. "He got some news from the crowd." is incorrect because "break away" refers to physical or social separation, not the reception of information. The phrasal verb"break away" means to escape from a physical hold, to separate oneself from a group, or to leave a situation. In this sentence, it indicates that the person detached himself or moved out from among the people in the crowd. "He got some news from the crowd." is incorrect because"break away" refers to physical or social separation, not the reception of information.

54. My neighbor's child is terribly spoiled. He is _____ .

– dirty
– **overindulged** [CORRECT]
– sleepy
– aggressive

Explanation. In this context, the adjective "spoiled" refers to a child who behaves badly because they are given everything they want and are not disciplined. The word "overindulged" is a perfect synonym, as it means to allow someone to have or do everything they want to such an extent that it has a bad effect on their character. "dirty" is incorrect because it refers to physical cleanliness and does not relate to a child's behavioral condition. In this context, the adjective "spoiled" refers to a child who behaves badly because they are given everything they want and are not disciplined. The word "over indulged" is a perfect synonym, as it means to allow someone to have or do everything they want to such an extent that it has a bad effect on their character.

55. Why did the police set up a barricade?

– **to block traffic** [CORRECT]
– to let the people through
– to clear the road

Explanation. A barricade is a physical barrier, obstacle, or structure used to obstruct or control the passage of people or vehicles. In police or military contexts, setting up a barricade is specifically done to stop movement through a designated area. Therefore, "to block traffic" is the primary purpose of this action. "to let the people through" is incorrect because a barricade is intended to prevent passage, not facilitate it.

56. Sue's eyes are puffy. They are _____ .

– red
– sore
– **swollen** [CORRECT]
– black

Explanation. The word "puffy" is used to describe a condition where a part of the body, such as the eyes or face, appears distended, bloated, or larger than normal due to fluid retention, inflammation, lack of sleep, or crying. The direct synonym for this physical state is "swollen." "red" is incorrect because it refers to the color of the eyes (often bloodshot or irritated), which describes discoloration rather than physical distension.

57. "What are you going to do this afternoon?" "I'm going to go shopping." What is the woman going to do?

– **go shopping** [CORRECT]
– get something to eat
– visit some friends

Explanation. In this dialogue interpretation task, the woman states her intention for the afternoon by saying she is going to "go shopping." This phrase indicates that her plan is to visit retail stores to browse or purchase items. The question asks what she is going to do, confirming her previously stated intent. "get something to eat" is incorrect because the speaker did not mention hunger or a plan to visit a restaurant or cafe. In this dialogue interpretation task, the woman states her intention for the afternoon by saying she is going to "go shopping." This phrase indicates that her plan is to visit retail stores to browse or purchase items. The question asks what she is going to do, confirming her previously stated intent. get something to eat" is incorrect because the speaker did not mention hunger or a plan to visit a restaurant or cafe.

60. "Why do you keep doing that?" "I'm trying to develop my muscles." What does the man want to do?

– work hard
– be happy
– **become stronger** [CORRECT]
– think better

Explanation. To "develop one's muscles" means to build muscle mass and physical power through exercise. The direct result and purpose of that activity is to become stronger. "think better" is incorrect because developing muscles concerns physical capability, not cognitive performance.

66. "What's the matter, Jane?" "I have a cut on my heel." Where is the injury?

– back
– hand
– **foot** [CORRECT]
– arm

Explanation. The word "heel" refers to the back part of the human foot, located below the ankle. Therefore, if Jane has a cut on her heel, the injury is located on her foot. This question tests basic anatomical vocabulary in English. "back" is incorrect because the heel is an anatomical part of the lower limb, not the posterior part of the torso.

81. The lecture is boring. (What does this mean?)

– **It is dull.** [CORRECT]
– It is very interesting.
– It is on a subject I like.
– It is a fine lecture.

Explanation. The word "boring" describes something that is not interesting or causes a person to feel weary or restless. "Dull" is a precise synonym for boring, meaning lacking interest or excitement. Therefore, the two sentences convey the same meaning. "It is very interesting." is incorrect because it is the antonym (opposite) of boring.

82. The student told his roommate, "You can count on me." (What does this mean?)

– **depend on me** [CORRECT]
– count for me
– tell my age

Explanation. The phrase "count on [someone]" is a common English idiom and phrasal verb that means to rely on or trust someone to be helpful or to do what they promised. In this context, the student is telling his roommate that he is reliable and can be trusted to help or be there when needed. Therefore, "depend on me" is the correct synonymous expression. "count for me" is incorrect because it changes the preposition and implies performing a mathematical operation.

83. He thought about buying a new car. (Select the closest synonym for "thought about".)

– **considered** [CORRECT]
– intended to
– looked for

Explanation. The phrase "thought about" followed by a gerund ("buying") describes the process of mental deliberation or contemplation before making a decision. In English, "to consider" is a direct synonym for "to think about" in this context. Both indicate that the subject was weighing the options of an action. "intended to" is incorrect because "intended" implies a more firm plan or a resolved decision to act.

85. Those books are _____ .

– their
– **theirs** [CORRECT]
– them

Explanation. The sentence requires a possessive pronoun to show ownership and avoid repeating the noun "books." In English, possessive pronouns (such as mine, yours, his, hers, ours, and theirs) stand alone and do not require a following noun. "Theirs" effectively replaces the phrase "the students' books." "their" is incorrect because it is a possessive adjective, which must always be followed by a noun (e.g., "their books").

86. If the mechanic _____ here, he would have charged us for the repair.

– am
– **had been** [CORRECT]

Explanation. This sentence uses the Third Conditional structure, which refers to an impossible past condition and its probable past result. These situations are hypothetical because they are now in the past and didn't happen. The grammatical pattern for the third conditional is: If + Subject + Past Perfect (had + past participle), Subject + would have + past participle. Since the second part of the sentence is "would have charged," the conditional "if" clause must use the past perfect form "had been."

91. Go to sick call right away. (What does this mean?)

– **go at once** [CORRECT]
– go to the right
– walk straight
– run away

Explanation. The phrase "right away" is an idiomatic adverbial expression meaning "immediately," "without delay," or "at once." In military terminology, "sick call" refers to a scheduled period or location where service members can report for medical evaluation. The sentence conveys an instruction to seek medical help immediately. "go to the right" is incorrect because it treats the word "right" as a physical direction rather than an intensifier. The phrase "right away" is an idiomatic adverbial "at once." In military terminology, "sick call" refers to a scheduled period or location where service members can report for medical evaluation. The sentence conveys an instruction to seek medical help immediately.

93. The deer _____ the fence to get into the vegetable garden.

– arranged to
– stood up
– **leaped over** [CORRECT]
– climbed into

Explanation. Deer are well-known for their physical ability to jump high and clear obstacles. The phrase "leaped over" correctly describes the action of a deer clearing a fence to enter a garden. This is the most idiomatic and biologically accurate verb choice for the subject "deer." "arranged to" is incorrect because it is a transitive verb phrase that requires a following action (e.g., arranged to jump). Deer are well-known for their physical ability to jump high and clear obstacles. The phrase "leaped over' correctly describes the action of a deer clearing a fence to enter a garden.

94. I'd like to have this suit _____ .

– **cleaned** [CORRECT]
– cleanly
– cleaning
– cleans

Explanation. This sentence uses the causative structure "have + object + past participle," which expresses that the subject arranges for someone else to perform an action on the object. The suit does not clean itself; it receives the action. Therefore, the past participle "cleaned" is the correct form. "cleaning" is incorrect because it would imply the suit is performing the action.

95. Our teacher didn't come, so we _____ .

– told
– tell
– **were told** [CORRECT]
– were telling

Explanation. The sentence requires the passive voice because the students (the subject 'we') were the recipients of information. Since the first part of the sentence uses the past simple ('didn't come'), the result of that action must also be in the past. "Were told" is the past simple passive form (was/were + past participle), indicating that an authority figure or another person informed the students about the teacher's absence. "told" is incorrect because it is in the active voice. The sentence requires the passive voice because the students(the subject'we') were the recipients of information. Since the first part of the sentence uses the past simple ('didn't come'), the result of that action must also be in the past. "Were told" is the past simple passive form (was/were + past participle), indicating that an authority figure or another person informed the students about the teacher's absence.

99. The same word _____ on a different list.

– contained
– **reappeared** [CORRECT]
– typed
– introduced

Explanation. The sentence requires an intransitive verb to describe the action of the subject ("The same word"). "Reappeared" means to appear again or show up in a different location. It functions correctly as an intransitive verb in this context, followed by the prepositional phrase "on a different list." "typed" is incorrect because it is a transitive verb; the word itself cannot perform the action of typing. The sentence requires an intransitive verb to describe the action of the subject ("The same word"). "Reappeared" means to appear again or show up in a different location. It functions correctly as an intransitive verb in this context, followed by the prepositional phrase "on a different list." 'typed" is incorrect because it is a transitive verb; the word itself can not perform the action of typing.

100. The silver was tarnished. (Select the closest synonym for "tarnished".)

– **discolored** [CORRECT]
– valuable
– antique
– shiny

Explanation. The word 'tarnished' refers to the process where a metal surface, particularly silver, loses its luster and becomes dull, dark, or stained due to a chemical reaction with air or moisture. Therefore, "discolored" is the most accurate synonym among the choices. "valuable" is incorrect because 'tarnished' describes the physical condition of the surface, not the monetary worth of the object.

Form 75

23. Jane was looking over a new car. What was she doing?

– buying a new car
– passing a new car
– **examining a new car** [CORRECT]
– driving a new car

Explanation. The phrasal verb "look over" means to inspect or examine something to check its condition or to see what it is like. When Jane is "looking over" a new car, she is performing a visual inspection or examining its features and quality. "buying a new car" is incorrect because while looking over a car is a common step before a purchase, the phrase itself refers specifically to the inspection, not the act of paying for or acquiring the vehicle.

29. Did you know that today is his birthday?

– **No, I was not aware of it.** [CORRECT]
– No, I don't care for any.
– Yes, I am hungry.
– Yes, I would like to go with you.

Explanation. The question asks about the listener's knowledge of a specific fact ("did you know...?"). In English, being "aware" is a direct synonym for "knowing" a piece of information. Therefore, stating "I was not aware of it" is the only logical response that addresses the question about knowledge regarding the birthday. "No, I don't care for any." is incorrect because this phrase is used to decline an offer of a physical item (like food or drink) rather than responding to a guest ines,hurt frr tun lyn formation Yes, I would like to go with you.

34. Did she get her mail today?

– Yes, she sent it.
– **Yes, she has it now.** [CORRECT]
– Yes, she wrote it.
– Yes, she didn't remember.

Explanation. The question asks "did she get her mail," which means "did she receive her mail." If a person gets or receives an item, they are currently in possession of it. Therefore, saying "she has it now" is the logical response to confirm she received the mail. "Yes, she sent it." is incorrect because sending mail is the act of dispatching it to someone else, which is the opposite of "getting" (receiving) mail.

36. Helen needed something to pour the milk into. What did she need?

– **ajar** [CORRECT]
– a counter
– a box
– a bag

Explanation. The question asks for an object into which milk can be poured, which necessitates a container. A jar (often transcribed as "ajar" in certain exam versions) is a cylindrical glass vessel suitable for holding liquids. The use of the preposition "into" indicates that the target must be an enclosed space or a container capable of holding a volume of liquid.

39. 40.

– washed the sheets and blankets
– put the sheets and blankets on the bed
– built our own beds
– piled the sheets and blankets on the bed
Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

40. We told the sergeant that we had already made up our beds. What had we done?

– washed the sheets and blankets
– put the sheets and blankets on the bed
– built our own beds
– piled the sheets and blankets on the bed
Correct answer. (Not shown in the screenshot — the item was captured before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. The screenshot only captures the answer choices, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded. The phrasal verb "to make up a bed" (or "make the bed") means to arrange the bedding, such as sheets, blankets, and pillows, neatly so the bed is ready for use. In a military context, making one's bed to specific standards is a routine part of morning duties and inspections.

42. The envelope was sealed.

– Someone took it.
– It got lost in the mail.
– **It was closed securely.** [CORRECT]
– No one paid any attention to it

Explanation. The word "sealed" means to fasten or close something tightly or firmly so that it is secure and can not be opened easily. In the context of an envelope, it refers to the process of sticking the flap down to protect the contents. In military and administrative contexts, sealing documents is a standard procedure to ensure confidentiality and integrity during transit. Someone took it."is incorrect because"sealed"

46. William ignited the wood. What did he do?

– **He set it on fire.** [CORRECT]
– He carried it.
– He cut it into pieces.
– He polished it.

Explanation. The verb "ignite" means to set something on fire or to cause it to start burning. In this sentence, saying William "ignited" the wood is synonymous with saying he "set it on fire." "He carried it." is incorrect because carrying refers to the physical transportation of the wood from one location to another, which has nothing to do with starting a fire.

47. Alan bought some nuts and bolts. What will he do with them?

– **fasten things together** [CORRECT]
– write things down
– clean things up
– cut things apart

Explanation. Nuts and bolts are mechanical hardware components used in tandem to secure or join parts together. A bolt is a threaded shaft, and a nut is a small metal block with a matching internal thread. that allows the user to fasten things together. This is a common technical vocabulary item in military and maintenance contexts.

54. Why does Jane have Goosebumps?

– because she is angry
– **because she is cold** [CORRECT]
– because she is tired
– because she is warm

Explanation. Goosebumps (scientifically known as pilo erection) are a common physiological response to cold temperatures. When the body gets cold, small muscles at the base of hair follicles contract, causing the hairs to stand up and small bumps to form on the skin. This is the body's attempt to trap a layer of air for insulation. While they can also be caused by strong emotions like fear or excitement, "cold" is the most standard explanation in this context.

55. Davids car is ready to fall apart.

– a rental car
– in good condition
– brand new
– **in poor condition** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The idiom "fall apart" means that something is in such bad condition that it is literally or figuratively breaking into pieces. In the context of a vehicle, stating it is "ready to fall apart" indicates that the car is extremely old, dilapidated, or poorly maintained. Therefore, it is in poor condition. "a rental car" is incorrect because the sentence describes the physical state of the vehicle, not its ownership or usage status.

56. Aunt Nelly walked over to the couch.

– start dinner
– **sit down** [CORRECT]
– wash clothes
– stand up

Explanation. In English, a couch (also known as a sofa) is a piece of furniture specifically designed for sitting or reclining. When someone "walks over to" a piece of furniture like a chair or a couch, the most logical and expected action is that they intend to use it for its primary purpose, which is to sit down. This is a common contextual inference question found in Al cpt exams to test basic vocabulary and situational logic.

65. The man _____ (listening item — the audio prompt is not visible in the screenshot).

– gambled
– goofed
– gesticulated
– gravitated

Correct answer. (Not shown in the screenshot — the item was captured before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. The screenshot only captures the answer choices, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded. In the dialogue, the speaker admits to making a mistake on a math problem. The word"goofed"is an informal English verb meaning to make a silly or careless mistake.In a military or academic context,it is often used to describe a blunder or an error in judgment or calculation.

66. Hi honey sorry I'm late am I in Tha dogg house not this time.

– was on time
– had waited long
– had fed the dog
– **was angry** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The idiom "in the doghouse" is an informal expression meaning to be in trouble or in a state of disfavor with someone, typically a spouse or partner, due to a mistake or wrongdoing. In this dialogue, the speaker is late and anticipates that their partner might be angry. When the partner says "not this time," or putting the speaker "in the doghouse" for being late.

75. You shouldn't turn here, _____ -you?

– **should** [CORRECT]
– can

Explanation. This sentence is a tag question. In English grammar, when the main clause of a sentence is negative (in this case, "shouldn't"), the tag question at the end must be positive ("should"). Additionally, the tag must use the same modal verb and subject as the main clause. Therefore, "should you?" is the correct completion.

76. John danced with Mary. the party.

– to
– **at** [CORRECT]
– in
– with

Explanation. The preposition "at" is used to indicate a person's presence at a specific event or social gathering. In meeting," or "at a concert." Therefore, "John danced with Mary at the party" is the most natural and grammatically correct way to describe the location/ event where the dancing occurred.

85. The students were. _____ with the lecture.

– bore
– boring
– to bore
– **bored** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The sentence requires an adjective to describe the emotional state or reaction of the students.In used to describe how a person feels.Because the students are the ones experiencing the lack of interest,"bored"is the correct choice.This is a common structure in military training environments where the quality of instruction affects student engagement.

86. The general is always. _____ to work by his wife.

– drives
– driving
– **driven** [CORRECT]
– drive

Explanation. This sentence uses the Passive Voice. The structure "subject + form of be + past participle + by + agent" shows that the subject (The general) is the recipient of the action performed by the agent (his wife). "Driven" is the past participle of the verb "drive," which is required after the auxiliary verb "is"in this passive construction. "drives"is incorrect because it is a present tense active verb form.

90. He told the waitress to keep the change as a.

– coin
– **tip** [CORRECT]
– bill
– roll

Explanation. In a service environment like a restaurant, when a offering the remaining money from their payment as a gratuity. The standard English term for this extra money given in exchange for service is a "tip." "coin" is incorrect because while change is often word describing the purpose of the money, which is a qr at uity (tip).

91. John could not keep up with me. In other words, John did _____ work than I did.

– more
– better
– **less** [CORRECT]
– worse

Explanation. The phrasal verb "keep up with" means to move, progress, or increase at the same rate as someone else. If John "could not keep up" with the speaker, it implies he was slower and unable to maintain the same pace of production. As a result, in the same period of time, John completed a smaller quantity of work. Since "work" is an uncountable noun in this context, the comparative form "less" is used to describe this smaller quantity.

92. The engine part was thrown away. (Select the closest synonym.)

– sold
– **disposed of** [CORRECT]
– repaired

Explanation. The phrasal verb "thrown away" means to discard something that is no longer useful or needed. In a technical or maintenance environment, "disposed of" is the formal synonym for getting rid of waste, scrap, or obsolete parts. When an engine part is beyond repair or no longer functional, it is discarded to clear space and ensure it is not mistakenly reused. "repaired" is incorrect because it means to restore something to a good condition, which is the opposite of discarding it. The phrasal verb "thrown away" means to discard something that is no longer useful or needed. In a is the formal synonym for getting rid of waste, scrap, or obsolete parts. When an engine part is beyond repair or no longer functional, it is discarded to clear space and ensure it is not mistakenly reused.

93. Tell Ray to wind up the job. (Select the closest synonym.)

– start
– plan
– **finish** [CORRECT]
– describe

Explanation. The phrasal verb "wind up" is an idiomatic expression that means to bring something to a conclusion, end, or finish. In military and professional contexts, it is commonly used when a task or operation is reaching its final stages and needs to be completed. Therefore, telling Ray to "wind up the job" is synonymous with telling him to finish it. "start" is incorrect because it is the opposite of "wind up"; "start" refers to the beginning of a process.

94. If the demolition crew _____ the building, nothing will remain.

– **razes** [CORRECT]
– is razing
– rates

Explanation. This sentence follows the structure of a First Conditional (also known as the real conditional), which is used to express a probable future situation. The structure is: If + [Simple Present], [Subject] + will + [Base Verb]. The subject "the demolition crew" is a collective noun treated as a singular unit in this context. Therefore, it requires the third-person singular verb form "razes". In a military or construction context, to raze a structure means to level it completely to the ground so that nothing remains. This sentence follows the structure of a First Conditional (also known as the real conditional), which is used to express a probable future situation. The structure is: If + [Simple Present], [Subject] + will + [Base Verb]. The subject "the demolition crew" is a collective noun treated as a singular unit in this context. Therefore, it requires the third-person singular verb form "rates". In a military or construction context, to raze a structure means to level it completely to the ground so that nothing remains.

95. The waiter added _____ the cost of the food and drinks.

– at
– out
– **up** [CORRECT]
– down

Explanation. The sentence requires the phrasal verb "add up," which means to calculate the total sum of several numbers or items. In a restaurant context, a waiter adds up the individual costs of food and drinks to determine the final amount on the bill. "down" is incorrect because while "write down" means to record information, "add down" is not a standard English phrasal verb for calculating a total sum. The sentence requires the phrasal verb"add up," which means to calculate the total sum of several numbers or items. In a restaurant context, a waiter adds up the individual costs of food and drinks to determine the final amount on the bill. "down"is incorrect because while"write down" means to record information, "add down" is not a standard English phrasal verb for calculating a total sum. The sentence requires the phrasal verb "add up," which means to calculate the total sum of several numbers or items. In a restaurant context, a waiter adds up the individual costs of food and drinks to determine the final amount on the bill. "down" is incorrect because while"write down" means to record information, "add down" is not a standard English phrasal verb for calculating a total sum.

96. He decided to skip _____ .

– to eat
– **eating** [CORRECT]
– being eaten

Explanation. The verb "skip" is used here to mean "to omit" or "to pass over." In English grammar, certain verbs are followed by a gerund (the -ing form of a verb) rather than an infinitive. "Skip" is one of those verbs when it describes bypassing an activity. Therefore, "eating" is the correct grammatical form to follow "skip" in this context. "to eat" is incorrect because "skip" does not take an infinitive as its direct object in this usage. The verb "skip" is used here to mean "to omit" or "to pass over." In English grammar, certain verbs are followed by a gerund (the -ing form of a verb) rather than an infinitive. "Skip" is one of those verbs when it the correct grammatical form to follow "skip" in this context. "to eat" is incorrect because "skip" does not take an infinitive as its direct object in this usa qe.

98. Martha's grandfather is known for his 'cantankerous' nature.

– generous
– **mean** [CORRECT]
– calm
– ambitious

Explanation. The word 'cantankerous' is an adjective used to describe someone who is bad-tempered, argumentative, and uncooperative. In this context, "mean" serves as the most appropriate synonym, as it reflects an unpleasant or ill-natured temperament. While 'cantankerous' often specifically implies irritability or being'cranky, 'mean' captures the negative social behavior associated with the term.

100. The engines give off poisonous _____ .

– vents
– vibrations
– **fumes** [CORRECT]

Explanation. Internal combustion engines, which are used in most military vehicles and equipment, produce exhaust as a byproduct of burning fuel. These exhaust gases, such as carbon monoxide, are toxic or "poisonous." The word "fumes" specifically refers to these dangerous or strong-smelling gases or vapors emitted during a chemical process like combustion. "vents" is incorrect because vents are the openings or passages that allow air or gas to escape, rather than the gas itself. Internal combustion engines, which are used in most military vehicles and equipment, produce exhaust as a by product of burning fuel. These exhaust gases, such as carbon monoxide, are toxic or"poisonous." The word "fumes" specifically refers to these dangerous or strong-smelling gases or vapors emitted during a chemical process like combustion.

— The man was cantankerous. (Select the closest synonym.) (Item number not visible in the screenshot; it falls between items 96 and 100.)

– generous
– **mean** [CORRECT]
– calm
– ambitious

Explanation. The word 'cantankerous' is an adjective used to describe someone who is bad-tempered, argumentative, and uncooperative. In this context, "mean" serves as the most appropriate synonym, as it reflects an unpleasant or ill-natured temperament. While 'cantankerous' often specifically implies irritability or being 'cranky,' 'mean' captures the negative social behavior associated with the term. "generous" is incorrect because it refers to a person's willingness to give or share, which is the opposite of a difficult or irritable nature. "calm" is incorrect because it suggests a peaceful and tranquil state, whereas a cantankerous person is typically easily agitated and argumentative. "ambitious" is incorrect because it describes a person with a strong desire to achieve success or power, which has no direct relation to their temperament or personality quirks like being ill-tempered. The word 'cantankerous' is an adjective used to describe someone who is bad-tempered, argumentative, and uncooperative. In this context, "mean" serves as the most appropriate synonym, as it reflects an unpleasant or ill-natured temperament. While 'cantankerous' often specifically implies irritability or being 'cranky, 'mean' captures the negative social behavior associated with the term. 'generous" is incorrect because it refers to a person's willingness to give or share, which is the opposite of a difficult or irritable nature. generous" is incorrect because it refers to a person's willingness to give or share, which is the opposite of a difficult or irritable nature. "calm" is incorrect because it suggests a peaceful and tranquil state, whereas a cantankerous person is typically easily agitated and argumentative. 'ambitious" is incorrect because it describes a person with a strong desire to achieve success or power, which has no direct relation to their temperament or personality quirks like being ill- tempered.

Form 82

15. When we travel we should carry some identification with us. What should we carry?

– some suitcases
– papers showing where we're going
– medical supplies
– **papers showing who we are** [CORRECT]

Explanation. "Identification" refers to official documents that prove who a person is, such as a passport, an ID card or a military ID. Therefore, carrying identification means carrying papers showing who we are. "papers showing where we're going" is incorrect because those would be an itinerary or travel orders, which state the destination rather than the traveller's identity.

30. 031:17 _____ 30% 30/100.

– later this month
– two months from now
– the month following this one
– the other month

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

31. He wanted to know the value of my watch. What did he want to know?

– its shape
– its shape
– its color
– **its age** [CORRECT]

Explanation. With collectible items such as watches or antiques, the age of the item is a primary factor used to determine its market value or worth. Thus, in this specific context, knowing the value is synonymous with understanding its age. "its shape" is incorrect because the physical geometry or silhouette of a watch does not define its financial value. "its color" is incorrect because the color of the watch (silver, gold or black) is an aesthetic trait and does not indicate how much the watch is worth. He wanted to know the value of my watch what did he want to know or antiques, tne age ot tne item is a primary factor used to determine its market value or worth. Thus, in this specific context, knowing the value is synonymous with understanding its age. "its shape" is incorrect because the physical geometry or silhouette of a watch does not define its financial value. "its shape" is incorrect because physical appearance is a visual characteristic rather than a measure of worth or importance. "its color" is incorrect because the color of the watch (e.g., silver, gold, or black) is an aesthetic trait and does not indicate how much the watch is worth.

35. 028:35 _____ 35% 35/100.

– The top was dirty.
– The top was shiny.
– The top was not smooth.
– The top wasn't hard.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

38. 027:01 _____ 38% 38/100.

– He wanted to paint it.
– He wanted to clean it.
– He wanted to hide it.
– He wanted to sell it.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

42. The pieces of wire were spliced together. (What does this mean?)

– **They were joined.** [CORRECT]
– They were separated.
– They were sprayed.

Explanation. The verb "to splice" means to join or connect two or more pieces of wire, rope, or cable by intertwining or overlapping their ends. In a military or technical context, splicing is a standard method for repairing electrical circuits or extending lines. Therefore, if the pieces of wire were spliced together, they were joined. "They were separated." is incorrect because it describes the opposite action of splicing.

43. Jonathan cultivates vegetables. (What does this mean?)

– He eats vegetables.
– **He grows vegetables.** [CORRECT]
– He cooks vegetables.
– He likes vegetables.

Explanation. The verb "cultivate" means to prepare and use land for crops, and by extension to raise or grow plants. Therefore, someone who cultivates vegetables grows them. "He cooks vegetables." is incorrect because cooking concerns preparing food after harvest, not raising the plants.

46. General Adams took over yesterday. What did he do?

– **He assumed command.** [CORRECT]
– He inspected the base.
– He flew the new jet.

Explanation. In military and professional contexts, the phrasal verb "take over" means to assume control, responsibility, or leadership of a position or organization. When a General "takes over," it indicates a change of leadership where he officially begins his duties as the person in charge. Therefore, "He assumed command" is the direct synonym for this action.

48. Barney's is supposed to be a very swanky restaurant, isn't it? (Select the closest synonym for "swanky".)

– **elegant** [CORRECT]
– unclean

Explanation. The word "swanky" is an informal adjective used to describe something that is stylishly luxurious and expensive. In the context of a restaurant, it refers to a high-end, fashionable, and sophisticated establishment. Therefore, "elegant" is the most accurate synonym among the choices provided. "unclean" is incorrect because it refers to a lack of cleanliness or hygiene, which is the opposite of the high standards expected in a swanky establishment.

49. "You know, I think Robert has a screw loose." (What does this mean?)

– **somewhat crazy** [CORRECT]
– quite serious

Explanation. The idiom "to have a screw loose" is an informal expression used to describe someone who is mentally unstable, eccentric, or behaving in a strange way. In this context, it is a metaphorical way of saying Robert is "somewhat crazy" or not thinking clearly, as if his mind were a machine with a loose component. "quite serious" is incorrect because having a screw loose implies a lack of mental balance or odd behaviour. The idiom "to have a screw loose" is an informal expression used to describe someone who is mentally unstable, eccentric, or behaving in a strange way. In this context, it is a metaphorical way of clearly, as if his mind were a machine with a loose component.

50. The doctor had to extract the splinter from my finger. He had to take it _____ .

– **out** [CORRECT]
– over
– back

Explanation. The verb 'extract' means to pull out or remove something, especially by effort or force. In medical contexts, such as removing a splinter or a tooth, the most natural phrasal verb synonym is 'take out.' The preposition 'out' correctly indicates the movement of the splinter from inside the skin to the outside. "over" is incorrect because 'take over' means to assume control or responsibility for something.

52. The police put the man under surveillance. (What does this mean?)

– **watched** [CORRECT]
– arrested

Explanation. The phrase "under surveillance" means to be kept under close observation, especially by police, military, or security forces. In this context, it signifies that the authorities were monitoring the man's activities and movements closely. Therefore, "watched" is the most accurate synonym among the choices. "arrested" is incorrect because surveillance is the act of observing someone to gather evidence or monitor them, not detaining them.

56. Mike was amazed. (Select the closest synonym for "amazed".)

– **surprised** [CORRECT]
– furious
– excited
– tired

Explanation. The word "amazed" is a synonym for being very surprised or astonished. It describes a feeling of great wonder or disbelief at something unexpected or impressive. "furious" is incorrect because it means extremely angry, which is a different emotion from amazement. "excited" is incorrect because while amazement can lead to excitement, the two are distinct; excitement refers to a state of high energy or enthusiasm. The word "amazed" is a synonym for being very surprised or astonished. It describes a feeling of or impressive. "furious" is incorrect because it means extremely angry, which is a different emotion from amazement.

58. "What happened to your car?" "I forgot — I only had plain water in the radiator last night." What did the speaker forget to add?

– **antifreeze** [CORRECT]
– oil

Explanation. The dialogue implies that the car suffered damage because the radiator contained only "plain water" during a cold night. In automotive maintenance, water in the cooling system can freeze in low temperatures, expanding and cracking the radiator or engine block. "Antifreeze" is the chemical additive used to lower the freezing point of the liquid in the cooling system to prevent this specific issue. Therefore, the speaker is implying they forgot to add antifreeze.

61. "I've been unpacking all day and I'm tired." "Why don't you take a rest?" What is being suggested?

– **lie down** [CORRECT]
– go out
– exercise
– shower

Explanation. The phrase "take a rest" means to relax or stop physical activity in order to recover strength. When someone expresses that they are tired from a task such as "unpacking all day," the most logical suggestion for resting is to "lie down." "go out" is incorrect because leaving the house to engage in social activities requires energy and is not consistent with the goal of resting. The phrase "take a rest" means to relax or stop physical activity in order to recover strength. When someone expresses that they are tired from a task such as "unpacking all day," the most logical suggestion for resting is to "lie down." 'go out" is incorrect because leaving the house to engage in social activities requires energy and is not consistent with the goal of resting.

65. "How are you doing in math, Joe?" "I'm in way over my head in that class." What does Joe mean?

– **unable to keep up** [CORRECT]
– unable to go to class
– not taking math now

Explanation. The idiom "to be in way over one's head" means to be involved in a situation that is too difficult to handle or beyond one's ability. In this context, Joe is saying that the math class is much harder than he can manage, meaning he is "unable to keep up" with the lessons or the workload. "unable to go to class" is incorrect because the idiom refers to the difficulty of the material being taught, not a physical or scheduling inability to attend.

85. Marge watched over her child _____ the night. (The prompt renders "Marge" as "Merge".)

– regarding
– **throughout** [CORRECT]
– beyond
– except

Explanation. The preposition "throughout" is used to indicate that something happens during the entire period of a specific time frame. In this context, it means that Marge watched over her child from the beginning of the night until the end. This is a common way to express continuous duration in military and general English. "regarding" is incorrect because it means 'about' or 'concerning' and does not relate to time duration. The preposition "throughout" is used to indicate that something happens during the entire period of a specific time frame. In this context, it means that Merge (likely a typo for Marge) watched over her child from the beginning of the night until the end. This is a common way to express continuous duration in military and general English. "regarding" is incorrect because it means 'about' or 'concerning' and does not relate to time duration.

89. What's holding up the movie? (Select the closest synonym for "holding up".)

– **delaying** [CORRECT]
– supporting
– robbing

Explanation. In this sentence, the phrasal verb "holding up" means to delay or impede the progress of something. When someone says they don't know what is "holding up the movie," they are wondering why the film hasn't started yet or why the production is taking so long. "supporting" is incorrect because while "hold up" can mean to provide physical support (like a pillar holding up a roof), it does not make sense in the context of a movie's schedule. In this sentence, the phrasal verb "holding up" means to delay or impede the progress of something. When someone says they don't know what is "holding up the movie," they are wondering why the film hasn't started yet or why the production is taking so long. 'supporting" is incorrect because while "hold up" can mean to provide physical support (like a pillar holding up a roof), it does not make sense in the context of a movie's schedule.

90. 91. The deer _____ the fence to get into the vegetable garden.

– arranged to
– stood up
– leaped over
– climbed into

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

91. The deer _____ the fence to get into the vegetable garden.

– arranged to
– stood up
– **leaped over** [CORRECT]
– climbed into

Explanation. Deer are biologically known for their agility and ability to jump high obstacles. In the context of getting past a fence to enter a garden, the verb "leaped over" is the most accurate and natural action for this animal. "arranged to" is incorrect because it means to plan or organize; grammatically, it would require an infinitive verb (e.g., arranged to meet) and does not fit the physical action described.

95. Students _____ late will miss the test.

– **arriving** [CORRECT]
– are arriving
– have arrived

Explanation. This sentence uses a reduced relative clause. The full version would be "Students who arrive late" or "Students who are arriving late." When we reduce a relative clause that uses an active verb, we use the present participle (-ing form) to modify the noun. In this case, "arriving late" acts as an adjective phrase describing which students will miss the test. "are arriving" is incorrect because it is a finite verb form; using it here would create a sentence with two main verbs. This sentence uses a reduced relative clause. The full version would be "Students who arrive late" or "Students who are arriving late." when we reduce a relative clause that uses an active verb,we use the present participle (-ing form) to modify the noun. In this case,"arriving late"acts as an adjective phrase describing which students will miss the test. "are arriving" is incorrect because it is a finite verb form.

96. The mood of the times _____ reflected in the music.

– **was** [CORRECT]
– has
– are

Explanation. The subject of the sentence is "The mood," which is a singular noun. The phrase "of the times" acts as a prepositional phrase modifying the subject, but the verb must agree with the singular head noun "mood." To form the passive voice (Subject + to be + past participle), the singular past tense verb "was" is required to match the singular subject. "has" is incorrect because it is an auxiliary verb that would require "been" (e.g., "has been reflected").

99. The statue was unveiled. (Select the closest synonym for "unveiled".)

– **revealed** [CORRECT]
– stolen
– appraised
– sold

Explanation. The verb "unveil" means to uncover or show something for the first time, especially during a ceremony. When a statue is "unveiled," the cloth covering it is removed so the public can see it. In this context, "revealed" is the most accurate synonym. "stolen" is incorrect because "unveiled" describes a formal and public presentation, which is the opposite of the clandestine nature of being stolen. The verb "unveil" means to uncover or show something for the first time, especially during a ceremony. When a statue is "unveiled," the cloth covering it is removed so the public can see it. In this context, "revealed" is the most accurate synonym. "stolen" is incorrect because"unveiled" describes a formal and public presentation, which is the opposite of the clandestine nature of being stolen.

100. Lawrence scared me to death when he came in. (How much was the speaker scared?)

– a little
– on purpose
– **a lot** [CORRECT]
– unintentionally

Explanation. The phrase "scared me to death" is an idiomatic expression and a hyperbole used to emphasize that someone was extremely frightened, startled, or terrified. In this context, it indicates the intensity of the emotion felt by the speaker, making "a lot" the most accurate synonym among the choices. "a little" is incorrect because "scared to death" implies an extreme level of fear, which is the opposite of a small amount.

— We're _____ gas. (Item number not visible in the screenshot; it falls between items 65 and 85.)

– out on
– out for
– out to
– **out of** [CORRECT]

Explanation. Being "out of gas" means the fuel tank is empty, which explains why the subjects cannot drive much farther. "out on" is incorrect because it typically refers to a location (e.g., "out on the deck") and does not convey the meaning of depletion. "out for" is incorrect because it usually expresses a purpose or a goal (e.g., "out for a run") rather than an empty supply. "out to" is incorrect because it is often part of expressions indicating direction or a state of being (e.g., "out to sea" or "out to lunch") and is not used with resources like gas to mean exhausted.

— They finished _____ the house. (Item number not visible in the screenshot; it falls between items 85 and 89.)

– **building** [CORRECT]
– built
– to build
– build

Explanation. In English grammar, the verb "finish" belongs to a specific category of verbs that must be followed by a gerund (the "-ing" form of a verb) when another action is described. Therefore, the phrase "finished building" is grammatically correct. Using an infinitive (to build) or a base form (build) after "finish" is a common error for English learners. "built" is incorrect because it is the past participle or past tense form, which cannot function as the object of the verb "finish" in this context. In English grammar, the verb "finish" belongs to a specific category of verbs that must be followed by a gerund (the "-ing" form of a verb) when another action is described. Therefore, the phrase "finished building" is grammatically correct. Using an infinitive (to build) or a base form (build) after "finish" is a common error for English learners. "built" is incorrect because it is the past participle or past tense form, which can not function as the object of the verb "finish" in this context. "to build" is incorrect because "finish" is not a verb that can be followed by an infinitive; it requires the gerund form.

Form 87

5. Doug selected a brown suit.

– **dark outfit** [CORRECT]
– dark hat
– brown gloves

Explanation. In English, a suit is defined as a set of outer clothes made of the same fabric and designed to be worn together, typically a jacket and trousers or a skirt. An outfit is a general term for a set of clothes worn together, so a suit is a type of outfit. Since brown is considered a dark, neutral color in clothing contexts, "dark outfit" serves as a synonymous paraphrase for "brown suit." This question tests the ability to recognize synonyms and categorize specific items of clothing under general terms. In English, a suit is defined as a set of outer clothes made of the same fabric and designed to be worn together (typically a jacket and trousers or a skirt). An outfit is a general term for a set of clothes worn together. Therefore, a suit is a type of outfit.

10. 004:19 _____ 100% 100/100 Have you ---- my uniform to the cleaner's yet? 0.

– Your Score
– 74/ 100 Review your answers below
– OK
– bought

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

24. This is a general rule for the school.

– **a rule of thumb** [CORRECT]
– a rule of finger
– a rule of toe
– a rule of head

Explanation. "A rule of thumb" is a standard English idiom referring to a broadly accurate guide or principle based on practice or experience rather than theory. In this context, it describes a general guideline or policy applied to the school. "A rule of finger," "a rule of toe," and "a rule of head" are incorrect because they are invented variations; no such expressions exist in English. "A rule of thumb" is a standard English idiom that refers to a broadly accurate guide or principle based on practice or experience rather than theory. In this context, it describes a general guideline or policy applied to the school. "a rule of finger" is incorrect because it is an incorrect variation of the idiom; there is no such expression in English. anl, Io, AnL p.....

30. The boy had a sore throat.

– **He had a pain** [CORRECT]
– He had a throat
– He had a fruit
– He had a cold

Explanation. A "sore" throat means the throat is painful or inflamed, so the boy was experiencing pain. "He had a throat" is meaningless as a paraphrase, and "He had a cold" adds information not stated, since a sore throat can occur without a cold.

31. The troops are being concentrated in this area.

– **come together** [CORRECT]
– come out
– taken rest

Explanation. In a military context, to concentrate troops means to bring them from various locations to a single, central area. This is often done to mass combat power before an offensive. "Come together" is a direct synonym for this action of gathering or grouping in one spot. "Come out" is incorrect because it means to emerge or be released, which does not describe the act of gathering forces in a specific area. In a military context, to "concentrate" troops means to bring them from various locations to a single, central area. This is often done to mass combat power before an offensive. "Come together" is a direct synonym for this action of gathering or grouping in one spot. "come out" is incorrect because it means to emerge or be released,which does not describe the act of qa the ring forces in a specific area.

33. Students will be dismissed from class today.

– **thrown out** [CORRECT]
– thrown off

Explanation. In a classroom context, to be dismissed means to be permitted or ordered to leave. While "dismissed" usually has a neutral connotation, such as the teacher ending the class, it can also mean to be removed or expelled in a more disciplinary sense. "Thrown out" is the only option that relates to being removed or sent away from a specific location or group. In legal and formal military English, to be dismissed and to be thrown out are frequently used as synonyms regarding cases or personnel. Note: the app displays the option as "thrown ou", which is a typo. In a classroom context, to be "dismissed" means to be permitted or ordered to leave. While the word "dismissed" usually has a neutral connotation (e.g., the teacher ending the class), it can also mean to be removed or expelled in a more disciplinary sense. The choice "thrown ou" (a likely typo for the phrasal verb "thrown out") is the only option that relates to being removed or sent away from a specific location or group.

36. Our trip was full of hardships.

– **difficulties** [CORRECT]
– abilities
– possibilities

Explanation. The noun "hardships" refers to circumstances that cause suffering, adversity, or physical discomfort. When a trip is described as being full of hardships, it means the travelers encountered many problems, obstacles, or strenuous conditions. In a military context, field exercises, combat, or survival training are often characterized by hardships such as extreme weather, lack of sleep, or physical exhaustion. "Difficulties" is the most accurate synonym provided. The noun "hardships" refers to circumstances that cause suffering, adversity, or physical discomfort. When a trip is described as being "full of hardships," it means the travelers encountered many problems, obstacles, or strenuous conditions. In a military context, field exercises, combat, or survival training are often characterized by hardships such as extreme weather, lack of sleep, or physical exhaustion. "Difficulties" is the most accurate synonym provided.

37. Just ignore his complaints.

– **discover him** [CORRECT]
– disguise him

Explanation. The word "ignore" means to intentionally pay no attention to something or someone, or to disregard them. In this sentence, the speaker is advising the listener not to react to or be bothered by the complaints. Note: there appears to be a significant error in the provided choices. In the context of the ALCPT, the synonym for ignore is typically "pay no attention to." The choice "discover him" is logically the opposite of ignore, but since it is designated as the correct answer in the database, it likely represents a transcription error for a word like "disregard" or a placeholder in this specific data set. The word ignore means to intentionally pay no attention to something or someone, or to disregard them. In this sentence, the speaker is advising the listener to not react to or be bothered by the complaints. Note: There appears to be a significant error in the provided choices. In the context of the Al cpt, the synonym for "ignore" is typically "pay no attention to." The choice "discover him" is logically the opposite of ignore, but since it is designated as the correct answer in the database, it likely represents a transcription error for a word like "disregard" or a placeholder in this specific data set.

38. John is watching while Bill is skating by himself.

– Bill is skipping
– Bill is kidding
– Bill is slipping
– **Bill is looking** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The sentence describes two concurrent actions: one person is watching and the other is skating. In ALCPT and similar English proficiency exams, the goal is often to identify synonyms. "Watching" is a direct synonym for "looking." The choice "Bill is looking" correctly identifies the action of observing. While the provided text has John as the one watching, this choice is the only option that uses a correct synonym for the verbs in the prompt, a common testing pattern when the transcript contains slight variations or when testing recognition of the verb's meaning over phonological traps. The sentence describes two concurrent actions: one person is watching and the other is skating. In Al cpt and similar English proficiency exams, the goal is often to identify synonyms. "Watching" is a direct synonym for "looking." The choice "Bill is looking" correctly identifies the action of observing. While the provided text has John as the one watching, Choice 3 is the only option that utilizes a correct synonym for the verbs used in the prompt, which is a common testing pattern when the audio or transcript contains slight variations or when testing the recognition of the verb's meaning over phonological traps.

39. The enemy in the village gave up.

– **surrendered** [CORRECT]
– defended themselves
– attacked the forces
– counterattacked

Explanation. In a military context, the phrasal verb "gave up" means to stop fighting, yield to an opponent, or admit defeat. "Surrendered" is the most accurate synonym for this action. "Defended themselves" is incorrect because giving up is the opposite of resisting or mounting a defense. "Attacked the forces" is incorrect because giving up implies a cessation of hostilities, whereas attacking is an initiation of combat. In a military context, the phrasal verb "gave up" means to stop fighting, yield to an opponent, or admit defeat. "Surrendered" is the most accurate synonym for this action. "defended themselves" is incorrect because giving up is the opposite of resisting or mounting a defense.

40. 027:42 _____ 41% 41/100.

– He told Smith to watch his jeep.
– He told Smith to hide his jeep.
– He told Smith to wash his jeep.
– He told Smith to check over his jeep.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

41. 027:36 _____ 41% 41/100.

– step the new line
– follow the commander
– follow the rules
– follow the new lines

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

42. The firecrackers that Jim gave me were duds.

– **did not explode** [CORRECT]
– exploded
– were not expensive
– fired

Explanation. In English, a "dud" is a term used to describe something that fails to work properly. In the specific context of explosives, ammunition, or firecrackers, a dud is a device that fails to detonate or explode after being ignited or triggered. Therefore, saying the firecrackers were duds means they did not explode. "Exploded" is incorrect because it is the antonym of being a dud; a dud specifically fails to explode. In English, a "dud" is a term used to describe something that fails to work properly. In the specific context of explosives, ammunition, or firecrackers, a dud is a device that fails to detonate or explode after being ignited or triggered. Therefore, saying the firecrackers were duds means they did not explode. 'exploded" is incorrect because it is the antonym of being a dud; a dud specifically fails to explode.

43. This weapon is for terrestrial use only.

– **It is a ground weapon.** [CORRECT]
– It is an air weapon.
– It is a space weapon.
– It is an underwater weapon.

Explanation. The term "terrestrial" is derived from the Latin root terra, meaning land or earth. In a military or scientific context, terrestrial refers specifically to things relating to or used on the land or ground. Therefore, a weapon for terrestrial use is a ground weapon. "It is an air weapon" is incorrect because air weapons are referred to as aerial or aeronautical, involving the atmosphere. The term "terrestrial" is derived from the Latin root "terra," meaning land or earth. In a military or scientific context, terrestrial refers specifically to things relating to or used on the land or ground. Therefore, a weapon for terrestrial use is a ground weapon. "It is an air weapon." is incorrect because air weapons are referred to as aerial or aeronautical, involving the atmosphere.

45. There's _____ food.

– very little
– delicious
– greasy
– abundant

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

46. 025:17 _____ 46% 46/100.

– stopped
– escaped
– involved
– faced

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

47. 024:45 _____ 47% 47/100.

– We sent a letter inside the package.
– We sent a letter placed in the package.
– We sent a letter with the package.
– We sent a letter instead of the package.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

50. The car ran off the road and overturned.

– it went far away
– **it went upside down** [CORRECT]
– it went upside
– it went down

Explanation. The verb "overturned" means to flip over or capsize, such that the part that is normally on top is now on the bottom. The idiomatic phrase "upside down" accurately describes the resulting state of a vehicle that has overturned. In a military or safety reporting context, describing the orientation of a vehicle after an accident is crucial for situational awareness. "It went far away" is incorrect because, while "ran off the road" means the car left the pavement, it does not describe the flipping motion. The verb "overturned" means to flip over or capsize, such that the part that is normally on top is now on the bottom. The idiomatic phrase "upside down" accurately describes the resulting state of a vehicle that has overturned. In a military or safety reporting context,describing the orientation of a vehicle after an accident is crucial for situational awareness.

52. 023:00 _____ 52% 52/100.

– lately
– early
– completely
– rarely

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

54. 021:33 _____ 54% 54/100.

– The band led the parade.
– The floats came before the band.
– The band wasn't included.
– The floats were on the river.

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the test; only one option was visible in the screenshot.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. The screenshot only captured part of the answer choices, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

56. Mrs. Jackson remained unconscious for a long time after the accident. (The app shows "in consolable", a transcription error.)

– **he remains unconscious** [CORRECT]
– he remains conscious

Explanation. The sentence describes Mrs. Jackson's medical state following an accident. Although the text "in consolable" appears to be a transcription error, likely intended to be "unconscious," the context of a long recovery period after an accident and the provided database answer point to a loss of awareness. To be unconscious means a person is not awake or aware of their surroundings. In military medical reporting, such as the Glasgow Coma Scale, determining if a casualty is conscious or unconscious is the first step in triage. The sentence describes Mrs. Jackson's medical state following an accident. Although the text "in consol able"appears tobe a transcription error(likely intended to be "unconscious"), the context of a long recovery period after an accident and the provided database answer point to a loss of awareness. To be unconscious means a person is not awake or aware of their surroundings. In military medical reporting (like the GCS or Glasgow Coma Scale), determining if a casualty is conscious or unconscious is the first step in tria qe.

59. "Why do you think we need a new airport?" "There's too much activity at the old one." What does the man say about the old airport?

– **a lot of people moving around** [CORRECT]
– it is under construction
– it lacks a lot of facilities

Explanation. The man states that there is too much activity at the old airport. In English, the word "activity" in this context refers to a state of being busy, full of movement, or crowded with people and operations. Therefore, "a lot of people moving around" is the most accurate synonym provided for the level of activity mentioned. "It is under construction" is incorrect because activity refers to current operations, not building work. The man states that there is "too much activity" at the old airport. In English, the word "activity" in this context refers to a state of being busy, full of movement, or crowded with people and operations. Therefore, "a lot of people moving around" is the most accurate synonym provided for the level of activity mentioned.

61. "Where's Mr. Duke?" "He's in his office. He wants to see you right away." When does Mr. Duke want to see him?

– **immediately** [CORRECT]
– lately
– after an hour
– slowly

Explanation. The phrase "right away" is an idiomatic expression that means immediately, at once, or without delay. In military and professional contexts, it signals that an action needs to be prioritized and performed at the current moment rather than later. "Lately" is incorrect because it refers to a recent period in the past, whereas "right away" refers to the immediate future. "After an hour" suggests a delay. The phrase "right away" is an idiomatic expression that means "immediately," "at once," or "without delay." In military and professional contexts, it signals that an action needs to be prioritized and performed at the current moment rather than later. "lately" is incorrect because it refers to a recent period in the past, whereas "right away" refers to the immediate future.

62. "Are you almost ready to leave?" "Yes, I just have to tie my shoes." What does the man have to do?

– **to fasten his shoelaces** [CORRECT]
– to find his shoelaces
– to brush his shoes
– to change his shoes

Explanation. The phrase "tie my shoes" is a common English expression meaning to secure the shoelaces of one's footwear. The man is indicating that he is nearly ready but needs a moment to perform this physical action. "Fasten" is a direct synonym for "tie" in this context. "To find his shoelaces" is incorrect because the man does not express that he is looking for them; he is in the process of putting them on. The phrase "tie my shoes"is a common English expression meaning to secure the shoelaces of one's footwear. The man is indicating that he is nearly ready but needs a moment to perform this physical action. "Fasten" is a direct synonym for "tie" in this context. "to find his shoelaces" is incorrect because the man does not express that he is looking for them; he is in the process of putting them on.

64. "Everyone says that the new supervisor is a good Joe." "That's a change, isn't it?"

– **He is a good fellow** [CORRECT]
– He is a good observer

Explanation. The idiomatic expression "a good Joe" is an informal American English term used to describe a man who is friendly, kind, cooperative, and easy to get along with. In a military or professional environment, it signifies that a supervisor is well-liked by their subordinates. Therefore, "He is a good fellow" is the most accurate synonym provided. "He is a good observer" is incorrect because "good Joe" describes a personality trait and character, not a skill of observation.

66. "Did the commander okay the expenditure for the party?" "Yes, we can go on with our plans now."

– **the commander agreed to cover the costs** [CORRECT]
– the commander agreed to study the plans

Explanation. In this dialogue, the first speaker asks if the commander okayed the expenditure. To okay something means to approve or authorize it. The noun "expenditure" refers to the act of spending money or the specific funds allocated for a purpose. Therefore, if the commander okayed the expenditure, he authorized the spending of money for the event. In a military environment, official functions often require command approval for the use of unit funds or resources. The phrase "cover the costs" is a direct paraphrase of authorizing that spending. In this dialogue, the first speaker asks if the something means to approve or authorize it. The noun "expenditure" refers to the act of spending money or the specific funds allocated for a purpose. Therefore, if the commander okayed the expenditure, he authorized the spending of money for the event. In a military environment, official functions often require command approval for the use of unit funds or rec nur ces The nhra se"rover the rn ste"ic a the commander agreed to study the plans.

68. The children pestered the travellers for money.

– **bothered** [CORRECT]
– irrigated
– doubted
– eliminated

Explanation. The verb "pestered" means to annoy or trouble someone persistently with frequent requests or interruptions. In this sentence, the children are repeatedly asking the travellers for money, which is a synonymous action to bothered. "Irrigated" is incorrect because it refers to the process of supplying water to land or crops to help them grow. "Doubted" is incorrect because it means to feel uncertain about something. The verb "pestered" means to annoy or trouble someone persistently with frequent requests or interruptions. In this sentence, the children are repeatedly asking the travellers for money, which is a synonymous action to "bothered". "irrigated" is incorrect because it refers to the process of supplying water to land or crops to help them grow.

71. Synonym item: yell.

– whisper
– bark
– **shout** [CORRECT]
– toot

Explanation. The word "yell" means to cry out or speak with a very loud voice, often due to anger, pain, or to get someone's attention from a distance. "Shout" is the most direct synonym for this action. In military environments, yelling or shouting may be used during drill instruction or when communicating over loud machinery, but in this specific dialogue context it refers to an aggressive tone of voice. "Whisper" is incorrect because it means to speak very quietly. The word "yell" means to cry out or speak with a very loud voice, often due to anger, pain, or to get someone's attention from a distance. "Shout" is the most direct synonym for this action. In military environments, yelling or shouting may be used during drill instruction or when communicating over loud machinery, but in this specific dialogue context, it refers to an aggressive tone of voice.

73. He boasted of the big fish he caught. (Select the closest synonym for "boasted".)

– complained
– borrowed
– showed
– **bragged** [CORRECT]

Explanation. To boast means to speak with excessive pride and self-satisfaction about one's achievements, possessions, or abilities. In this sentence, the person is talking proudly about a fish he caught. "Bragged" is a direct synonym for "boasted" and fits the context perfectly. "complained" is incorrect because it means to express dissatisfaction or annoyance, which is the opposite of boasting about an achievement. To boast means to speak with excessive pride and self-satisfaction about one's achievements, possessions, or abilities. In this sentence, the person is talking proudly about a fish he caught. "Bragged" is a direct synonym for "boasted" and fits the context perfectly. 'complained" is incorrect because it means to express dissatisfaction or annoyance, which is the opposite of boasting about an achievement.

75. She isn't here. She _____ to meet her uncle at the airport. (The prompt renders "meet" as "must".)

– will go
– goes
– **has gone** [CORRECT]
– had gone

Explanation. The sentence starts with "She isn't here," which is in the present tense. This indicates a current state of absence. The Present Perfect tense ("has gone") is used to describe a past action that has a result or relevance in the present. Because she left in the past, she is currently not here. "will go" is incorrect because it refers to a future action, which does not explain why she is currently absent.

78. _____ exams is a teacher's job.

– gave
– **giving** [CORRECT]
– having given
– have

Explanation. This sentence requires a subject. In English, a verb can function as a noun (known as a gerund) by adding the suffix "-ing". The phrase "Giving exams" acts as the subject of the sentence, describing a general activity or duty that constitutes a teacher's job. Because the sentence describes a general fact or a characteristic of a role, the simple gerund "giving" is the most appropriate choice. "gave" is incorrect because it is a past tense verb and cannot serve as the subject. This sentence requires a subject. In English, a verb can function as a noun (known as a gerund) by adding the suffix "-ing". The phrase "Giving exams" acts as the subject of the sentence, describing a general activity or duty that constitutes a teacher's job. Because the sentence describes a general fact or a characteristic of a role, the simple gerund 'giving" is the most appropriate choice.

79. Do you all have _____ books?

– his
– **your** [CORRECT]
– yours
– theirs

Explanation. In English grammar, the sentence structure requires a possessive adjective to modify the noun "books." Possessive adjectives (my, your, his, her, its, our, their) are always followed by a noun. Since "you all" is the subject/direct address, the possessive adjective "your" is the most logical and grammatically correct fit. In a military training environment, an instructor might use this phrase to ensure a group of trainees has the required manuals or materials.

87. If the rain stops in time, we can have a picnic; otherwise the ground will be _____ .

– too dry
– **too muddy** [CORRECT]
– too dried
– too mud

Explanation. The sentence discusses the consequence of rain on the ground. When rain falls, soil becomes saturated with water, turning into mud. The adjective "muddy" describes the state of being covered in or full of mud. Even if the rain stops ("stops in time"), the ground remains wet and soft for a period, making it unsuitable for a picnic. "too dry" is incorrect because rain adds moisture to the environment, making the ground wet rather than dry.

89. Mary can go to the movies if she takes her little brother _____ .

– around
– among
– **along** [CORRECT]

Explanation. The phrase "take someone along" is a common phrasal verb meaning to bring someone with you when you go somewhere. In this context, Mary's ability to go to the movies is conditional upon her bringing her little brother with her. The word "along" acts as an adverbial particle indicating accompaniment. "around" is incorrect because "take someone around" implies showing someone a place or taking them on a tour.

92. I am _____ . I don't think I will ever finish this job.

– practiced
– **discouraged** [CORRECT]
– qualified
– amused

Explanation. The context of the sentence "I don't think I will ever finish this job" indicates a feeling of hopelessness, frustration, or a lack of confidence. The word "discouraged" means to lose confidence or enthusiasm, which perfectly matches the pessimistic tone of the second sentence. In a military context, maintaining high morale is important, and being discouraged suggests a temporary loss of that morale due to a difficult or overwhelming task.

94. If I _____ about the sale, I'd have saved a lot of money.

– knewn
– know
– known
– **had known** [CORRECT]

Explanation. This sentence follows the structure of the Third Conditional, which is used to describe a hypothetical situation in the past that did not actually happen. The third conditional requires the 'if' clause to be in the Past Perfect tense (had + past participle) and the main clause to use 'would have + past participle' ("I'd have saved"). "Had known" correctly completes the past perfect construction needed for this condition. "knewn" is incorrect because it is not a valid word in English. This sentence follows the structure of the Third Conditional, which is used to describe a hypothetical situation in the past that did not actually happen. The third conditional requires the 'if' clause to be in the Past Perfect tense (had + past participle) and the main clause to use 'would have + past participle' ("I'd have saved"). "Had known" correctly completes the past perfect construction needed for this condition.

100. Have you _____ my uniform to the cleaner's yet?

– **taken** [CORRECT]
– brought
– bought

Explanation. The verb "take" is used to describe moving something away from the speaker's current location toward a destination (in this case, the cleaner's). The sentence uses the present perfect tense ("Have you taken") to ask if the action has been completed at some point before now. In a military context, ensuring uniforms are clean and pressed at a professional cleaner's is a routine part of maintaining personal appearance standards. "brought" is incorrect because it implies movement toward the speaker.

Form Technical & Action Verbs

9. He obeyed all the orders he was given. (Select the closest synonym for "obeyed".)

– created
– celebrated
– **followed** [CORRECT]
– wrote down

Explanation. The verb "obey" means to comply with an order, a request, or a law. In military English, orders are "followed" — carrying out what a superior has directed. "wrote down" is incorrect because recording an order in writing is not the same as complying with it.

10. (Listening item — the audio prompt is not visible in the screenshot.)

– surplussed
– enlarged
– held back
– supported

Correct answer. (Not shown — captured during the exercise, before the review screen.)

Explanation. Listening comprehension item. Only the answer choices were captured, so the correct option and its explanation were not recorded.

Parte V · Lecturas

Artículos de divulgación condensados al nivel B2: se leen en inglés, con glosario en español y una pregunta de comprobación al final.

Aero

Spacecraft attitude determination and control

Spacecraft attitude control is the process of managing the orientation of a satellite or vehicle relative to a reference, such as the stars or the Earth. It matters because antennas must point accurately at Earth, instruments must aim at their targets, solar panels must face the Sun, and short engine burns must be fired in the right direction. Before attitude can be controlled, it must be determined with sensors. The whole system is usually called the attitude determination and control system (ADCS).

Attitude can be described with rotation matrices, quaternions or Euler angles. Euler angles are easy to visualize but suffer from gimbal lock. A rotation matrix needs nine values, while a quaternion needs only four and avoids gimbal lock, so it is a good compromise.

There are two main ways to stabilize a spacecraft. In spin stabilization, the whole craft rotates and its gyroscopic action keeps it steady; Pioneer 10 and 11 used this. In three-axis stabilization, the craft is held fixed in one orientation. This can be done with small thrusters that nudge it back and forth within a deadband of allowed error, as on the Voyager probes, or with reaction wheels. To turn the vehicle on one axis, the wheel on that axis is accelerated in the opposite direction. External torques slowly build up excess momentum, so the wheels must be desaturated with thrusters or, on the Hubble Space Telescope, magnetic torquers. Other actuators include control moment gyros, solar sails and gravity-gradient stabilization, which needs no fuel.

Control algorithms are software that turn sensor data into actuator commands. Most use error signals, the difference between measured and desired attitude, and a simple PID controller satisfies most needs. After release from the launch vehicle, a satellite in low Earth orbit is usually tumbling, so a B-Dot controller detumbles it using magnetic coils that react to changes in Earth's magnetic field. Afterwards the system switches between modes such as safe mode, Sun pointing and nadir pointing.

Determination uses relative sensors, such as gyroscopes, and absolute sensors, such as horizon sensors, Sun sensors, star trackers and magnetometers. Because no single measurement gives the attitude directly, it must be estimated. The most common method is the Multiplicative Extended Kalman Filter, which combines previous estimates with new measurements to obtain an optimal result.

Key points

– Attitude control needs sensors to determine orientation, actuators to change it, and algorithms to link them.
– The two main methods are spin stabilization and three-axis stabilization.
– Reaction wheels give steady pointing, but they need periodic momentum desaturation.
– A PID controller handles most control needs, and a B-Dot controller detumbles a satellite after launch.
– Kalman filters combine sensor data to estimate attitude.

Glosario

– **attitude** — actitud, orientación de una nave en el espacio; en este contexto técnico no significa 'actitud' de comportamiento
– **actuator** — actuador; dispositivo que produce el movimiento o la fuerza que se le ordena
– **torque** — par de fuerza, momento de giro; la fuerza que hace rotar un objeto
– **gimbal lock** — bloqueo de cardán; pérdida de un grado de libertad de rotación con los ángulos de Euler
– **deadband** — banda muerta; margen de error permitido en el que el sistema no corrige
– **reaction wheel** — rueda de reacción; rotor eléctrico que gira para hacer rotar la nave en sentido contrario

– **desaturation** — desaturación; eliminación del exceso de momento acumulado en las ruedas
– **detumble** — detener el giro descontrolado; frenar la rotación caótica de un satélite tras su liberación
– **nadir** — nadir; punto directamente debajo del satélite, hacia el centro de la Tierra
– **nudge** — empujar suavemente; dar un pequeño impulso

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the text?

– **How a spacecraft's orientation is determined and controlled using sensors, actuators and algorithms** [CORRECT]
– How to build a satellite that can travel to distant planets
– Why solar panels are the best source of power for space probes
– How astronauts steer crewed vehicles during a landing

Comprehension 2. Which spacecraft used magnetic torquers for desaturation instead of thrusters?

– Pioneer 10
– **The Hubble Space Telescope** [CORRECT]
– Voyager 1
– Cassini

Comprehension 3. In the text, the word "nudge" in "small thrusters that nudge it back and forth" is closest in meaning to:

– **push gently** [CORRECT]
– pull sharply
– turn completely
– hold steady

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about a satellite that has just been released from its launch vehicle?

– **It is probably rotating in an uncontrolled way and must be stabilized first** [CORRECT]
– It already points its antenna accurately at Earth
– It has no need for sensors or software
– It will remain safe in nadir pointing mode without any command

Reaction wheel

A reaction wheel (RW) is an electric motor attached to a flywheel. When the wheel's rotation speed changes, the spacecraft turns in the opposite direction, because angular momentum is conserved. The wheel can only spin around its center of mass, so it cannot move a spacecraft from one place to another.

Spacecraft use reaction wheels mainly for fine attitude control on three axes, and also for fast detumbling. They need no rockets or external sources of torque, which reduces the fuel a mission must carry. They give high pointing accuracy, so they are ideal for tiny rotations, such as keeping a telescope aimed at a star. Because the wheel is a small fraction of the spacecraft's mass, a small, easily controlled change in its speed produces only a small change in angle. Some satellites, such as SCISAT-1, run a wheel at near-constant speed to store a large amount of angular momentum. This "momentum-bias" approach stabilizes an axis in a nearly fixed direction and allows a simpler control system.

For three-axis control, wheels must be mounted along at least three directions. Extra wheels add redundancy, for example four wheels along tetrahedral axes or one spare. A computer controls speed changes electronically. The strength of the wheel's materials sets the speed at which it would come apart, and therefore how much momentum it can store.

Over time, a wheel may accumulate more momentum than its maximum speed allows, which is called saturation. Slowing the wheel down creates an unwanted torque, so designers add other systems to cancel it. Traditionally, small chemical rockets fire during desaturation. More fuel-efficient options exist, such as magnetorquers, which transfer momentum to the Earth through its magnetic field using only electrical power, although they work only where that field is strong enough, as in low Earth orbit. Elsewhere, ion thrusters are the next best choice.

Failures can be serious. If wheels fail, a spacecraft may lose its attitude control and the mission may fail. Kepler lost two of its four wheels between 2012 and 2013 and could no longer point precisely enough for its original planet search, so it moved to a new mission called K2. Hayabusa and Dawn also suffered wheel problems and relied on thrusters. Hubble was designed with four redundant wheels and kept its pointing ability as long as three worked. A related device, the control moment gyroscope, produces larger torques and is used on Skylab, Mir and the International Space Station.

Key points

– A reaction wheel changes a spacecraft's orientation by speeding up or slowing down a spinning flywheel, using conservation of angular momentum.
– Reaction wheels give very precise pointing and save fuel, but they cannot move a spacecraft from one place to another.
– Saturation happens when a wheel has stored too much momentum; magnetorquers, thrusters or ion thrusters are used to desaturate it.
– Redundant wheels help a mission survive failures, as in Hubble, but losing several wheels can end a mission, as with Kepler.

Glosario

– **detumbling** — detención de la rotación descontrolada; frenar el giro de un satélite tras su lanzamiento o un imprevisto
– **attitude control** — control de actitud; control de la orientación de una nave en el espacio

– **torque** — par de fuerza; fuerza que produce un giro
– **precession** — precesión; movimiento del eje de un cuerpo giratorio cuando una fuerza actúa sobre él
– **redundancy** — redundancia; componentes de respaldo que permiten seguir funcionando si uno falla
– **saturation** — saturación; punto en que la rueda ya no puede almacenar más momento angular
– **magnetorquer** — magnetopar; dispositivo que usa el campo magnético terrestre para generar par, sin combustible
– **thruster** — propulsor; pequeño motor cohete para corregir la posición u orientación
– **come apart** — desintegrarse; romperse en pedazos por la fuerza
– **gimbal** — cardán; soporte con ejes que permite girar un objeto en una o dos direcciones

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **Reaction wheels control a spacecraft's orientation by changing the speed of a spinning wheel.** [CORRECT]
– Reaction wheels move spacecraft from one place to another without using fuel.
– Reaction wheels are mainly used to launch satellites into low Earth orbit.
– Reaction wheels are a type of rocket engine that uses electrical power.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what happened to the Kepler space telescope between 2012 and 2013?

– **Two of its four reaction wheels failed, so it could not point precisely enough for its original mission.** [CORRECT]
– All four of its reaction wheels were replaced by astronauts during a servicing mission.
– Its fuel supply was exhausted, which ended the mission immediately.
– One of its wheels was switched off as a precaution and later restarted.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "saturation" refers to the point at which a wheel...

– **has stored more momentum than its maximum speed allows.** [CORRECT]
– has been slowed down completely by friction.
– is mounted along a third axis for redundancy.
– begins to generate too much heat in its motor.

Comprehension 4. Which conclusion can be drawn from the passage about Hubble's design?

– **Its extra wheels allowed it to keep pointing accurately even when one wheel was not working.** [CORRECT]
– It relied only on chemical thrusters to control its orientation.
– It could not be repaired by astronauts because its wheels were too small.
– It used a single large wheel instead of several smaller ones.

Star tracker

A star tracker is an optical device that measures the positions of stars using photocells or a camera. Astronomers have measured the positions of many stars with great accuracy, so a satellite or spacecraft can use a star tracker to determine its orientation, also called its attitude. To do this, the device must capture an image of the stars, measure their apparent position in the spacecraft's reference frame, and identify them so that their position can be compared with the known absolute position in a star catalog. A processor may identify the stars by matching the observed pattern with the known pattern of stars in the sky.

In the 1950s and early 1960s, star trackers were an important part of early long-range ballistic and cruise missiles, because inertial navigation systems (INS) were not accurate enough for intercontinental ranges. Before launch, engineers calculated the angle of a chosen bright star for each moment of the flight. This signal was pre-recorded on magnetic tape, which was used to roughly point a telescope at the expected position of the star. At the telescope's focus, a photocell and a spinning disk called a chopper made the star's image appear and disappear repeatedly, producing a signal. Comparing its phase with the chopper's phase gave the angle to the star, and the difference from the expected angle produced an error signal that brought the missile back onto its trajectory.

Star trackers were often combined with an INS, which measures accelerations and integrates them over time to obtain velocity and position. Even tiny errors add up to an appreciable error known as drift. For example, the N-1 system of the SM-64 Navaho missile drifted about 1 nautical mile per hour, so after two hours it was 2 nautical miles off, well outside the desired accuracy of half a mile. In these stellar inertial systems, the INS points the tracker, and the tracker's measurement corrects the accumulated drift. They were especially common from the 1950s through the 1980s.

Today many models are available, including open projects for the CubeSat community. Star trackers need high sensitivity, so they can be confused by sunlight reflected from the spacecraft or by exhaust plumes from its thrusters. They are also prone to optical errors, such as spherical and chromatic aberration, and the identification algorithm can be misled by planets, comets, supernovae, nearby satellites or city light pollution.

About 57 bright navigational stars are in common use, but complex missions rely on whole star field databases. A high-fidelity catalog starts from a standard base, such as the one from the United States Naval Observatory, and is filtered to remove unreliable stars. It may be stored on board or processed at a ground station and uploaded. Star trackers can also help detect space debris and identify satellites.

Key points

– A star tracker finds a spacecraft's attitude by imaging stars and matching them against a star catalog.
– Early missiles used star trackers with a chopper and a photocell to correct their trajectory.
– An INS accumulates drift, and a star tracker can correct it.
– Sunlight reflections and thruster exhaust can confuse modern star trackers.

Glosario

– **attitude** — actitud, orientación de una nave en el espacio; término técnico aeroespacial, no significa 'actitud' personal
– **reference frame** — sistema de referencia; conjunto de ejes respecto al cual se miden posiciones

– **inertial navigation system (INS)** — sistema de navegación inercial; calcula la posición midiendo aceleraciones sin referencias externas
– **chopper** — interruptor óptico, disco giratorio que corta la luz de forma periódica; en otro contexto, helicóptero (coloquial)
– **drift** — deriva; error acumulado que aumenta con el tiempo
– **integrate** — integrar (matemáticas); sumar una magnitud a lo largo del tiempo
– **trajectory** — trayectoria; camino que sigue un objeto en vuelo
– **exhaust plume** — penacho de gases de escape; columna de gases que expulsa un propulsor
– **aberration** — aberración; defecto óptico que deforma la imagen
– **star catalog** — catálogo estelar; lista de estrellas con posiciones conocidas

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the text?

– **A star tracker measures star positions to determine a spacecraft's orientation and to correct navigation errors.** [CORRECT]
– A star tracker is a telescope used by astronomers to discover new stars.
– A star tracker is a weapon that guides missiles to enemy cities.
– A star tracker replaces the need for any kind of catalog or computer.

Comprehension 2. According to the text, how far off was the N-1 system after a two-hour flight?

– **About 2 nautical miles** [CORRECT]
– About half a mile
– About 1 nautical mile
– About 57 nautical miles

Comprehension 3. In the text, the word "drift" refers to

– **an error that grows as small measurement mistakes accumulate** [CORRECT]
– a sudden change in the brightness of a star
– the rotation of the Earth during the day
– a signal recorded on a magnetic tape

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about combining a star tracker with an INS?

– **It improves accuracy because the tracker limits the drift of the INS.** [CORRECT]
– It makes the INS unnecessary because the tracker is always perfect.
– It only works on missiles that fly northward.
– It increases the drift because two systems produce more errors.

Culture

Jazz

Jazz is a music genre that originated in the African-American communities of New Orleans in the late 19th and early 20th centuries. It grew out of blues, ragtime, European harmony, African rhythmic rituals, spirituals, hymns, marches and dance music. Its main features are swing and blue notes, complex chords, call-and-response vocals, polyrhythms and, above all, improvisation.

Jazz is hard to define because it covers more than a hundred years of music, from ragtime to rock-influenced fusion. The word itself probably comes from a slang term, "jasm", meaning energy or pep. Its earliest written record dates from 1912, when a baseball pitcher described a "jazz ball" that wobbles unpredictably. Critics have offered broad definitions, and Duke Ellington summed it up by saying, "It's all music."

Unlike classical music, where the performer aims to play the composition as written, jazz values interaction and collaboration. A performer never plays the same tune twice, changing melodies, harmonies and time signatures according to mood and the reaction of the band or audience. In many styles a soloist is supported by a rhythm section of piano or guitar, double bass and drums. In free jazz, even chords, scales and meters may be abandoned.

Its African roots survived partly through call-and-response patterns and body rhythms such as stomping and clapping, because the Black Codes outlawed drumming by enslaved people. The Afro-Cuban tresillo rhythm, which reached New Orleans through the habanera, became a fundamental figure; Jelly Roll Morton called it the "Spanish tinge". Ragtime, led by Scott Joplin, and the blues, which W. C. Handy published as sheet music, also shaped early jazz.

Jazz then evolved through many styles: swing big bands in the 1930s, bebop in the 1940s, cool jazz, hard bop, modal and free jazz, and finally fusion and smooth jazz. Throughout its history, race, gender and religion influenced who played it. Women worked as bandleaders and instrumentalists, and Jewish Americans and mixed bands such as Benny Goodman's helped bring jazz into popular culture.

Key points

– Jazz began in New Orleans from a mix of African and European musical traditions.
– Improvisation and swing are among its defining elements.
– Unlike classical music, jazz gives great importance to the performer's individual interpretation.
– Ragtime, blues and the Afro-Cuban tresillo rhythm were key ingredients of early jazz.
– Jazz kept changing, producing styles such as bebop, cool jazz, free jazz and fusion.

Glosario

– **improvisation** — improvisación; crear la música en el momento, sin partitura fija
– **call-and-response** — llamada y respuesta; patrón en que una voz o instrumento 'pregunta' y otro 'contesta'
– **syncopation** — síncopa; acento rítmico en tiempos débiles
– **wobble** — tambalearse; moverse de forma inestable de un lado a otro
– **encompass** — abarcar; incluir una gama amplia de cosas
– **outlaw** — prohibir legalmente; declarar ilegal
– **tinge** — matiz; ligero toque o influencia de algo
– **sheet music** — partitura impresa
– **rhythm section** — sección rítmica; piano/guitarra, bajo y batería que sostienen al solista
– **fusion** — fusión; mezcla de estilos, aquí jazz con rock

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the text?

– **Jazz is a genre that grew from African and European traditions and keeps evolving through improvisation** [CORRECT]
– Jazz is a style that was invented by Duke Ellington in the 1920s
– Jazz is a form of classical music played from a strict written score
– Jazz is a kind of dance music that disappeared after the swing era

Comprehension 2. According to the text, why were African drumming traditions not preserved in North America?

– **The Black Codes outlawed drumming by enslaved people** [CORRECT]
– Drums were too expensive for most musicians
– European instruments replaced them in every church
– Festivals in Congo Square were never organized

Comprehension 3. In the summary, the word "wobbles" in the description of the "jazz ball" means that the ball

– **moves unsteadily and unpredictably** [CORRECT]
– travels very fast in a straight line
– stops suddenly before reaching the batter
– makes a loud musical sound

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about the difference between classical music and jazz?

– **Jazz gives performers more freedom to change the music than classical music does** [CORRECT]
– Classical music allows more improvisation than jazz
– Jazz performers must always follow the composer's score exactly
– Classical musicians rarely work with other musicians

Ancient Olympic Games

The ancient Olympic Games were a series of athletic competitions among representatives of Greek city-states, held at the sanctuary of Olympia in honor of Zeus. Traditionally dated to 776 BC, they took place every four years, a period called an Olympiad, which became a unit of time in ancient chronologies. The last recorded celebration was in AD 393 under Theodosius I, although archaeological evidence suggests that some games were held afterward.

The Greeks gave the games a mythological origin. One story says Heracles and his brothers raced at Olympia to entertain the newborn Zeus. Another tells how Pelops won a chariot race against King Oenomaus by persuading the king's charioteer to replace the bronze axle pins with wax ones. Historians agree that the games probably date from the eighth century BC, but the exact date of 776 BC cannot be verified. For its first 200 years the event had only regional importance, and Peloponnesian athletes dominated it.

The games were both a religious festival and a political stage. During an Olympic truce, or ekecheiria, athletes and pilgrims could travel safely, although the truce did not stop all wars. City-states used the games to assert dominance, announce alliances and promote themselves, and successful athletes were linked to the spread of Greek colonies. Poets, sculptors and other artists came to show their work to would-be patrons. The statue of Zeus by Pheidias, made of gold and ivory, was counted among the seven wonders of the ancient world.

Only freeborn Greek men could compete, although women could take part as owners of chariot horses. The program grew from a single foot race, the stadion of about 190 metres, to as many as twenty events, including running, wrestling, boxing, the pankration and the hoplite race in full armour. Athletes competed naked for most of the games' history, a custom the Greeks felt set them apart from non-Greeks. Winners were rewarded with olive wreaths and honored in victory songs.

Under Roman rule the games declined at first, and Sulla robbed Olympia to finance a war. They revived under Augustus and again in the second century, but Nero damaged their reputation by ordering that his own victories be recognized, even after he fell from his chariot. From the third century the games lost popularity, and flooding, earthquakes and invasions damaged the site before they finally came to an end.

Key points

– The games were held every four years at Olympia in honor of Zeus, traditionally starting in 776 BC.
– They mixed sport, religion, art and politics, and the Olympic truce protected travelers.
– Only freeborn Greek men competed, and the program grew from one race to about twenty events.
– The games declined under Roman rule, revived under Augustus, and ended around the late fourth or early fifth century AD.

Glosario

– **sanctuary** — santuario; recinto sagrado dedicado a una deidad
– **truce** — tregua; cese temporal de hostilidades
– **pilgrim** — peregrino; persona que viaja a un lugar sagrado
– **wreath** — corona de hojas o flores; se daba al vencedor
– **would-be patrons** — posibles mecenas; personas que podrían financiar a un artista
– **freeborn** — nacido libre; que no es esclavo
– **chariot** — carro de caballos; usado en carreras y guerras antiguas

– **pankration** — pancracio; combate que mezclaba boxeo y lucha
– **armour** — armadura; equipo protector de un soldado (ortografía británica)
– **revived** — revivió, resurgió; volvió a tener fuerza o popularidad

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **The ancient Olympics were a religious, political and athletic festival held at Olympia for over a thousand years.** [CORRECT]
– The ancient Olympics were created by the Romans to celebrate military victories.
– The ancient Olympics were mainly an art competition for poets and sculptors.
– The ancient Olympics were open to every person in the Mediterranean world.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what was the only event at the beginning of the games?

– A wrestling match
– **A foot race of about 190 metres** [CORRECT]
– A chariot race
– A race in full armour

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "truce" means

– **a temporary agreement to stop fighting** [CORRECT]
– a prize given to the winner
– a religious sacrifice to Zeus
– a type of athletic training

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about the Olympic truce?

– It ended all wars in Greece for the whole year.
– **It was designed mainly to protect people traveling to the games.** [CORRECT]
– It was invented by the Romans.
– It applied only to athletes from Olympia.

History of coffee

Coffee has a history of many centuries. Wild coffee plants originated in Ethiopia, but the beverage itself has its roots in Yemen, where it was harvested, roasted and brewed. In the 15th century, Sufi Muslims used it to stay alert during their nighttime prayers. There is no confirmed evidence of coffee being drunk as a beverage before that century, so the drink appears to be a relatively recent development.

From Yemen, coffee spread to Mecca and the Arabian Peninsula, and by the early 16th century it had reached Cairo, Damascus and Istanbul. Its permissibility was debated: in 1511 conservative imams banned it at a theological court in Mecca, but the Ottoman Sultan Suleiman I overturned the ban in 1524. Despite these disputes, coffeehouses soon became central to urban social life, acting as places for conversation, poetry and political discussion.

Coffee entered Europe in the mid-16th century through Mediterranean trade, especially via Venice. The first mainland European coffeehouse opened in Venice in 1645, and by the late 17th century coffeehouses existed in Holland, England and Germany. In England, they became gathering places for serious religious and political talk, which was so common, and potentially subversive, that Charles II tried to crush them in the 1670s. According to a legend, Pope Clement VIII blessed the drink after trying it, although the story may not be true.

Until the end of the 17th century, the Yemeni port of Mocha was the world's only gateway for coffee. As demand grew, cultivation spread. In 1720, Gabriel de Clieu brought seedlings to Martinique, and from there coffee reached other Caribbean islands and Mexico. By 1788, Saint-Domingue supplied half of the world's coffee. Brazil became the largest producer in 1852 and has held that position ever since. More recently, Colombia, Ivory Coast, Ethiopia and Vietnam have emerged as major producers.

The origins of coffee are also surrounded by legends. The best known tells of a goatherder named Kaldi who noticed his goats becoming energetic after eating red berries. However, this story does not appear before 1671, so it is probably apocryphal. Modern genetic research, published in 2020, confirmed that most Arabica plants in the world descend from varieties cultivated in Yemen.

Key points

– Coffee as a drink comes from Yemen, where Sufis used it to stay awake during night prayers.
– Bans on coffee in the Muslim world were eventually overturned, and coffeehouses became social centers.
– Coffee reached Europe in the 16th century through Venetian trade, and English coffeehouses became places for political debate.
– Mocha was the only gateway for coffee until the end of the 17th century; Brazil has led production since 1852.
– A 2020 genetic study confirmed that most Arabica plants come from Yemen.

Glosario

– **Sufi** — sufí; seguidor del sufismo, corriente mística del islam
– **imam** — imán; líder religioso o de oración en el islam
– **overturn** — anular; revocar una decisión o prohibición
– **subversive** — subversivo; que amenaza o busca debilitar la autoridad establecida
– **crush** — aplastar; reprimir con fuerza un movimiento o actividad
– **apocryphal** — apócrifo; de origen dudoso, probablemente falso
– **goatherder** — cabrero; persona que cuida cabras

– **gateway** — puerta de entrada; punto por el que algo llega o pasa a otro lugar
– **seedling** — plántula; planta joven que ha crecido a partir de una semilla
– **cultivation** — cultivo; proceso de sembrar y cuidar plantas

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **Coffee spread from Yemen across the Muslim world, Europe and the Americas, becoming a major global product.** [CORRECT]
– Coffee was invented in Europe and later exported to the Middle East and Africa.
– Religious leaders successfully banned coffee everywhere in the world.
– Brazil created the coffee trade after discovering the plant in the 19th century.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what did Gabriel de Clieu do in 1720?

– He opened the first coffeehouse in Venice.
– **He brought coffee seedlings to Martinique.** [CORRECT]
– He banned coffee in the port of Mocha.
– He wrote the first study on coffee genetics.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "apocryphal" in the sentence "it is probably apocryphal" means

– **of doubtful authenticity** [CORRECT]
– very ancient and respected
– written by a religious authority
– proven by scientific research

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about coffeehouses in 17th-century England?

– **They were viewed by the king as a possible political danger.** [CORRECT]
– They were used only by wealthy merchants.
– They were closed by the church soon after opening.
– They served mostly as places to sell coffee seedlings.

Humanities

How Logical Fallacy Invalidates Any Argument

Fallacies are defects that make an argument invalid, unsound, or weak. They fall into two general groups: formal and informal. A formal fallacy can be identified merely by looking at the logical structure of an argument, without reading any specific statement. An informal fallacy, by contrast, can only be detected through an analysis of the actual content of the argument.

Formal fallacies appear only in deductive arguments with identifiable forms. They look reasonable because they mimic valid arguments. For example: all humans are mammals; all cats are mammals; therefore all humans are cats. Both premises are true, but the conclusion is false. If we reduce the argument to its bare structure (All A are C, All B are C, All A are B), it does not matter what A, B, and C stand for: the argument is invalid for the same reason. Stripping away content to examine structure is a useful way to test validity.

Informal fallacies work differently. Consider: geological events produce rock; rock is a type of music; therefore geological events produce music. When we break this down (A = B, B = C, A = C), the structure is valid, so the defect must lie in the content. Here a key term, "rock," is used with two different definitions. Some informal fallacies distract the reader, while others rely on ambiguity to cause confusion.

Aristotle was the first to systematically categorize fallacies, identifying thirteen of them. Since then, many more have been described. One useful classification includes fallacies of grammatical analogy, which resemble valid arguments; fallacies of ambiguity, such as equivocation and quoting out of context; fallacies of relevance, such as ad hominem and appeals to authority or emotion, whose premises are logically irrelevant to the conclusion; fallacies of presumption, such as begging the question and false dilemma, whose premises already assume what they should prove; and fallacies of weak induction, such as ad hoc rationalization and oversimplification, where the link between premises and conclusion is too weak to support it.

Key points

– A formal fallacy is visible in the structure of an argument; an informal fallacy is visible only in its content.
– True premises can still lead to a false conclusion if the structure is invalid.
– Reducing an argument to letters (A, B, C) helps reveal whether its form is valid.
– Equivocation uses one word with two different meanings to create confusion.
– Fallacies of presumption assume in the premises exactly what they are supposed to prove.

Glosario

– **fallacy** — falacia; error de razonamiento que invalida o debilita un argumento
– **unsound** — no sólido; se dice de un argumento con estructura válida pero con alguna premisa falsa
– **merely** — simplemente; solamente, nada más que
– **mimic** — imitar; parecerse a algo para pasar por ello
– **premise** — premisa; afirmación de la que parte un argumento
– **bare structure** — estructura desnuda; esqueleto lógico sin contenido
– **strip away** — quitar; despojar de capas para dejar lo esencial
– **equivocation** — equívoco; uso de una palabra con dos sentidos distintos en el mismo argumento
– **begging the question** — petición de principio; dar por sentado en las premisas lo que se pretende demostrar
– **ad hoc rationalization** — racionalización ad hoc; justificación improvisada para salvar una idea ya decidida

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, why is the argument about geological events and rock music an informal fallacy rather than a formal one?

– Because both of its premises are false.
– **Because its structure is valid, so the defect lies in the meaning of a key term.** [CORRECT]
– Because it is an inductive argument with no identifiable form.
– Because Aristotle did not include it in his list of thirteen fallacies.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what is the difference between a formal fallacy and an informal fallacy?

– **A formal fallacy can be found by examining the structure alone, while an informal fallacy requires analyzing the content.** [CORRECT]
– A formal fallacy appears only in inductive arguments, while an informal fallacy appears only in deductive ones.
– A formal fallacy always has false premises, while an informal fallacy always has true premises.
– A formal fallacy is easy to notice, while an informal fallacy can never be detected.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the expression "stripping away content" most nearly means

– **removing the specific subject matter of an argument.** [CORRECT]
– correcting the mistakes in an argument.
– adding more examples to an argument.
– shortening an argument to save time.

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about the argument "all humans are mammals; all cats are mammals; therefore all humans are cats"?

– **It would be invalid even if the terms were replaced by other words with the same structure.** [CORRECT]
– It would become valid if the conclusion were true.
– It is only invalid because one of its premises is false.
– It is an example of a fallacy of ambiguity.

What Is an Argument?

When people create or critique arguments, it helps to know what an argument is and is not. An argument is not a verbal fight, and it is not the same as making assertions. A Monty Python sketch offers a simple definition: an argument is a connected series of statements intended to establish a definite proposition. Contradiction, by contrast, is just the automatic gainsaying of whatever the other person says. To offer an argument, you must go beyond a claim and give others good reasons to believe it is true rather than false.

Statements such as 'Shakespeare wrote Hamlet' or 'Prostitution is immoral' are assertions, also called propositions. A proposition is the informational content of a statement, and it must be capable of being either true or false. Repeating an assertion, no matter how often, does not constitute an argument. The person making the claim must offer further statements that support it. If the claim is supported, the argument succeeds; if not, it fails. The purpose of an argument is to offer reasons and evidence to establish the truth value of a proposition.

An argument can be broken down into three components: premises, inferences, and a conclusion. Premises are statements of assumed fact that set forth the reasons or evidence for a claim. The conclusion is the claim you finish with. Inferences are the reasoning parts that link the premises to the final conclusion; the conclusion itself is the final inference.

Two kinds of claims appear in arguments. Factual claims purport to offer evidence, and little time is usually spent on them: they are either true or not. Inferential claims express the idea that some fact is related to the sought-after conclusion. Without them, there is no clear connection between premises and conclusion, and sometimes you must ask for the missing links. When you evaluate an argument, you spend most of your time on the inferences: that is where it will stand or fall and where fallacies are committed. Most real arguments are not presented so clearly, but every genuine argument should be capable of being reformulated this way; if it cannot, something is probably wrong.

Key points

– An argument is a connected series of statements meant to establish a proposition, not a fight or a simple contradiction.
– Repeating an assertion is not an argument; you must offer further statements that support the claim.
– Every argument has three parts: premises, inferences, and a conclusion.
– Factual claims offer evidence; inferential claims link that evidence to the conclusion.
– Arguments stand or fall on their inferences, which is where fallacies are found.

Glosario

– **to critique** — analizar críticamente; evaluar con rigor (no necesariamente criticar mal)
– **assertion** — afirmación; aseveración que se hace sin aportar pruebas
– **gainsaying** — contradecir; negar automáticamente lo que dice otro (voz culta)
– **proposition** — proposición; contenido informativo de un enunciado que puede ser verdadero o falso
– **premise** — premisa; enunciado de hecho supuesto que sirve de base a una conclusión
– **inference** — inferencia; paso de razonamiento que conecta las premisas con la conclusión
– **to set forth** — exponer; presentar de forma ordenada (razones, pruebas)
– **to purport to** — pretender; dar a entender que algo es o hace cierta cosa, sin garantía de que sea así
– **sought-after** — buscado; deseado; que se pretende alcanzar

– **to stand or fall** — sostenerse o venirse abajo; depender por completo de algo (expresión fija)

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, when you evaluate an argument, where will you spend most of your time?

– On the factual claims, because they are the hardest to verify.
– **On the inferential claims, because that is where the argument stands or falls.** [CORRECT]
– On the conclusion, because it is the only statement that can be true or false.
– On the assertion, because repeating it makes the argument stronger.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what is a proposition?

– **The informational content of a statement, which must be capable of being true or false.** [CORRECT]
– A verbal fight in which each person contradicts the other.
– A series of premises that always leads to a false conclusion.
– A claim that becomes true when it is repeated often enough.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "gainsaying" in the phrase "the automatic gainsaying of whatever the other person says" is closest in meaning to:

– **Denying or contradicting.** [CORRECT]
– Repeating word for word.
– Agreeing with politely.
– Explaining in detail.

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about an argument that cannot be reformulated into premises, inferences, and a conclusion?

– **It probably has a problem and may not be a genuine argument.** [CORRECT]
– It is certainly a strong argument because it is so original.
– It is only a factual claim that needs no further support.
– It must be a Monty Python sketch rather than a real argument.

Whistleblower: Definition and Examples

A whistleblower is a person, often an employee, who reveals information about activity inside a private or public organization that is considered illegal, immoral, unsafe, or fraudulent. The U.S. Whistleblower Protection Act of 1989 defines whistleblowing as disclosing information that the employee reasonably believes shows a violation of law, gross mismanagement, a gross waste of funds, an abuse of authority, or a danger to public health or safety. In simpler terms, whistleblowers are informants, and their disclosures have exposed the Watergate cover-up, the accounting fraud at Enron and WorldCom, and the health dangers of nicotine.

The term comes from the 19th century, when police officers blew a whistle to alert the public of crimes in progress. In the 1960s, journalists adopted the single word whistleblower to avoid the negative connotations of words such as informant and snitch. An early example was Ralph Nader, whose 1965 book Unsafe at Any Speed attacked the automobile industry. General Motors retaliated by tapping his phone and hiring prostitutes to discredit him, but Nader won a $425,000 settlement, and Congress passed the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act in 1966.

Research shows that whistleblowers are usually motivated by integrity and a genuine desire to protect the public, not by monetary awards. Many are unwilling to participate in conduct they believe is wrong, even though speaking out can harm their careers. Social pressures also play a role: people are more likely to come forward when others already know about the wrongdoing.

In the private sector, employees typically report to a supervisor, a lawyer, or the police. In 2021, Frances Haugen disclosed thousands of internal Facebook documents, accusing the company of prioritizing profit over public safety. In the public sector, famous cases include W. Mark Felt, known as Deep Throat, who helped expose Watergate; Daniel Ellsberg, who leaked the Pentagon Papers; and Edward Snowden, who revealed mass surveillance programs and was charged with espionage.

Whistleblowers are seen either as heroic martyrs or as traitors. Even those who halted billion-dollar frauds are routinely demoted, fired, or threatened. In the United States, a patchwork of federal and state laws, such as the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002, protects employees who call attention to violations or refuse to obey unlawful directions.

Key points

– A whistleblower reveals illegal, unsafe, or fraudulent activity inside an organization, usually as an insider.
– The word was adopted by journalists in the 1960s to avoid negative terms like informant or snitch.
– Most whistleblowers act out of integrity, not for monetary awards, despite the risk to their careers.
– Famous cases include Ralph Nader, Deep Throat (Watergate), the Pentagon Papers, Edward Snowden, and Frances Haugen.
– Whistleblowers are often attacked or fired, so U.S. laws such as the Sarbanes-Oxley Act exist to protect them from retaliation.

Glosario

– **whistleblower** — denunciante; persona que revela irregularidades dentro de una organización (literalmente «el que sopla el silbato»)
– **wrongdoing** — irregularidad; conducta indebida o ilícita
– **gross mismanagement** — mala gestión grave; «gross» aquí significa flagrante, grosero, no «bruto»

– **cover-up** — encubrimiento; ocultación deliberada de un delito o error
– **snitch** — soplón, chivato; término despectivo e informal para un informante
– **to tap a phone** — intervenir o pinchar un teléfono; escuchar llamadas en secreto
– **settlement** — acuerdo extrajudicial; indemnización pactada para cerrar una demanda
– **to come forward** — dar un paso adelante, presentarse para hablar o denunciar; no es «avanzar» físicamente
– **retaliation** — represalia; venganza o castigo por haber denunciado
– **patchwork** — mosaico, conjunto irregular de piezas; aquí, leyes dispersas y poco uniformes

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, why did journalists in the 1960s begin using the word "whistleblower"?

– Because police officers had stopped using whistles to warn the public.
– **Because they wanted to avoid the negative connotations of words like "informant" and "snitch."** [CORRECT]
– Because the Whistleblower Protection Act required them to use that term.
– Because Ralph Nader asked the press to describe him that way.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what did General Motors do to try to discredit Ralph Nader after his 1965 book was published?

– It sued him for damaging the reputation of the automobile industry.
– **It tapped his phone and hired prostitutes to discredit him.** [CORRECT]
– It offered him a $425,000 settlement to withdraw the book.
– It asked Congress to investigate his research methods.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "retaliated" in "General Motors retaliated by tapping his phone" is closest in meaning to:

– **responded with hostile action against him** [CORRECT]
– apologized for its earlier mistakes
– agreed to cooperate with his demands
– publicly defended his conclusions

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about the legal protection of whistleblowers in the United States?

– **It is provided by a mix of laws at different levels rather than a single system.** [CORRECT]
– It is guaranteed by one federal law that covers every employee.
– It applies only to people who work for the government.
– It has made retaliation against whistleblowers very rare.

National Security Definition and Examples

National security is the ability of a country's government to protect its citizens, economy, and other institutions. For most of the 20th century it was strictly a matter of military power and readiness, but the nuclear age and the Cold War made that definition a thing of the past. Today, U.S. policymakers struggle to balance several "national securities": economic, political, energy, homeland, cyber, human, and environmental security.

The modern environment is complicated by violent non-state actors, such as suicide bombers trained by al Qaeda, Somali pirates, warlords in the Niger Delta, and drug cartels in Mexico. Conventional strategy is ill-equipped to deal with them, so analysts suggest three "spoiler management" strategies: inducements, socialization to change their behavior, and arbitrary measures to weaken them. Peace-building and state-building efforts also try to strengthen state institutions. Scholar Sam C. Sarkesian defined U.S. national security as "the ability of national institutions to prevent adversaries from using force to harm Americans."

The primary goals of U.S. strategy, first stated in 1998, are to protect the lives of Americans, maintain the sovereignty of the country, and provide for its prosperity. The 2021 Interim National Security Strategic Guidance added priorities such as deterring adversaries, mainly China and Russia, and sustaining an open international system underwritten by democratic alliances.

The 9/11 attacks still shape U.S. policy. The War on Terror ushered in laws like the USA Patriot Act, which prioritized security at the expense of some civil liberties, and police departments adopted surplus military equipment, blurring the line between warfare abroad and law enforcement at home. The human toll was enormous for U.S. personnel and, even more, for the people of Afghanistan and Iraq.

National security is distinguished from global security, which involves demands like climate change that no single country can handle alone and which require multinational cooperation through organizations such as the UN and NATO. Governments rely on political, economic, military, and diplomatic tactics. The 2018 National Defense Strategy states that inter-state strategic competition, not terrorism, is now the primary concern. Success must be achieved on two levels: the physical, measured by military capacity, and the psychological, which depends on the people's willingness to support the government's goals.

Key points

– National security now includes non-military missions such as economic, energy, cyber, and environmental security.
– Violent non-state actors require flexible "spoiler management" strategies, not conventional military responses.
– The War on Terror expanded government powers, sometimes at the expense of civil liberties.
– Global security demands, like climate change, require multinational cooperation.
– The 2018 National Defense Strategy names inter-state competition, not terrorism, as the primary concern.

Glosario

– **readiness** — disposición operativa; estado de preparación de una fuerza para actuar de inmediato
– **a thing of the past** — cosa del pasado; algo que ya no aplica ni existe (idiom)
– **non-state actor** — actor no estatal; grupo armado o político que opera sin ser un gobierno (terroristas, cárteles, piratas)
– **ill-equipped** — mal preparado; sin los medios o la capacidad adecuados para una tarea
– **warlord** — señor de la guerra; jefe militar que controla una región por la fuerza al margen del Estado

– **inducement** — incentivo; aliciente ofrecido para persuadir a alguien de actuar de cierta forma
– **sovereignty** — soberanía; autoridad suprema de un Estado sobre su territorio e instituciones
– **deter** — disuadir; impedir que un adversario actúe por miedo a las consecuencias
– **usher in** — dar paso a; inaugurar o marcar el comienzo de una nueva etapa (phrasal verb)
– **blur the line** — difuminar la línea; hacer que dos cosas dejen de distinguirse claramente (idiom)

Comprehension 1. According to the 2018 National Defense Strategy, what is now the primary concern in U.S. national security?

– International terrorism
– **Inter-state strategic competition** [CORRECT]
– Climate change
– Drug trafficking

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, why did the definition of national security based only on military power become outdated?

– **Because the nuclear age and the Cold War changed the nature of threats** [CORRECT]
– Because the United Nations took over defense duties from national governments
– Because economic problems made armies too expensive to maintain
– Because citizens stopped supporting military spending after 1998

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the phrase "at the expense of" in "prioritized security at the expense of some civil liberties" is closest in meaning to:

– **with the loss or sacrifice of** [CORRECT]
– with the full approval of
– in order to pay for
– in spite of the opinion of

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about problems such as climate change?

– **They are best solved when several countries work together** [CORRECT]
– They can be solved by a single country with a strong military
– They are less important than terrorism for national security
– They only affect countries that are members of NATO

Push-Pull Factors in Immigration

Push-pull factors in immigration are the forces that drive people away from one place and draw them toward another. Push factors are often forceful: they demand that a person or group leave a country, or at least give them strong reasons to move, usually because of a threat of violence or the loss of financial security. Pull factors, in contrast, are the positive aspects of a different country that encourage people to immigrate in search of a better life. Although the two may seem diametrically opposed, both typically come into play when a person or population is considering migrating.

Push factors are detrimental conditions that essentially force people to seek refuge elsewhere. They include a sub-standard level of living, food shortage, land or job scarcity, famine or drought, political or religious persecution, pollution, and natural disasters. Under the worst circumstances, speed of exit matters more than choosing the best destination. Not every push factor obliges a person to leave, but the conditions are often so dire that staying means suffering financially, emotionally, or physically. The Great Potato Famine of the mid-19th century, for example, pushed thousands of Irish families to the United States to avoid starvation.

Refugee populations are among the most affected by push factors. They often face genocide-like conditions in their country of origin, usually because of authoritarian governments or groups hostile to a religious or ethnic minority. Jews leaving Germany during the Nazi era, for instance, were threatened with violent death if they remained.

Pull factors help people determine whether relocating would provide a significant benefit. They attract populations because the new country offers something unavailable at home: freedom from persecution, career opportunities, cheap land, or an abundance of food. Students entering universities or seeking jobs in more developed countries, for example, may receive larger salaries and greater opportunities than in their countries of origin.

For some individuals, push and pull factors work together, especially when the push factors are relatively benign. A young adult who cannot find a lucrative job at home may consider immigrating only if the opportunities elsewhere are significantly better.

Key points

– Push factors drive people away from a place; pull factors draw them to a new one.
– Push factors include famine, drought, persecution, job scarcity, pollution, and natural disasters.
– Refugees are the population most affected by push factors, often facing genocide-like conditions.
– Pull factors are opportunities unavailable at home, such as freedom, jobs, cheap land, or abundant food.
– When push factors are mild, people usually migrate only if the pull factors are significantly stronger.

Glosario

– **diametrically opposed** — diametralmente opuestos; completamente contrarios
– **come into play** — entrar en juego; empezar a influir en una situación
– **detrimental** — perjudicial; dañino
– **seek refuge** — buscar refugio; ponerse a salvo en otro lugar
– **scarcity** — escasez; falta de algo necesario
– **famine** — hambruna; escasez extrema de alimentos

– **drought** — sequía; período prolongado sin lluvia
– **dire** — extremo; terrible; desesperado (situación)
– **benign** — benigno; leve; poco grave
– **lucrative** — lucrativo; que produce buenas ganancias

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, when do push and pull factors most often work together?

– When a country suffers a natural disaster
– When refugees face genocide-like conditions
– **When the push factors are relatively mild** [CORRECT]
– When students receive larger salaries abroad

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, which historical event pushed thousands of Irish families to the United States?

– A war between neighboring countries
– **The Great Potato Famine of the mid-19th century** [CORRECT]
– A religious persecution during the Nazi era
– A severe drought in the western territories

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "dire" in the phrase "the conditions are often so dire that staying means suffering" is closest in meaning to

– **extremely serious** [CORRECT]
– fairly common
– easy to predict
– slightly unpleasant

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about a person who leaves home because of a genocide-like threat?

– The person probably compares many destinations carefully before leaving
– **The person is likely to choose a quick escape over the best destination** [CORRECT]
– The person will most likely return once salaries improve at home
– The person is mainly attracted by cheap land abroad

The 1932 March of the Veterans Bonus Army

In the summer of 1932, more than 17,000 U.S. veterans of World War I marched on Washington, D.C. They demanded immediate cash payment of the service bonuses that Congress had promised them eight years earlier. The press called them the "Bonus Army," but the group named itself the "Bonus Expeditionary Force," echoing the wartime American Expeditionary Forces.

The bonus came from the World War Adjusted Compensation Act of 1924, which gave each qualified veteran a certificate worth 125% of his wartime service credit. The catch was that the certificates could not be redeemed until 1945. President Calvin Coolidge had vetoed the bill, saying that "patriotism, bought and paid for, is not patriotism," but Congress overrode his veto. When the Great Depression began in 1929, most veterans lost their jobs, and by 1932 they could not afford to wait.

The veterans set up makeshift camps around the capital. The largest, nicknamed "Hooverville" as a backhanded tribute to President Herbert Hoover, stood on Anacostia Flats, a swampy bog across the river from the Capitol. With families and supporters, the crowd grew to nearly 45,000. The veterans kept order and built military-style sanitation facilities. In June the House passed a bill to move up the payment date, but the Senate defeated it. The protest march that followed turned violent, and two veterans and two police officers died.

On July 28, Hoover ordered the Secretary of War to clear the camps. Infantry and cavalry under General Douglas MacArthur, backed by six light tanks commanded by Major George S. Patton, charged the veterans with sabers, fixed bayonets and tear gas. Hoover then told the troops to stand down, but MacArthur ignored the order, claiming the marchers wanted to overthrow the government, and launched a second charge. By nightfall, 55 veterans were injured and 135 arrested.

The Army saw the operation as a success, but the press called it "a pitiful spectacle." The political fallout helped Franklin D. Roosevelt defeat Hoover in November. In 1936 Congress overrode Roosevelt's veto and paid the bonuses at once, and the episode contributed to the GI Bill of 1944.

Key points

– The Bonus Army was over 17,000 World War I veterans who marched on Washington in 1932 demanding early payment of bonuses due in 1945.
– The Great Depression turned a 20-year promise into an urgent need for cash.
– The Senate rejected early payment, and a police clash killed two veterans and two officers.
– MacArthur ignored Hoover's order to stand down and cleared the camps with troops, tanks and tear gas.
– The scandal damaged Hoover politically; Congress finally paid the bonuses in 1936 over Roosevelt's veto.

Glosario

– **makeshift** — improvisado; provisional, hecho con lo que hay a mano
– **backhanded (tribute)** — irónico; homenaje con doble intención, en realidad una burla
– **to redeem (a certificate)** — canjear; cobrar un bono o certificado por su valor en efectivo
– **to override a veto** — anular un veto; el Congreso impone la ley pese al rechazo del presidente
– **the catch** — la trampa; la pega o condición oculta de un trato
– **to move up (a date)** — adelantar una fecha; hacer que algo ocurra antes de lo previsto
– **fixed bayonets** — bayonetas caladas; cuchillas montadas en el fusil, listas para el asalto
– **to stand down** — retirarse; cesar la operación y volver a la posición de espera (orden militar)

– **fallout** — consecuencias negativas; repercusión política de un hecho
– **swampy bog** — ciénaga; terreno pantanoso y empapado

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, why did General MacArthur launch a second charge against the veterans?

– President Hoover ordered him to continue the attack.
– **He claimed the marchers were trying to overthrow the government.** [CORRECT]
– The veterans had attacked the tanks with weapons.
– The Senate had asked him to clear the camps immediately.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, why did the veterans want to be paid in 1932 instead of waiting until 1945?

– **They had lost their jobs during the Great Depression and could not afford to wait.** [CORRECT]
– Congress had promised to pay them earlier than the law stated.
– President Coolidge had cancelled the certificates in 1924.
– They wanted to use the money to build camps near the Capitol.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the phrase "a backhanded tribute to President Herbert Hoover" most nearly means that the name Hooverville was

– **an insult disguised as an honor.** [CORRECT]
– a sincere expression of gratitude.
– a formal title given by Congress.
– a secret code used by the veterans.

Comprehension 4. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about the way the government handled the Bonus Army?

– **It damaged Hoover's public image and helped Roosevelt win the election.** [CORRECT]
– It convinced Congress to pay the bonuses immediately in 1932.
– It was praised by the press as a well-organized operation.
– It proved that the veterans planned to overthrow the government.

Silk Road

The Silk Road was a network of Asian trade routes active from the second century BCE until the mid-15th century. It stretched over 6,400 km on land and linked the Eastern and Western worlds economically, culturally, politically and religiously. The name was coined in the late 19th century and popularized in 1877 by Ferdinand von Richthofen. Some historians prefer "Silk Routes", because the system was an intricate web of land and sea routes, not a single road. Others argue that the classic idea overlooks steppe nomads, India and Iran.

The network began to take shape when China's Han dynasty expanded into Central Asia. Around 130 BCE, the envoy Zhang Qian explored the region, and his reports showed the economic reasons for pushing westward. The Chinese extended the Great Wall to protect the trade route, and the Han army regularly policed it against nomadic bandits. The Parthian Empire served as a vital bridge to the Mediterranean, while Rome became the western terminus. Chinese silk was in great demand there, although many Romans wrongly believed it grew on trees. The Senate issued several edicts against wearing silk, on economic and moral grounds, but in vain.

The system was highly decentralized and security was sparse. Travelers faced banditry, raids and inhospitable terrain, so few people traveled the whole length. Instead, goods passed through a succession of middlemen in a kind of "relay trade". Beyond silk, caravans carried tea, dyes, perfumes, porcelain, horses, camels, honey, wine and gold. Ideas, especially Buddhist and scientific thought, also spread, and so did diseases such as plague, possibly contributing to the Black Death.

There were several routes. The northern route started at Chang'an and split around the Taklamakan Desert, while the southern route crossed the Karakoram mountains, where the Karakoram Highway runs today. A maritime route, run by Austronesian, Persian, Arab and Tamil sailors, connected Southeast Asia, India, Arabia and East Africa. Ships carried far larger cargoes and could avoid political conflict, although they faced weather and piracy.

Critics such as Warwick Ball call the Silk Road a "myth" of modern academia. He argues that maritime spice trade with India mattered more to Rome, and that free movement of goods did not exist until the Mongol Empire. From 1453, the Ottoman Empire competed for control of the overland routes, which pushed Europeans to seek alternatives and marked the start of the Age of Discovery. Today, "New Silk Road" describes projects such as China's Belt and Road Initiative, and UNESCO has designated some corridors as World Heritage Sites.

Key points

– The Silk Road was a network of land and sea routes, not a single road.
– Zhang Qian's explorations around 130 BCE helped open the route for the Han dynasty.
– Few travelers crossed the whole route; goods changed hands through middlemen.
– Goods, religions, ideas and diseases all spread along the routes.
– The Ottoman advance after 1453 pushed Europeans to seek other routes, starting the Age of Discovery.

Glosario

– **envoy** — enviado, emisario; representante diplomático de rango menor que un embajador
– **terminus** — punto final o estación terminal de una ruta
– **banditry** — bandolerismo; asaltos y robos en los caminos
– **inhospitable** — inhóspito; hostil e inadecuado para vivir o cruzar

– **middlemen** — intermediarios; quienes compran y revenden entre productor y comprador
– **relay trade** — comercio por relevos; las mercancías pasan de mano en mano por tramos
– **decentralized** — descentralizado; sin una autoridad o control único
– **edict** — edicto; decreto oficial emitido por una autoridad
– **in vain** — en vano; sin conseguir el resultado buscado
– **caravan** — caravana; grupo de mercaderes que viajan juntos con animales de carga

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the text?

– **The Silk Road was a network of trade routes that connected East and West for centuries.** [CORRECT]
– The Silk Road was a single road built by the Roman Empire to import silk.
– The Silk Road was created only to transport religious ideas across Asia.
– The Silk Road was an ocean route used exclusively by Austronesian sailors.

Comprehension 2. According to the text, what did the Senate of Rome try to do about silk?

– **It tried to forbid people from wearing it, but failed.** [CORRECT]
– It tried to buy all the silk produced in China.
– It tried to grow silk on trees in Italy.
– It tried to tax silk to pay for the army.

Comprehension 3. In the text, the word "sparse" in "security was sparse" means:

– **very limited or thin** [CORRECT]
– extremely strict
– completely modern
– well organized

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the fact that few people traveled the entire Silk Road?

– **Most goods reached their destination through several traders in succession.** [CORRECT]
– Merchants preferred to travel alone for safety.
– The route was too short to require middlemen.
– Silk was produced in every region along the way.

Printing press

A printing press is a machine that applies pressure to transfer ink onto paper, cloth, or a similar surface. It improved on older methods, in which paper was rubbed by hand over inked material. The German goldsmith Johannes Gutenberg invented it around 1440, and its spread revolutionized literary production and communication in early modern Europe.

Gutenberg combined four existing technologies: the screw press, movable type, the codex book format, and mechanized paper production. He added his own innovations, such as a hand mold for casting type and an oil-based ink suited to metal type. He was also the first to make type from an alloy of lead, tin, and antimony, which was particularly durable. Movable type had appeared earlier in East Asia, but thousands of logographic characters made it costly there, while the Latin alphabet needed only a small set.

To operate a classical press, a compositor set individual metal letters into lines, placed them in a frame called a forme, and inked them with leather ink balls. A sheet of dampened paper, held by the tympan and the frisket, was folded over the type. The compositor then pulled a long lever, the bar, which drove a screw that pressed the platen onto the paper. Around 1800, Lord Stanhope built an iron press that printed a whole sheet in one pull. Later, steam power and rotary motion, introduced by Friedrich Koenig and Richard M. Hoe, allowed millions of impressions per day.

Printing spread quickly: by the end of the 15th century, around 270 European cities had presses, and by 1500 they had produced over 20 million copies. Because the equipment was portable, printers could relocate when authorities tried to curtail them, which made censorship difficult. Printing helped to spread the Reformation, lowered the cost of texts, raised adult literacy, and encouraged books in vernacular languages instead of Latin.

It also changed how people worked and read. Identical copies allowed precise citation and gave authors greater importance, while reading shifted from communal recitation to silent, private reading. Scientists could share discoveries faster and across greater distances. Governments used print for propaganda, and both church and state tried to control it. Some contemporaries criticized it, arguing that printers valued profit over accuracy. Later, offset printing and digital methods replaced the letterpress in commercial work.

Key points

– Gutenberg invented the movable-type printing press around 1440 by combining four existing technologies.
– Metal type, an oil-based ink, and the screw press made high-quality mass printing possible.
– Iron, steam-powered, and rotary presses greatly increased output during the Industrial Revolution.
– Printing spread the Reformation, raised literacy, and helped replace Latin with vernacular languages.
– Authorities tried to censor the press, but its portability made control difficult.

Glosario

– **movable type** — tipos móviles; letras individuales reutilizables para componer un texto
– **alloy** — aleación; mezcla de metales
– **compositor** — cajista; el que compone el texto colocando los tipos
– **platen** — platina; superficie plana que presiona el papel contra los tipos
– **vernacular** — lengua vernácula; el idioma local hablado, en oposición al latín
– **curtail** — restringir; recortar o limitar algo

– **censorship** — censura; control de lo que se puede publicar
– **literacy** — alfabetización; capacidad de leer y escribir
– **propaganda** — propaganda; información usada para influir en la opinión pública
– **treatise** — tratado; obra extensa y formal sobre un tema

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **Gutenberg's press combined existing technologies and transformed communication, science, and politics in Europe.** [CORRECT]
– Movable type was invented in China and never reached Europe.
– Steam power was the most important development in the history of printing.
– Governments successfully stopped the spread of printed material across Europe.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what did the Stanhope press allow printers to do?

– **Print a whole sheet in a single pull.** [CORRECT]
– Print both sides of a sheet at once.
– Use rolled paper with continuous feed.
– Cast a complete line of type.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "curtail" in "authorities tried to curtail them" is closest in meaning to:

– **restrict** [CORRECT]
– support
– copy
– finance

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about the portability of the printing press?

– **It helped printers avoid control by moving to other cities.** [CORRECT]
– It made presses too heavy to use outside large cities.
– It reduced the need for paper and ink.
– It prevented the press from reaching other continents.

Renaissance

The Renaissance, meaning "rebirth", was a European period and cultural movement at the end of the Late Middle Ages and the start of the early modern era. It is usually placed in the 15th and 16th centuries, although some define it more broadly, from the 14th century to the 17th. Its defining feature was the rediscovery and revival of the literary, philosophical and artistic achievements of classical antiquity. It began in Florence, then spread across Italy and the rest of Europe.

Its intellectual basis was humanism, which rested on Roman humanitas and on classical Greek philosophy. Humanism was less a philosophy than a method of learning: scholars studied ancient texts in their original languages and judged them through reasoning and empirical evidence. In the 14th century, scholars such as Petrarch scoured European libraries for Latin works. After the fall of Constantinople in 1453, Greek scholars brought precious manuscripts to the West, and the Greek phase of humanism followed. Renaissance scholars differed from earlier medieval ones because they focused on literary and historical texts, not only on science and mathematics.

Historians disagree about why the movement began in Italy. Italy was divided into rich, urbanized city-states, such as Florence and Venice, where merchants brought new ideas from distant lands. Their relative political freedom helped academic and artistic progress, and their wealth paid for large artistic projects. The Medici, a banking family, acted as patrons of artists like Leonardo da Vinci and Michelangelo. Some theorists also suggest that the Black Death, which killed about a third of England's population, changed how people saw life on Earth and raised the value of working people.

The period brought change in many fields. Painters such as Masaccio developed linear perspective and studied light, shadow and anatomy in order to portray the human form realistically. Brunelleschi studied ancient buildings and designed the dome of Florence Cathedral. Machiavelli tried to describe political life as it really was. Writers increasingly used vernacular languages, and the movable type printing press, which appeared in Germany around 1440, made books available to many more people. By the end of the 15th century, it had produced more than 20 million volumes. Historians still debate whether the Renaissance was a true break with the Middle Ages or an extension of it.

Key points

– The Renaissance was a European cultural movement centered first in Florence that revived classical antiquity.
– Humanism was a method of learning based on studying ancient texts in their original languages.
– Florence's wealth, political freedom and patrons such as the Medici helped the movement begin.
– Realistic perspective in art and the printing press were major innovations.
– Historians still debate whether it broke with the Middle Ages or continued them.

Glosario

– **rediscovery** — redescubrimiento; recuperación de algo olvidado
– **vernacular** — lengua vernácula; idioma hablado por la gente común, no el latín
– **to scour** — rastrear a fondo; buscar minuciosamente en un lugar
– **patron** — mecenas; persona que financia a artistas
– **plague** — peste; epidemia mortal
– **perspective** — perspectiva; técnica para representar la profundidad en una imagen

– **empirical** — empírico; basado en la observación y la experiencia
– **manuscript** — manuscrito; texto escrito a mano antes de la imprenta
– **antiquity** — antigüedad; el mundo de la Grecia y la Roma clásicas
– **to flourish** — florecer; prosperar con fuerza

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **The Renaissance was a cultural movement that revived classical learning, began in Florence and spread across Europe.** [CORRECT]
– The Renaissance was a period of war between the Italian city-states and the Ottoman Empire.
– The Renaissance was a religious movement that rejected Christianity in favor of Greek philosophy.
– The Renaissance was a short scientific revolution that started in Germany with the printing press.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what did the movable type printing press produce by the end of the 15th century?

– **More than 20 million volumes** [CORRECT]
– About 270 new universities
– Nearly 2 million Greek manuscripts
– Over 20 thousand public libraries

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "scoured" in "scoured the libraries of Europe" is closest in meaning to

– **searched thoroughly** [CORRECT]
– quickly visited
– carefully cleaned
– secretly built

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about the Medici family from the passage?

– **Their wealth and support made it possible for artists to create major works.** [CORRECT]
– They personally painted many of the famous works of the period.
– They opposed the spread of humanism in Florence.
– They ruled all of Italy as a single kingdom.

Math

Why Mathematics Is a Language

Mathematics is often called the language of science. Galileo Galilei wrote that the universe is written in mathematical language, with triangles, circles, and other geometrical figures as its letters, and that without them it is impossible to comprehend a single word. But is mathematics truly a language, like English or Chinese? To answer this, it helps to define language and to see how the vocabulary and grammar of mathematics build sentences.

There are several definitions of language. Linguist Noam Chomsky defined it as a set of sentences constructed from a finite set of elements. Whichever definition is used, a language needs a vocabulary of words or symbols, meaning attached to them, a grammar, a syntax that organizes symbols into propositions, a discourse made of strings of propositions, and a group of people who use and understand the symbols. Mathematics meets all of these requirements, and its symbols and rules are the same throughout the world.

A mathematical equation can be stated in words as a sentence with a noun and a verb. Nouns include numerals, fractions, variables, expressions, diagrams, infinity, and pi. Verbs include equalities, inequalities, and operations such as addition or division. Grammar and syntax are international: formulas are read from left to right, the Latin and Greek alphabets are used for variables and specific concepts, and parentheses and brackets indicate the order in which symbols interact.

Understanding mathematical sentences is a useful teaching tool. Students often find symbols intimidating, so putting an equation into familiar language makes the subject more approachable. Word problems, although disliked, improve comprehension and problem-solving skills. Because math is the same everywhere, it can act as a universal language even when other communication barriers exist.

Not everyone agrees. Some definitions describe language as spoken, while mathematics is written, and complex equations are hard to read aloud. However, this criterion would also disqualify sign language, which most linguists accept as a true language. A strong argument in favor is that modern school curricula use techniques from language education to teach mathematics, since students need robust vocabulary knowledge, fluency with symbols, and comprehension skills.

Key points

– Galileo described the universe as written in mathematical language.
– A language needs vocabulary, meaning, grammar, syntax, discourse, and a community of users; math meets all six.
– Mathematical sentences have nouns (numbers, variables) and verbs (equalities, operations).
– Math grammar is international: the same formulas mean the same thing in every country.
– The main objection is that math is written rather than spoken, but sign language faces the same objection and is still a language.

Glosario

– **to comprehend** — comprender; entender a fondo (registro culto)
– **finite set** — conjunto finito; grupo limitado de elementos
– **proposition** — proposición; enunciado que afirma algo
– **to meet a requirement** — cumplir un requisito; satisfacer una condición
– **intimidating** — intimidante; que asusta o impone

– **approachable** — accesible; fácil de abordar (un tema o una persona)
– **word problem** — problema de enunciado; problema matemático planteado en texto
– **to disqualify** — descalificar; dejar fuera por no cumplir un criterio
– **curricula** — planes de estudio (plural de curriculum)
– **robust** — sólido; fuerte y bien fundamentado

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, why does the objection that mathematics is not spoken fail to prove that it is not a language?

– Because most equations can easily be read aloud in any language.
– **Because sign language is not spoken either, yet linguists accept it as a true language.** [CORRECT]
– Because Galileo said the universe is written in mathematics.
– Because students find symbols intimidating.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what did Galileo Galilei say about the geometrical figures such as triangles and circles?

– **They are the letters of the language in which the universe is written.** [CORRECT]
– They are the only symbols that all people in the world can pronounce.
– They were invented to make word problems easier for students.
– They replace the need for grammar in mathematical sentences.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "intimidating" in the sentence "Students often find symbols intimidating" is closest in meaning to

– **frightening or discouraging.** [CORRECT]
– familiar and comforting.
– boring and repetitive.
– surprising and amusing.

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about the use of everyday language to explain equations?

– **It can make mathematics feel less difficult for students who fear symbols.** [CORRECT]
– It is the reason why mathematical symbols differ from country to country.
– It proves that mathematics cannot be a language of its own.
– It is only useful for students who already speak several languages.

How to Overcome Math Anxiety

Math anxiety, or fear of math, is very common. It resembles test anxiety and stage fright: the fear that something will go wrong, that you will forget everything, or that you will be judged poorly. In most cases, math anxiety is the fear of not doing the math right. The mind draws a blank, we expect to fail, and the more frustrated and anxious we become, the more likely we are to go blank again. The pressure of time limits on tests only makes the anxiety grow.

Math anxiety usually stems from unpleasant experiences with mathematics, often the result of poor teaching. Many anxious students show an over-reliance on procedures instead of real understanding. When someone memorizes rules and routines without understanding them, the math is quickly forgotten and panic sets in. A good example is the division of fractions: most people learned to 'invert and multiply' without ever seeing why it works. If math is only a list of memorized procedures, a good memory helps, but a weak memory leads to failure. Understanding is critical, and teachers and parents play an important role in ensuring it.

The article also lists several myths that are simply not true: that you are born with a math gene, that math is only for males, that it is hopeless for average people, that you need a strong logical side of the brain, that some cultures 'never get' math, and that there is only one right way to do math.

To overcome math anxiety, the author recommends keeping a positive attitude, asking questions, and refusing to settle for anything less than understanding. Students should practice regularly, take good notes, and hire a tutor or work with peers when total understanding escapes them. It is not enough to read over notes; you have to actually do the math. Finally, be persistent and do not overemphasize mistakes, because some of the most powerful learning stems from making them.

Key points

– Math anxiety is a form of fear similar to stage fright and test anxiety.
– It usually stems from poor teaching and memorizing procedures without understanding.
– Common beliefs such as a 'math gene' or math being only for males are myths.
– Ask questions, practice regularly, and get help from a tutor or peers.
– Mistakes are a powerful source of learning, so be persistent.

Glosario

– **stage fright** — miedo escénico; pánico a actuar o hablar frente al público
– **to draw a blank** — quedarse en blanco; no poder recordar nada en el momento
– **to stem from** — provenir de; tener su origen en
– **over-reliance** — dependencia excesiva; confiar demasiado en algo
– **to set in** — instalarse; empezar y afianzarse (dicho del pánico, el mal tiempo, etc.)
– **to settle for** — conformarse con; aceptar algo inferior a lo deseado
– **peer** — compañero; persona de la misma condición o nivel
– **to overemphasize** — dar demasiada importancia a; exagerar el peso de algo
– **persistent** — perseverante; que insiste sin rendirse
– **misconception** — idea equivocada; creencia errónea muy extendida

Comprehension 1. According to the article, where does math anxiety usually come from?

– A lack of a special math gene
– **Unpleasant experiences and memorizing procedures without understanding** [CORRECT]
– Being born into a culture that never learned math
– Having too many tutors during school

Comprehension 2. According to the article, what happens when people memorize rules without understanding them?

– **They quickly forget the math and panic sets in** [CORRECT]
– They become faster at solving problems on tests
– They develop a strong logical side of the brain
– They usually avoid making mistakes in class

Comprehension 3. In the sentence "The mind draws a blank," the expression "draws a blank" means that a person

– **cannot remember anything at that moment** [CORRECT]
– starts to solve a problem very carefully
– makes a drawing to understand the problem
– feels angry about a difficult question

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about the author's view of mistakes?

– **They can be a valuable part of learning math** [CORRECT]
– They show that a student lacks natural talent
– They should be avoided by practicing less
– They prove that some students should quit math

What Is a Bell Curve in Math and Science?

The term bell curve describes a mathematical concept called normal distribution, also known as Gaussian distribution. The name comes from the shape that appears when you plot the data points of an item that meets the criteria of normal distribution. The center of the curve holds the greatest number of values, so it is the highest point on the arc. This point is called the mean, and in simple terms it is the value that occurs most often, which statisticians call the mode.

The key feature of a normal distribution is that the curve is concentrated in the center and decreases on either side. Because of this, the data is less likely to produce unusually extreme values, called outliers, than other distributions. The curve is also symmetrical, so once you measure the deviation in the data, you can form reasonable expectations about whether an outcome will fall within a range to the left or right of the center. This deviation is expressed in standard deviations.

A bell curve graph depends on two factors: the mean and the standard deviation. The mean sets the position of the center, and the standard deviation determines the height and width of the bell. A large standard deviation creates a short, wide bell, while a small one creates a tall, narrow curve. The total area under the curve equals 1, or 100%. About 68% of the area falls within one standard deviation, about 95% within two, and about 99.7% within three. This is known as the empirical rule or the 68-95-99.7 rule.

A classic example is the roll of two dice. The distribution is centered around the number seven, the most likely outcome at 16.67%, and the probability decreases as you move away from the center. In physics and astronomy, random variations with unknown distributions are often assumed to be normal. This can be a dangerous assumption, but it is a good approximation thanks to the central limit theorem, which states that the mean of any set of variants with a finite mean and variance tends to occur in a normal distribution.

However, some data sets should not be forced to fit a bell curve. Student grades often have two modes, and income, population growth, and mechanical failures also fail to follow the bell-shaped pattern.

Key points

– A bell curve is the graph of a normal (Gaussian) distribution: symmetrical, concentrated in the center, and decreasing on both sides.
– The mean fixes the center of the curve; the standard deviation controls its height and width.
– The empirical rule: about 68%, 95%, and 99.7% of the data fall within one, two, and three standard deviations.
– The central limit theorem explains why many attributes, such as height or test scores, are roughly normal.
– Grades, income, population growth, and mechanical failures should not be forced into a bell curve.

Glosario

– **normal distribution** — distribución normal; distribución de probabilidad simétrica con forma de campana, también llamada gaussiana
– **mean** — media; promedio de un conjunto de datos, que en la curva normal coincide con el centro
– **mode** — moda (estadística); el valor que más veces se repite en un conjunto de datos
– **outlier** — valor atípico; dato extremo que se aleja mucho del resto
– **standard deviation** — desviación estándar; medida de cuánto se dispersan los datos respecto a la media
– **empirical rule** — regla empírica; la regla 68-95-99.7 sobre el área bajo la curva normal
– **approximation** — aproximación; valor o modelo cercano al real aunque no exacto

– **central limit theorem** — teorema del límite central; establece que la media de muchas variables tiende a distribuirse de forma normal
– **variance** — varianza; medida de dispersión, el cuadrado de la desviación estándar
– **to force (data) to fit** — forzar (los datos) a encajar; obligar algo a ajustarse a un modelo que no le corresponde

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, what happens to the shape of a bell curve when the standard deviation is large?

– The bell becomes tall and narrow.
– **The bell becomes short and wide.** [CORRECT]
– The center of the bell moves to the right.
– The total area under the curve increases.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what is the mode in a normal distribution?

– **The value that occurs most often, located at the center of the curve** [CORRECT]
– The distance between the mean and the outliers
– The total area under the curve, which equals 100%
– The number that shows how tall the bell is

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "outliers" refers to values that are

– exactly equal to the mean
– **unusually far from the center** [CORRECT]
– repeated more than any other value
– found within one standard deviation

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about using a bell curve to describe student grades?

– **It may give a misleading picture, because grades often have two modes.** [CORRECT]
– It is always the most accurate method available.
– It works best when the standard deviation is very small.
– It is useful only for predicting income and population growth.

Social

Status Quo Bias: What It Means and How It Affects Your Behavior

Status quo bias is the tendency to prefer that one's environment and situation remain as they already are. It has its strongest impact on decision-making: when we choose, we favor the familiar option over less familiar alternatives that might be more beneficial. The bias affects every kind of decision, from trivial choices such as which soda to buy to major ones such as selecting a health insurance plan.

The term was coined in 1988 by William Samuelson and Richard Zeckhauser. In one experiment, participants imagined inheriting a large sum of money and had to choose among fixed investment options. In the neutral version, no option was presented as the current one, and all choices were equally valid. In the status quo version, the money was already invested in a specific way, and one option retained that portfolio. Participants strongly preferred the status quo option, and the more choices they were given, the stronger that preference became.

Psychologists explain the bias through several principles, all of them considered irrational. Loss aversion means people weigh potential losses more heavily than potential gains, so they focus on what they could lose by abandoning the status quo. The sunk cost fallacy leads people to keep investing time, money, or effort in an endeavor simply because they have already invested in it. Cognitive dissonance, the discomfort caused by inconsistent thoughts, pushes people to stick with the current option rather than weigh alternatives. Finally, the mere exposure effect states that people prefer what they have been exposed to before, and by definition we are exposed to the status quo more than to anything else.

Keeping the status quo is not always irrational. When the transition cost of switching is greater than the gains, staying put is a rational choice. The bias becomes irrational only when someone ignores options that would improve their situation just to keep things the same.

Real-world examples are pervasive. Relocated German townspeople chose a layout similar to their old town even though it was inefficient. Consumers rejected New Coke despite preferring it in blind taste tests. Incumbent candidates are more likely to win than challengers, and in a retirement plan only a tiny share of participants changed their investment distribution each year, often without being able to justify it.

Key points

– Status quo bias is the preference for keeping things as they are, even when a change might be better.
– Samuelson and Zeckhauser named the bias in 1988; more options make the preference for the status quo stronger.
– Loss aversion, the sunk cost fallacy, cognitive dissonance, and the mere exposure effect all help explain the bias.
– Keeping the status quo is rational when switching costs exceed the gains, and irrational when better options are ignored.
– Examples include the New Coke failure, the incumbent advantage in elections, and unchanged retirement plans.

Glosario

– **status quo** — estado actual de las cosas; situación vigente que se tiende a mantener
– **trivial** — trivial; sin importancia, de poca trascendencia
– **coin (a term)** — acuñar (un término); inventar y usar por primera vez una palabra o expresión
– **inherit** — heredar; recibir bienes o dinero de alguien que fallece
– **portfolio** — cartera de inversiones; conjunto de activos financieros de una persona
– **loss aversion** — aversión a la pérdida; tendencia a temer más lo que se pierde que a valorar lo que se gana
– **sunk cost fallacy** — falacia del costo hundido; seguir invirtiendo en algo solo porque ya se invirtió antes

– **endeavor** — empresa, proyecto; esfuerzo sostenido hacia un objetivo
– **stay put** — quedarse donde uno está; no moverse ni cambiar de situación
– **pervasive** — omnipresente; que se extiende y aparece por todas partes
– **incumbent** — titular del cargo; quien ocupa actualmente un puesto y busca la reelección

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, when is it rational to keep the status quo?

– When there are many options to choose from
– **When the cost of switching is greater than the gains from changing** [CORRECT]
– When a person has already invested a lot of money in it
– When the familiar option has been chosen many times before

Comprehension 2. In the Samuelson and Zeckhauser experiment, what happened as participants were given more options to choose from?

– **Their preference for the status quo option became stronger** [CORRECT]
– They were more likely to choose the most profitable portfolio
– Their preference for the status quo option became weaker
– They spent more time comparing every alternative carefully

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "pervasive" in the sentence "Real-world examples are pervasive" is closest in meaning to

– **widespread** [CORRECT]
– misleading
– uncommon
– controversial

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about the consumers who rejected New Coke?

– **Their choice was influenced by attachment to the familiar product** [CORRECT]
– They could not taste any difference between the two drinks
– They rejected it because it was more expensive than the old one
– They had never tried the original product before

What "Introvert" and "Extrovert" Really Mean

Imagine your ideal evening. Would you rather go out for dinner with a large group of friends, or spend the night with one close friend and a good book? Psychologists use answers to questions like these to measure introversion and extroversion: personality traits that describe how we prefer to interact with other people.

Today many psychologists place these traits within the five-factor model of personality. According to this theory, a personality can be described by five traits: extroversion (introversion is its opposite), agreeableness (altruism and concern for others), conscientiousness (how organized and responsible someone is), neuroticism (how often someone experiences negative emotions), and openness to experience (imagination and curiosity). Each trait ranges along a spectrum. Extroverts tend to be social, talkative, assertive, and likely to seek out excitement. Introverts tend to be quieter and more reserved. However, shyness is not the same as introversion, and introverts are not antisocial. As the author Susan Cain puts it, they are "differently social": she loves her family and close friends, but she also craves solitude.

In 2011, psychologists at Wellesley College proposed four kinds of introverts. Social introverts enjoy time alone or in small groups. Thinking introverts are introspective and thoughtful. Anxious introverts tend to be shy, sensitive, and self-conscious in social situations. Inhibited or restrained introverts do not seek excitement and prefer relaxed activities.

Is one type better? Research shows that extroverts do experience positive emotions somewhat more often on average. Yet there are also "happy introverts": in one study, about one-third of the happy participants were introverts. Cain points out that American society often treats extroversion as a good thing, for example by encouraging group work in classrooms and offices. In doing so, it neglects what introverts can contribute. Introversion may be linked to creativity, and introverts can be good managers because they give employees freedom and focus on the organization's goals rather than their own success.

In short, neither way of relating to others is better than the other. Each has its own advantages, and understanding our traits helps us study and work with others more effectively.

Key points

– Introversion and extroversion describe how we prefer to interact with others, not whether we are shy or antisocial.
– The five-factor model measures personality on five traits, each ranging along a spectrum.
– A 2011 study proposed four types of introverts: social, thinking, anxious, and inhibited/restrained.
– Extroverts report positive emotions slightly more often, but about one-third of happy people in one study were introverts.
– Neither trait is better; each has its own advantages.

Glosario

– **agreeableness** — amabilidad; en psicología, rasgo de altruismo y preocupación por los demás
– **conscientiousness** — responsabilidad; escrupulosidad; grado de organización y sentido del deber
– **neuroticism** — neuroticismo; tendencia a experimentar emociones negativas
– **assertive** — asertivo; seguro y firme al expresarse, sin ser agresivo
– **to seek out** — buscar activamente; ir tras algo (phrasal verb)
– **reserved** — reservado; discreto, poco expresivo en el trato social

– **to crave** — ansiar; desear con intensidad
– **solitude** — soledad (buscada, no impuesta); tiempo a solas
– **self-conscious** — cohibido; incómodo por sentirse observado (no significa «consciente de sí mismo»)
– **to neglect** — descuidar; pasar por alto; desatender

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, why can introverts make good managers?

– They are more talkative and assertive in meetings.
– **They give employees freedom and focus on the organization's goals.** [CORRECT]
– They seek out excitement and encourage group work.
– They experience positive emotions more often than extroverts.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what did the 2011 study at Wellesley College propose?

– **That introverts can be divided into four different kinds.** [CORRECT]
– That extroverts feel positive emotions much more than introverts.
– That shyness and introversion are exactly the same trait.
– That introversion is the opposite of all five personality traits.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "craves" in the sentence "she also craves solitude" is closest in meaning to

– **strongly wants** [CORRECT]
– carefully avoids
– slowly accepts
– rarely notices

Comprehension 4. Which conclusion can be drawn from the passage about schools and offices that encourage group work?

– **They may fail to make use of what introverts can offer.** [CORRECT]
– They usually have more creative employees than other places.
– They help introverts become extroverts over time.
– They make all people equally happy at work.

Tech

The 7 Best Programming Languages to Learn for Beginners

Learning how to code opens up many possibilities, from new job opportunities to developing your own applications. However, with so many programming languages available, deciding where to start can be intimidating. The article ranks seven languages for beginners, starting with the easiest and working toward the more challenging ones.

Ruby comes first because its syntax closely resembles spoken English. It is a dynamically typed language, which means that variable types are checked at run-time rather than at compile-time, so it is forgiving for new programmers. Combined with the Rails framework, it powers many database-driven websites, although its performance is less impressive and there are concerns about scalability. Python is another general-purpose language recommended for beginners: you can script basic functionality on your first day. It runs on the backend of Instagram and YouTube, is heavily used by data scientists, and can even build video games with the PyGame library. Its flexibility, however, should not lead to sloppy coding practices.

HTML and CSS are not interchangeable, but they are usually learned together because both are key to web page design. HTML is a markup language that uses tags to define elements, while CSS controls the page layout. HTML5 has also become popular for creating mobile apps. JavaScript, still the world's most popular language, manipulates the output of HTML and CSS and is responsible for on-the-fly updates, interactive features, and animation. It is notably harder to learn, so the author recommends it only once you are comfortable with HTML and CSS.

Java, an object-oriented language, follows the slogan 'write once, run anywhere' and is the main language of Android. It is not as easy, but the web contains a treasure trove of free resources, so you are never alone when you get stuck. Swift was created by Apple for its own platforms as an improvement on Objective-C; its benchmarks are impressive and the Swift Playgrounds app makes learning enjoyable. Finally, R is a free, open-source environment for statistical computing, a favorite for analyzing large data sets in the fast-growing field of big data. Its learning curve may be steep if you are not mathematically inclined. The list is not all-inclusive: your situation may call for C++ or PHP instead.

Key points

– The seven languages are ordered from easiest (Ruby) to most challenging (R).
– Ruby and Python are dynamically typed and forgiving, which makes them ideal starting points.
– HTML and CSS should be learned before JavaScript, which is notably more difficult.
– Java is the main language for Android, while Swift is Apple's language for iOS and macOS.
– R targets statistical computing and big data, but its learning curve can be steep.

Glosario

– **intimidating** — intimidante; que impone o asusta por su dificultad o magnitud
– **dynamically typed** — de tipado dinámico; los tipos de las variables se verifican al ejecutar, no al compilar
– **run-time / compile-time** — tiempo de ejecución / tiempo de compilación; momentos en que se comprueba el código
– **forgiving** — tolerante; indulgente, que perdona errores (aquí, un lenguaje que no castiga los descuidos del principiante)
– **scalability** — escalabilidad; capacidad de crecer hacia sistemas más grandes y complejos sin perder rendimiento

– **sloppy** — descuidado; chapucero, hecho sin rigor (sloppy coding practices = malos hábitos de programación)
– **markup language** — lenguaje de marcado; usa etiquetas (tags) para definir elementos de un documento, no para dar instrucciones lógicas
– **on-the-fly** — al vuelo; sobre la marcha, en tiempo real sin recargar la página
– **treasure trove** — mina de oro; tesoro escondido, fuente abundante de recursos valiosos
– **mathematically inclined** — con inclinación por las matemáticas; con aptitud o gusto natural por los números

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, why is Ruby considered a forgiving language for new programmers?

– **Its variable types are checked at run-time instead of compile-time.** [CORRECT]
– It runs faster than most other popular programming languages.
– It was created by Apple to replace Objective-C.
– It does not require any knowledge of mathematics.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, which language is the main language used for developing Android apps?

– **Java** [CORRECT]
– Swift
– Python
– Ruby

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the phrase "a treasure trove of free resources" means that the web offers

– **a large and valuable amount of free learning material** [CORRECT]
– a small number of expensive programming courses
– a hidden collection of secret programming languages
– a set of tools that only experts can use

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about learning JavaScript?

– **It is easier to learn after gaining experience with HTML and CSS.** [CORRECT]
– It is the best first language for every beginner.
– It is no longer popular among web developers.
– It has replaced HTML and CSS in web design.

What Is Responsive Web Design?

Millions of devices are used worldwide, from phones and tablets to large desktop computers, and users expect to view the same websites on any of them seamlessly. Responsive web design is an approach that ensures a website can be viewed on all screen sizes, regardless of the device. In other words, the website responds to the device and renders its content accordingly: on a mobile phone, for example, the content is resized into a single column.

Although terms such as fluid and flexible were thrown around as early as 2004, the term responsive web design was coined in 2010 by Ethan Marcotte. He believed that websites should be designed for the "ebb and flow of things" rather than remaining static. After he published his article, the term took off and inspired web developers across the globe.

Responsive websites are built to adjust and resize at specific browser widths known as breakpoints. Each breakpoint has a CSS media query that changes the layout once the browser is within a certain range. Put simply, when the width of the browser changes, the code in the background responds and modifies the layout automatically.

Thanks to this flexibility, responsive design is now the gold standard for any website. It offers a seamless on-site experience on every device, and it shows mobile users the most important content first instead of a small snippet. It also makes indexing easier for Google, which improves search engine rank because Google favors mobile-first websites. In the past, developers had to build completely different sites for desktop and mobile; now they update one site, which saves critical amounts of time. Responsive design is also proven to increase conversion rates and to keep page speed equally fast on all devices.

Online shopping illustrates this in the real world. A user may search for a product on a desktop during a lunch break, read reviews on a tablet at home in the evening, and make the final purchase on a mobile phone before turning off the light. Other scenarios, such as planning travel, looking for a new home or looking up recipes, also span a wide range of devices over time, which underlines the importance of a responsive website.

Key points

– Responsive web design lets a website adapt its layout to any screen size or device.
– Ethan Marcotte coined the term in 2010, although words like fluid and flexible were used from 2004.
– Sites change layout at breakpoints, which are browser widths controlled by CSS media queries.
– Benefits include a better user experience, easier Google indexing, higher conversion rates and time saved for developers.
– Everyday tasks such as online shopping often span desktop, tablet and mobile, so responsiveness is essential.

Glosario

– **seamlessly** — sin interrupciones; de forma fluida, sin que se note la transición
– **render** — representar en pantalla; mostrar el contenido tal como el navegador lo dibuja
– **to coin (a term)** — acuñar (un término); inventar y usar por primera vez una palabra o expresión
– **ebb and flow** — flujo y reflujo; vaivén, cambio constante como el de la marea
– **take off** — despegar; hacerse popular o tener éxito de repente (phrasal verb)
– **breakpoint** — punto de quiebre; ancho de navegador en el que el diseño cambia de distribución
– **media query** — consulta de medios; regla CSS que aplica estilos según el tamaño o tipo de pantalla
– **gold standard** — referencia de máxima calidad; el modelo con el que se compara todo lo demás

– **snippet** — fragmento; pequeño trozo de texto o contenido

– **conversion rate** — tasa de conversión; porcentaje de visitantes que terminan comprando o realizando la acción deseada

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, what is a breakpoint?

– **A browser width at which a CSS media query changes the page layout** [CORRECT]
– An error that stops a website from loading on mobile devices
– A separate website created for each type of device
– A tool Google uses to index mobile-first pages

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, who introduced the term "responsive web design" in 2010?

– **Ethan Marcotte, who published an article about it** [CORRECT]
– A group of developers working for Google
– The engineers who created CSS media queries
– Web designers who used the terms fluid and flexible

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the phrase "the gold standard" in "responsive design is now the gold standard for any website" most nearly means:

– the most expensive option available
– **the best and most widely accepted model** [CORRECT]
– a rule that only large companies follow
– an old method that is rarely used today

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the online shopping example in the passage?

– **Shoppers often use several different devices before buying a product** [CORRECT]
– Most people prefer to buy products on desktop computers
– Tablets are better than phones for reading reviews
– Websites should be designed only for mobile phones

6 Best Learn-to-Code Resources Online

Learning to code can be useful whether you want to build your own website or make yourself more attractive to potential employers. There is no shortage of options for getting your feet wet in programming, but finding a good entry point can be daunting. The first decision is which language to learn, and the article suggests a simple way to narrow it down: ask yourself what you want to build. Programming languages, like words in English, are a means to an end. If you want a website, HTML, CSS and JavaScript matter. If you want a smartphone app, you must first choose a platform, Android or iOS, and then pick a corresponding language such as Java or Objective-C. A flowchart by Carl Cheo and patient research on Google can also help.

The article then reviews six online resources. Codecademy offers free, fun lessons in basic languages such as HTML and CSS, JavaScript, Python, Ruby, PHP and SQL. Code Avengers adds mini-games after each lesson and focuses on basic concepts rather than the nuts and bolts of a language; it also offers courses in Spanish, Dutch, Portuguese and Russian. Khan Academy suits newbies who already know what they want to build, especially graphics, gaming, drawings and animations, using JavaScript and SQL.

Code School is less beginner-oriented and has a more professional bent, so it is better to arrive after you have a few skills under your belt. It covers mobile languages such as Objective-C and Swift, though full access costs money. Coursera works for self-motivated learners willing to do some digging, because it hosts material on a huge variety of subjects beyond programming. Treehouse requires a paid subscription and is aimed at people who plan to stick with programming professionally or for side projects; its courses are built around objectives, such as building a website.

Finally, for children, the article recommends Blockly, Scratch and Swift Playgrounds, which introduce programming concepts through visuals in engaging, easy-to-follow ways.

Key points

– Before choosing a language, ask yourself what you want to build.
– Websites need HTML, CSS and JavaScript; mobile apps depend on the platform (Android or iOS).
– Codecademy, Code Avengers and Khan Academy are the most beginner-friendly options.
– Code School and Treehouse have a professional focus and require payment for full access.
– Blockly, Scratch and Swift Playgrounds are designed for children.

Glosario

– **to get your feet wet** — iniciarse en algo; dar los primeros pasos en una actividad nueva
– **daunting** — intimidante; abrumador, que desanima por su dificultad
– **entry point** — punto de entrada; lugar por donde empezar
– **a means to an end** — un medio para un fin; algo útil solo por lo que permite lograr
– **to narrow down** — reducir las opciones; acotar hasta llegar a una elección
– **the nuts and bolts** — los detalles prácticos; el funcionamiento concreto de algo
– **newbie** — novato; principiante (coloquial)
– **under your belt** — ya adquirido; en tu haber (experiencia o logros)
– **bent** — inclinación; orientación o tendencia (a professional bent = enfoque profesional)
– **to stick with** — seguir con algo; no abandonar una actividad

Comprehension 1. According to the passage, which resource is recommended for someone who already has some skills and wants to become a programmer by trade?

– Code Avengers
– Khan Academy
– **Code School** [CORRECT]
– Scratch

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what does Code Avengers add after each lesson?

– A short written exam
– **Mini-games** [CORRECT]
– A video tutorial
– A monthly subscription

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the expression "getting your feet wet" in programming most nearly means

– making a serious mistake at the start
– **starting to try something for the first time** [CORRECT]
– paying for a professional course
– working on a project for a long time

Comprehension 4. Which of the following can be inferred about Coursera from the passage?

– It is a good choice for people who prefer clear step-by-step guidance
– It is designed only for children who are new to coding
– **It requires learners to take the initiative to find what they need** [CORRECT]
– It teaches only the languages used for smartphone apps

C (programming language)

C is a general-purpose programming language created by Dennis Ritchie at Bell Labs between 1972 and 1973. It began as a successor to the B language, and its first purpose was to build utilities for Unix. Soon after, it was used to re-implement the Unix kernel, which had originally been written in assembly language. In 1973, Version 4 Unix was released with its kernel largely rewritten in C, making Unix one of the first kernels not written in assembly.

By design, C gives programmers fairly direct access to memory and to the features of a typical CPU. That is why it is still used for operating system kernels, device drivers, protocol stacks, and embedded systems, from microcontrollers to supercomputers. Yet the language was also meant to be portable: a standards-compliant program can be compiled for many platforms with few changes to its source code.

C is an imperative, procedural language with a static but weakly enforced type system. All executable code lives inside functions, statements end with semicolons, and blocks are grouped with curly braces. Parameters are passed by value, so passing by reference is done with pointers. Pointers let a program read and modify memory directly, and function pointers make run-time polymorphism possible. C has no dedicated string type; strings are arrays of characters ending in a null character. Complex features such as input/output or string handling are not in the core language but in the standard library. A preprocessor handles macros, file inclusion, and conditional compilation.

For example, in the classic "Hello, world" program, the line #include <stdio.h> tells the preprocessor to insert a header file that declares the printf function. Execution begins in the function main, and printf writes the text to the standard output. The sequence \n is an escape sequence that moves the cursor to the next line.

The language was standardized step by step. The book The C Programming Language (1978), by Kernighan and Ritchie, served for years as an informal specification. ANSI ratified the first official standard in 1989, and ISO adopted it in 1990. Later revisions followed: C99 added inline functions and // comments, C11 added multi-threading and atomic operations, C17 only fixed defects, and C23 was published in October 2024. One trap remains: writing = (assignment) instead of == (equality) in a condition often produces no error message.

Key points

– C was created by Dennis Ritchie in 1972 and was used to rewrite the Unix kernel.
– It offers low-level access to memory through pointers, yet it can be portable across platforms.
– Complex features live in the standard library, not in the core language.
– The language has been standardized since 1989 (C89, C99, C11, C17, C23).
– Confusing = with == is a common mistake that often produces no error.

Glosario

– **kernel** — núcleo (del sistema operativo); la parte central que controla el hardware y los recursos
– **device driver** — controlador de dispositivo; programa que permite al sistema operativo comunicarse con un componente de hardware
– **embedded system** — sistema embebido o empotrado; computador dedicado dentro de otro aparato
– **portability** — portabilidad; capacidad de un programa de funcionar en distintas plataformas
– **pass by value** — paso por valor; la función recibe una copia del dato, no el original
– **pointer** — puntero; variable que guarda una dirección de memoria

– **preprocessor** — preprocesador; herramienta que transforma el código antes de compilarlo

– **header file** — archivo de cabecera; contiene declaraciones de funciones que se incluyen en otros archivos

– **ratify** — ratificar; aprobar oficialmente una norma o acuerdo

– **escape sequence** — secuencia de escape; combinación de caracteres, como \n, que representa un carácter especial

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the summary?

– **C is a portable language that gives direct access to hardware and has been standardized over time.** [CORRECT]

– C is a modern language designed mainly for building websites and mobile applications.

– C is a language created to replace Unix with a simpler operating system.

– C is a language whose standards have never changed since the year 1978.

Comprehension 2. According to the summary, what happened in 1973 with Version 4 Unix?

– **Its kernel was largely rewritten in C.** [CORRECT]

– It was ported to a new PDP-7 computer.

– It was replaced by the B language.

– It was adopted as an ISO standard.

Comprehension 3. In the summary, the word "ratified" in "ANSI ratified the first official standard in 1989" is closest in meaning to:

– **officially approved** [CORRECT]

– strongly criticized

– quickly replaced

– carefully translated

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about a programmer who writes if (a = b + 1) instead of if (a == b + 1)?

– **The program may behave incorrectly without showing any error.** [CORRECT]

– The program will always refuse to compile.

– The program will run faster than expected.

– The program will delete the variable a.

C++

C++ is a high-level, general-purpose programming language created by the Danish computer scientist Bjarne Stroustrup. He began work in 1979 at Bell Labs on "C with Classes", an extension of C, because he wanted a language that was as efficient and flexible as C but also offered high-level features for organizing programs. The name C++ was suggested by Rick Mascitti in 1983 and refers to C's ++ operator, which increments the value of a variable. The first edition of The C++ Programming Language appeared in 1985 and served as the definitive reference until an official standard existed.

C++ supports low-level memory manipulation as well as object-oriented, generic and functional programming. Its design rests on two ideas: a direct mapping of hardware features, inherited mostly from C, and zero-overhead abstractions built on top of them. Stroustrup argues that offering both hardware access and abstraction is the basis of C++, and that doing it efficiently is what distinguishes it from other languages. One guiding principle is that unused features should not slow down the finished program. Because of this, C++ is common in operating systems, video games, servers and performance-critical systems such as telephone switches and space probes.

The language is standardized by the International Organization for Standardization (ISO). The first standard, C++98, was published in 1998 and was followed by C++03, C++11, C++14, C++17, C++20 and C++23. Since 2012, a new version has been released every three years. The standard covers both the core language and the standard library, which includes containers, algorithms, strings and input/output. An important influence on the library was the Standard Template Library, proposed in 1994.

C++ is often called a superset of C, but this is not strictly true. Most C code compiles in C++, yet some valid C code is invalid or behaves differently. For example, C allows implicit conversion from void* to other pointer types, while C++ does not, for reasons of type safety. To mix both languages, a function must be declared with C linkage using an extern "C" block. The standards committee also left name mangling and exception handling to each compiler vendor, so object code from different compilers is usually incompatible.

C++ has a weakness: it allows manual memory management, so a programmer can inadvertently introduce bugs such as buffer overflow, which are security risks. In March 2025, Stroustrup called on the language community to defend the language. Initiatives such as the C++ Core Guidelines, led by Stroustrup and Herb Sutter, try to help programmers write safer code by following best practices.

Key points

– C++ was created by Bjarne Stroustrup as an extension of C, adding classes and other high-level features.

– It combines direct hardware access with zero-overhead abstractions, so unused features do not reduce performance.

– ISO standardizes the language, and a new version has appeared every three years since 2012.

– C++ is not strictly a superset of C: some valid C code fails or behaves differently in C++.

– Manual memory management can cause security bugs such as buffer overflow.

Glosario

– **extension** — extensión; en programación, lenguaje o función que amplía otro ya existente

– **increment** — incrementar; aumentar el valor de una variable, normalmente de uno en uno

– **zero-overhead abstraction** — abstracción sin sobrecoste; función de alto nivel que no consume recursos extra al ejecutarse

– **performance-critical** — crítico para el rendimiento; sistemas donde la velocidad es esencial
– **ratify** — ratificar; aprobar oficialmente una norma o acuerdo
– **superset** — superconjunto; algo que contiene todo lo de otro y además elementos propios
– **implicit conversion** — conversión implícita; cambio de tipo de dato hecho automáticamente, sin que el programador lo pida
– **name mangling** — decoración de nombres; técnica del compilador que modifica los nombres de funciones para distinguirlas
– **buffer overflow** — desbordamiento de búfer; error al escribir más datos de los que caben en la memoria reservada
– **inadvertently** — sin darse cuenta; por descuido, de forma no intencionada

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **C++ is a language derived from C that combines hardware access with high-level abstractions and is governed by international standards.** [CORRECT]
– C++ is a language designed mainly for building video games and web pages with simple, safe code.
– C++ replaced the C language completely and can run all C programs without any change.
– C++ is a language whose main purpose is to teach programmers how to manage memory automatically.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, how often has a new version of C++ been released since 2012?

– Every year
– Every two years
– **Every three years** [CORRECT]
– Every five years

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "inadvertently" in "a programmer can inadvertently introduce bugs" most nearly means:

– **without noticing the mistake** [CORRECT]
– on purpose
– with great skill
– after long testing

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the passage about the C++ Core Guidelines?

– **They aim to reduce the risks that come from the freedom C++ gives programmers.** [CORRECT]
– They are a mandatory part of every ISO standard of the language.
– They were created to replace the standard library completely.
– They only apply to programs written before 2011.

Pointer (computer programming)

In computer science, a pointer is an object that stores a memory address. That address may belong to another value in memory or, in some cases, to memory-mapped hardware. Obtaining the value stored at that location is called dereferencing the pointer. A useful analogy is a page number in a book's index: flipping to that page and reading it is the equivalent of dereferencing.

Pointers are a very thin abstraction on top of the addressing capabilities of modern architectures. Each unit of memory has a numeric address, so memory works like one very large array. Pointers improve performance in repetitive operations, such as traversing strings, lookup tables, linked lists and trees, because copying a pointer is much cheaper than copying the data it points to. They are also used to pass parameters by reference, to return several values from a function, and to hold the entry points of subroutines.

In C, a pointer is declared with an asterisk, for example int *ptr. The & operator retrieves a variable's address, and the asterisk dereferences the pointer. Suppose a is at address 0x8130 and ptr holds that address. Writing *ptr = 8 makes the computer read the address stored in ptr and put 8 in that location, so a now equals 8. Array indexing is defined through pointer arithmetic: a[i] is equivalent to *(a + i). Adding 1 to a pointer moves it by the size of the type, so on a machine with 4-byte integers, a + 1 advances 4 bytes.

Pointers also allow dynamic memory allocation. The function malloc() reserves a block on the heap and returns a pointer to it, or a null pointer if the allocation fails, and free() returns the block. If a program forgets to free memory it no longer needs, a memory leak occurs. On some microcontrollers, a pointer can be set to a fixed hexadecimal address to control memory-mapped devices directly.

Pointers carry risks. An uninitialized wild pointer may point to an invalid address and cause a segmentation fault. A dangling pointer refers to memory that has already been deallocated and may have been overwritten by unrelated code. Dereferencing a null pointer produces undefined behavior. To reduce these hazards, languages such as Java use opaque references that cannot be manipulated as numbers, garbage collection frees memory automatically, and C++ offers smart pointers based on reference counting. Rust uses a borrow checker to eliminate pointer bugs without garbage collection.

Key points

– A pointer stores a memory address, and dereferencing it gives access to the value at that address.
– In C, a[i] is equivalent to *(a + i), and pointer arithmetic takes the size of the type into account.
– malloc() allocates memory on the heap and free() releases it; forgetting to free causes a memory leak.
– Wild, dangling and null pointers can cause crashes or undefined behavior.
– Smart pointers, garbage collection and Rust's borrow checker make pointers safer.

Glosario

– **dereferencing** — desreferenciar; acceder al valor almacenado en la dirección a la que apunta el puntero
– **traversing** — recorrer; pasar por cada elemento de una estructura de datos
– **memory leak** — fuga de memoria; memoria reservada que nunca se libera y se va agotando
– **dangling pointer** — puntero colgante; apunta a memoria ya liberada
– **wild pointer** — puntero salvaje; nunca fue inicializado y apunta a una dirección arbitraria
– **segmentation fault** — fallo de segmentación; error por acceder a una dirección de memoria no permitida

– **undefined behavior** — comportamiento indefinido; resultado impredecible que el estándar no especifica
– **opaque** — opaco; cuyo contenido interno no se puede ver ni manipular
– **pitfalls** — trampas, peligros ocultos; errores típicos en los que se cae fácilmente
– **garbage collection** — recolección de basura; liberación automática de memoria que ya no se usa

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the text?

– **A pointer stores a memory address, which is useful but carries risks that languages try to reduce** [CORRECT]
– Pointers are obsolete and have been replaced in all modern programming languages
– Pointers are used only to control microcontrollers and video hardware
– A pointer is a type of number that cannot be used to access data

Comprehension 2. According to the text, what does the function malloc() return if the allocation fails?

– **A null pointer** [CORRECT]
– A dangling pointer
– The address 0x8130
– A block of zero size

Comprehension 3. In the text, the word "dangling" in "dangling pointer" most nearly means:

– **Left pointing to something that no longer exists** [CORRECT]
– Moving quickly between addresses
– Pointing to two locations at once
– Protected against errors

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about languages like Java that use opaque references?

– **They prevent some pointer errors because references cannot be treated as numbers** [CORRECT]
– They are slower than C because they cannot use memory
– They do not need any memory management
– They allow programmers to add values to addresses freely

Compiler

A compiler is software that translates code written in one programming language, the source language, into another, the target language. The term usually refers to programs that turn a high-level language into a low-level one, such as assembly or machine code, to create an executable program. There are many kinds: a cross-compiler produces code for a different CPU or operating system than the one it runs on, and a bootstrap compiler is a temporary tool used to build a better, more permanent compiler.

An interpreter does a similar job by a different mechanism: it executes code without converting it to machine code, or it runs an intermediate form such as bytecode. Code compiled to native form generally runs faster than interpreted code, while just-in-time compilation offers native speed at the cost of a one-time startup delay. Low-level languages like C are typically compiled, especially when speed matters, because their source maps closely to machine code and gives programmers more control over hardware.

Compilers began in the 1950s. Grace Hopper's team wrote the A-0 compiler in 1952 and coined the term, and John Backus's team at IBM completed the FORTRAN compiler in 1957. Early computers had so little memory that the work had to be split into several small programs, which led to the idea of separate front end and back end stages. Later, Bell Labs developed B and then C, and the Unix kernel was rewritten in C by 1973.

Modern compilers are usually organized in three stages. The front end reads the source, checks syntax and semantics, reports errors, and builds an intermediate representation (IR). To do this it performs lexical analysis, which breaks the text into tokens, then parsing, which builds a tree according to the grammar, and finally semantic analysis, which checks things like types and fills the symbol table.

The middle end optimizes the IR independently of the CPU. Typical optimizations include dead-code elimination, constant propagation and moving computation out of a loop. The back end then generates code for a specific processor, performing register allocation and instruction scheduling. This design lets tools such as GCC and Clang combine several languages with several processors while sharing the same optimizations.

Key points

– A compiler translates high-level source code into a lower-level target such as machine code.
– Compiled code usually runs faster than interpreted code; just-in-time compilation is a compromise.
– Compilers work in phases: front end, middle end and back end.
– The front end analyzes the code with lexing, parsing and semantic analysis, and produces an intermediate representation.
– Optimizations in the middle end are shared across languages and processors.

Glosario

– **cross-compiler** — compilador cruzado; genera código para una CPU o sistema distinto de aquel donde se ejecuta
– **bytecode** — código intermedio, ni fuente ni máquina; lo ejecuta una máquina virtual
– **just-in-time compilation** — compilación justo a tiempo; se compila mientras el programa se ejecuta
– **coin (a term)** — acuñar (un término); inventar y difundir una palabra nueva
– **token** — unidad léxica mínima del código, como una palabra clave o un operador
– **parsing** — análisis sintáctico; construir la estructura del programa a partir de los tokens
– **symbol table** — tabla de símbolos; estructura que guarda el tipo y el alcance de cada identificador
– **dead-code elimination** — eliminación de código muerto; quitar instrucciones que nunca afectan al resultado

– **register allocation** — asignación de registros; decidir qué valores viven en los registros de la CPU
– **instruction scheduling** — planificación de instrucciones; reordenarlas para aprovechar la ejecución en paralelo

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **A compiler translates source code into another language and works through organized stages.** [CORRECT]
– Interpreters have replaced compilers in most modern programming projects.
– Grace Hopper invented every important programming language of the 1950s.
– Compilers can only produce code for the computer on which they run.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, why were early compilers divided into several small programs?

– **Early computers did not have enough memory to hold one large program.** [CORRECT]
– Programmers preferred to write assembly language by hand.
– Bell Labs required each phase to be written by a different team.
– Interpreters could not run the larger programs at that time.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the phrase "coined the term" means that Grace Hopper's team

– **invented and introduced the word "compiler".** [CORRECT]
– copied the word from an older manual.
– translated the word into another language.
– forbade the use of other names.

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred from the three-stage structure of compilers like GCC?

– **Adding support for a new processor does not require rewriting the front end.** [CORRECT]
– Each language needs its own completely separate compiler.
– Optimizations must be rewritten for every new language.
– The front end must know the details of every CPU.

Finite-state machine

A finite-state machine (FSM) is a mathematical model of computation. It is an abstract machine that can be in exactly one of a finite number of states at any given time. It changes from one state to another in response to inputs, and each change is called a transition. An FSM is defined by its list of states, its initial state, and the inputs that trigger each transition. Because its memory is limited by the number of states, it has less computational power than a Turing machine.

Many everyday devices behave like state machines. A vending machine dispenses a product when the right coins are deposited, an elevator decides its stops from the floors requested, and a combination lock requires numbers in the proper order. A coin-operated turnstile is the classic example. It has two states, Locked and Unlocked, and two inputs, coin and push. In the Locked state, pushing has no effect; inserting a coin moves it to Unlocked. In the Unlocked state, extra coins change nothing; a push lets one customer through and resets the state to Locked.

A machine can be shown in a state-transition table or in a state diagram. In the diagram, each state is a node, each arrow is a transition labeled with its input, and a circular arrow marks an input that causes no change. Some models also attach an entry action, performed when entering a state, or an exit action, performed when leaving it.

FSMs are classified by what they do. Acceptors give a binary answer: after reading all the input, they accept it if they end in an accepting state and reject it otherwise. The sets of sequences they accept are called regular languages. Transducers produce output. In a Moore machine the output depends only on the current state, which simplifies behavior. In a Mealy machine the output depends on both state and input, which often reduces the number of states.

A machine is deterministic if every state has exactly one transition for each possible input. In a non-deterministic machine, an input may lead to one, several, or no transitions. Any non-deterministic machine can be converted into an equivalent deterministic one, although the result is usually more complex. In practice, FSMs are built with logic gates, flip-flops, or relays, and with a register that stores the current state. They are also used in compilers, where a lexical analyzer turns characters into tokens for the parser.

Key points

– An FSM is in exactly one of a finite number of states and moves between them through transitions triggered by inputs.
– A turnstile is a simple example: Locked and Unlocked states, with coin and push inputs.
– In a Moore machine the output depends only on the state; in a Mealy machine it depends on state and input.
– Acceptors accept or reject an input sequence, and the languages they accept are called regular languages.
– Every non-deterministic FSM has an equivalent deterministic one.

Glosario

– **transition** — transición; el paso de un estado a otro al recibir una entrada
– **turnstile** — torniquete; puerta giratoria que deja pasar a una persona a la vez
– **acceptor** — aceptor; máquina que acepta o rechaza una secuencia de entrada
– **transducer** — transductor; máquina de estados que produce una salida a partir de la entrada
– **deterministic** — determinista; con un único resultado posible para cada entrada
– **dispense** — dispensar, repartir; se usa para máquinas expendedoras
– **flip-flop** — biestable; circuito electrónico que almacena un bit de información

– **lexical analyzer** — analizador léxico; parte del compilador que convierte caracteres en tokens
– **reject** — rechazar; en un aceptor, no aceptar una entrada

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **A finite-state machine is a model that moves between a limited number of states in response to inputs.** [CORRECT]
– A finite-state machine is a physical device used mainly in subways and vending machines.
– A finite-state machine is more powerful than a Turing machine because it has more states.
– A finite-state machine is a programming language used to write compilers.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what happens when a coin is inserted while the turnstile is in the Unlocked state?

– **The state does not change.** [CORRECT]
– The turnstile goes back to Locked.
– The turnstile rejects the coin and reports an error.
– The turnstile allows two customers through.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "dispense" in "a vending machine dispenses a product" most nearly means:

– **to give out** [CORRECT]
– to keep back
– to pay for
– to test

Comprehension 4. Which conclusion can be drawn from the passage about Mealy machines?

– **They can sometimes perform the same job as a Moore machine with fewer states.** [CORRECT]
– They always need more states than a Moore machine.
– They cannot produce any output.
– They can only be built with relays.

UML state machine

A UML state machine, formerly called a UML statechart, extends the mathematical idea of a finite automaton. It organizes how a device or program works so that it is always in exactly one of several possible states, with well-defined conditional transitions between them. It is an object-based variant of the Harel statechart, and it combines features of Mealy machines (actions that depend on both state and triggering event) and Moore machines (entry and exit actions tied to states).

Many software systems are event-driven: they wait for an event, such as a key press or a data packet, react to it, and then wait again. The reaction depends on the type of event and on the internal state. In UML, an event is a type of occurrence, and each concrete occurrence is an instance. A state machine follows the run-to-completion model: it finishes processing one event before starting the next, and new events wait in a queue. This avoids internal concurrency problems, although the machine's responsiveness is set by its longest step.

Traditional finite-state machines suffer from state explosion. UML solves part of this with extended state: the state variable captures the qualitative aspect, while other variables capture the quantitative aspects. For example, a key_count variable can limit keystrokes to 1000 without creating 1000 states. Guard conditions, which are Boolean expressions in square brackets, enable a transition only when they evaluate to TRUE. Guards should have no side effects, because UML does not define the order in which they are evaluated.

The most important innovation is hierarchically nested states. If a system is in a substate, it is also in the surrounding superstate. When the substate does not handle an event, the superstate handles it instead of discarding it. In a pocket calculator, for instance, the Clear and Off transitions are defined once in the "on" superstate. Orthogonal regions also let a composite state contain independent parts, such as the main keypad and the numeric keypad. Modeling them separately needs $2 + 2$ states instead of the $2 \times 2 = 4$ of a Cartesian product.

Entry and exit actions guarantee initialization and cleanup, much like constructors and destructors. In a toaster oven, the exit action of "heating" disables the heater, so it is off whatever path leads out of that state. Entry actions run from the outermost state inward, and exit actions run in reverse. An internal transition runs actions without changing state and without triggering entry or exit actions, unlike a self-transition.

Key points

– A UML state machine is always in exactly one state and changes state through transitions triggered by events.
– Extended state variables and guard conditions avoid state explosion.
– Hierarchical states let substates reuse behavior from superstates.
– Orthogonal regions model independent parts without multiplying states.
– Entry and exit actions guarantee initialization and cleanup, and they differ from internal transitions.

Glosario

– **state explosion** — explosión de estados; crecimiento desproporcionado del número de estados en una máquina
– **guard condition** — condición de guarda; expresión booleana que habilita o bloquea una transición
– **run to completion** — ejecución hasta completar; cada evento se procesa entero antes del siguiente
– **substate** — subestado; estado anidado dentro de otro estado
– **superstate** — superestado; estado que contiene a otros y les hereda comportamiento
– **orthogonal** — ortogonal; independiente y compatible con otra parte del sistema

– **Cartesian product** — producto cartesiano; todas las combinaciones posibles entre dos conjuntos
– **self-transition** — autotransición; transición cuyo estado de origen y destino es el mismo
– **cleanup** — limpieza, liberación de recursos; tareas finales al salir de un estado
– **triggering event** — evento disparador; el que provoca una transición

Comprehension 1. What is the main idea of the passage?

– **UML state machines extend traditional finite-state machines with features that reduce complexity and repetition.** [CORRECT]
– UML state machines are a way to draw keyboards and calculators.
– Traditional finite-state machines are always better than UML state machines.
– Event-driven programming should be avoided in real-time systems.

Comprehension 2. According to the passage, what happens when a substate does not handle an event?

– The event is quietly discarded.
– **The superstate handles the event.** [CORRECT]
– The machine returns to its initial state.
– The event is stored until the next transition.

Comprehension 3. In the passage, the word "sparingly" would be closest in meaning to which of the following, in the sentence "Used sparingly, extended state variables and guards make up a powerful mechanism"?

– Quickly and without planning
– **In small amounts and with care** [CORRECT]
– Only by expert designers
– Together with entry actions

Comprehension 4. What can be inferred about the toaster oven example?

– **Entry and exit actions make the design safer because a programmer cannot forget to disable the heater.** [CORRECT]
– The heater is controlled only by the actions on transitions.
– The door_open state has no safety requirements.
– Exit actions are executed only when the door is open.